

WARRIOR
LATE-ROUND

PROSPECT GUIDE

2026

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Introduction

“The film doesn’t lie.”

Actually, it does. All the time.

If film were pure truth, prospect evaluation wouldn’t be subjective. Teams wouldn’t disagree. Analysts wouldn’t argue. Entire draft rooms wouldn’t split over the same player.

And yet, they do. Every year.

“The numbers don’t lie.”

Actually, they do. All the time.

Numbers don’t tell stories — they simplify them. They strip context. They smooth uncertainty into something that feels precise, even when it isn’t.

Film lies by convincing us we’re seeing the whole picture.

Numbers lie by convincing us we don’t need one.

Like Jimmy Eat World at the turn of the century, the answer lies somewhere in the middle.

The thing is, I, JJ — hey, nice to meet you — am far more comfortable on one side of the prospect evaluation coin.

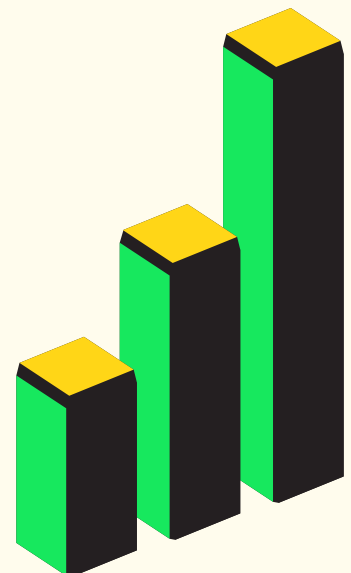
I can get down with numbers.

But they do lie. Because they’ll never tell the whole story.

That’s OK, though. As long as you know that going in.

What you’re about to read won’t give you the answers. It’ll just get you closer to them.

It’s hard to believe, but this is the fifth iteration of the Late-Round Prospect Guide. If you’ve been here before, you probably know



what you're in for. If you're new, welcome — and thank you. I genuinely appreciate you being here.

I also hope you've got your pocket protector ready. Because we're about to get very, very nerdy.

Over the last half decade-plus, I've built prospect models for running backs, wide receivers, and tight ends designed to estimate future fantasy football performance.

And they've worked.

The Zachariason-Adjusted Prospect Model — or ZAP Model — saw Malik Nabers as the best wide receiver in his draft class when consensus was locked onto Marvin Harrison Jr. It flagged Isiah Pacheco as a value before the masses even knew who he was. It projected Khalil Shakir as a potential impact slot player despite his Day 3 draft capital. It adored Jaxon Smith-Njigba.

All of it came through math. Through numbers.

Each positional ZAP Model has evolved over time. Every offseason starts with testing, tweaking, and questioning assumptions. That process inevitably leads to new ways to evaluate prospects.

This year is no different. There are additions and adjustments throughout the guide that I think you'll really enjoy.

But at the center of it all is the same guiding principle it's always been: The goal isn't to be certain. It's to be directionally right.

Prospect models aren't meant to totally replace evaluation. They're meant to challenge it. To nudge us away from bad bets, toward better ones, and closer to the right questions — even when the answers remain frustratingly unclear.

In a process this uncertain, that edge matters.

The ZAP Model

Overview

The goal of the ZAP Model hasn't changed, but the way it gets there continues to evolve.

At its core, it's designed to estimate *how effective* an offensive player will be for fantasy football purposes over the *first three years* of his NFL career.

The reasoning is simple: by the end of Year 3, we usually have a pretty good idea of who a player is. Late-career breakouts do happen, but they're rare enough that they shouldn't drive a prospecting process. If we're trying to identify future fantasy contributors, the first three years are where the signal is strongest.

That naturally raises the question of how early-career success should be defined.

You could look at cumulative fantasy points. You could focus on average points per game. You could even weigh peak seasons more heavily than consistency. There's no single correct answer. But, over time, I've landed on a metric that balances upside, sustainability, and fantasy usability.

That metric is called B2S.

(Yes, another acronym. I'm sorry. Or you're welcome.)

B2S stands for "Best Two Seasons." For each player, we look at his first three NFL seasons and identify his two best years in points per game in point-per-reception formats. Those two seasons are then averaged together.

Imagine a wide receiver who averages 11.0 PPR points per game



as a rookie, 12.0 points per game in Year 2, and 15.0 points per game in Year 3. Under B2S, the rookie season would be discarded, and the 12.0 and 15.0 seasons would be averaged, resulting in a B2S of 13.5.

This approach rewards players who reach meaningful fantasy relevance, even if it takes time, and it avoids over-penalizing prospects who start slow but ultimately develop into usable assets.

Of course, points per game can be misleading in small samples. A player who averages 21 points per game across three contests before suffering a season-ending injury probably shouldn't be treated the same as someone who sustains that level of production across a full season.

To account for that, a season only qualifies for B2S if the player appears in at least seven games. If he fails to meet that threshold, the season is treated as a zero for B2S purposes.

And since the final week of the NFL season is often filled with backups and teams playing for very little, Week 18 is removed from the B2S sample as well. In other words, B2S is only evaluating relevant fantasy weeks.

So, going back to our example: if that wide receiver played only five games in his second season — the one where he averaged 12.0 points per game — but cleared the seven-game threshold in his rookie (11.0 PPR points per game) and third (15.0) years, then his B2S wouldn't be 13.5. Instead, the injury-shortened season would be pushed aside, and the rookie and third-year numbers would be averaged, producing a B2S of 13.0.

That's B2S. And that's what the ZAP Model is attempting to predict.

So how does the model get there?

Over the years, I've worked extensively with college production, athletic testing, and draft data. Through that process, I've developed separate prospect models for running backs, wide receivers, and tight ends, each tailored to the nuances of the position.

But building a model is easy. Proving it's useful is not.

Anyone can throw variables into a spreadsheet and generate a score. If that score doesn't meaningfully improve our understanding — if it doesn't outperform something we already have access to — **then it isn't adding value.**

Which brings us to draft capital.

Draft capital is always the first benchmark I test against. If a prospect model can't do a better job predicting B2S than where a player was selected in the NFL Draft, then the model isn't worth using.

Thankfully, that hurdle is cleared. Every positional ZAP Model included in this guide is more predictive of B2S than draft capital alone.

Much more.

As for the player pool that's being evaluated, each model analyzes all players who were drafted or invited to the NFL Combine since 2011. There's typically significant overlap there, but each year a handful of prospects slip through one channel or the other.

Even though the ZAP Models outperform draft capital on their own, draft capital still plays a central role within them. That's intentional.

The goal here isn't to predict where a player should be drafted in the NFL. Plenty of analysts do that extremely well.



The goal is to help **you win** at fantasy football.

There's no medal awarded for ignoring draft capital during fantasy football rookie drafts. NFL teams invest millions of dollars — and enormous resources — into their draft decisions. Treating that information as irrelevant would be irresponsible.

As a result, draft capital is the single most important input in every ZAP Model. That naturally creates a strong relationship between where a player is drafted and his overall ZAP score.

This isn't a flaw. It's the foundation.

The real value of the model lies in identifying when and where it makes sense to **deviate from draft capital.**

And ultimately, the competition we're trying to beat isn't the NFL. It's our leaguemates.

Every ZAP Model is not only more predictive of B2S than draft capital alone — it's also more predictive than rookie average draft position. In other words, blindly following ZAP scores would outperform blindly following market consensus over time.

That's the edge.

We all on the same page?

Now let's get into what actually goes into these things.

The Wide Receiver ZAP Model

The ZAP Models are adjusted every offseason. Not to retroactively fix misses — players from the most recent class aren't even eligible for testing yet, since they haven't completed three NFL seasons.

The updates happen for a simpler reason: the landscape keeps changing. New data becomes available. Better ways of analyzing that data emerge. And over time, my own approach to prospect evaluation evolves.

This year is no different. The wide receiver model has changed.

A couple of offseasons ago, I introduced the concept of Breakout Score to the prospect models. Breakout Age is a commonly referenced metric in analytically driven prospect evaluation, and it used to play a role in the ZAP Model as well.

But I've always had issues with it.

For those unfamiliar, Breakout Age represents how old a player was when he first reached a certain Dominator Rating threshold. Dominator Rating, to anyone unaware, measures the percentage of a team's receiving production a player accounted for during his college career.

The intuition behind Breakout Age is sound. Early production matters. When a player earns a significant role at a young age, it's usually a sign that he's simply better than his peers.

If a 10-year-old can play Canon in D on the piano the same way a 17-year-old can, odds are that when both pianists turn 20, the younger one is going to be ahead.

(I use that analogy every year in this guide, and it's not going anywhere. Sorry.)

Breakout Age isn't useless, but it is flawed.

Its biggest issue is that it's far too binary. A player either clears

the threshold or he doesn't. There's no room for nuance.

A wide receiver can fall just short of the breakout mark and be treated the exact same way as someone who barely contributed at all. The metric doesn't care how close you were. It only cares whether you crossed an arbitrary line.

Another way to think about it: imagine evaluating wide receivers solely by whether they reached 500 receiving yards in a season. A player with 499 yards and a player with 20 yards would be treated identically, despite clearly not being the same caliber of prospect.

That's the fundamental problem with Breakout Age. It captures when a player produced, but not how much he actually produced when explaining that breakout.

And when you're trying to separate good prospects from great ones, that distinction can be important.

That frustration with Breakout Age ultimately led to Breakout Score.

Like Breakout Age, Breakout Score is designed to capture age-adjusted collegiate production. Unlike Breakout Age, it doesn't rely on a single threshold. And it doesn't lean on Dominator Rating, a metric that comes with its own set of limitations.

Instead, Breakout Score evaluates a player's receiving yards per team pass attempt at multiple points throughout his collegiate career, adjusting for both age and competition level.

Let me explain.

Receiving yards per team pass attempt is exactly what it sounds like: a player's receiving yards divided by the number of pass attempts his team recorded. The ZAP Model uses a prorated version of the stat, so if a player misses some time, that's accounted for. However, if he appears in fewer than six games in a season, that year is excluded from the Breakout Score



calculation.

The “adjusted” portion of Breakout Score comes from two inputs: strength of schedule and age.

For strength of schedule, the model uses team-level data from Sports Reference. Those numbers are translated into a multiplier and applied to a player’s receiving yards per team pass attempt for each season. The idea is simple: production against stronger competition should carry more weight than production against weaker opponents.

It’s easier to rack up numbers at South Alabama than it is at Alabama.

Once that schedule-adjusted number is established, Breakout Score then evaluates it through the lens of age. The younger a player is when he posts a strong schedule-adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt, the more favorably he grades within the metric.

In short, Breakout Score rewards early, efficient production without forcing players into arbitrary buckets.

Breakout Score shows a much stronger relationship to B2S than Breakout Age, and it greatly improves the effectiveness of the ZAP Model.

The wide receiver model also accounts for rushing production. That might sound a little strange at first, but when a receiver is used as more than just a pass-catcher, it’s usually a signal of genuine talent. Coaches don’t manufacture touches for players they don’t trust. If a wideout is getting handoffs or schemed runs, it’s because the offense wants the ball in his hands as often

as possible.

Within the model, rushing production is capped. The goal isn't to turn gadget usage into a cheat code. Instead, modest rushing totals act as a proxy for versatility and, more broadly, for being good at football.

The final production-related input in the wide receiver model is best-season adjusted fantasy points per game, a new addition this year. The concept is straightforward: it takes a player's best collegiate season in fantasy points per game (with a minimum of six games played) and adjusts that output for both age and strength of schedule.

That covers the production side of the wide receiver model. But several inputs have nothing to do with what a player did on the field on Saturdays.

Early-declare status is the most notable.

It's a concept that's been debated in dynasty circles for years, and the logic behind it isn't all that different from metrics like Breakout Age. When a player chooses to leave school early and enter the NFL Draft, it's usually because he's good enough to do so. NFL teams are showing interest, and the player is responding.

If that's the case, he's probably pretty good at playing the position.

That's why early-declare status carries weight in the model.

There's also a practical consideration. Early-declare receivers have fewer collegiate seasons on their résumé. That puts them at a slight disadvantage in pure production metrics, since they don't get the benefit of padding their profile with a fourth or fifth year of college production.

Most early-declare wideouts still post strong age-adjusted numbers, of course. But older prospects can sometimes inflate their statistical profiles by simply sticking around longer. Early

declaration helps correct for that imbalance.

The common question people have with early-declare status these days relates to name, image, and likeness (NIL) deals. Players can make real money while staying in school, and they can buy themselves more time to develop before stepping into the NFL.

And it's true: wide receivers are leaving early at a lower rate than they were before. From 2023 through 2025, for example, 15% of the wide receivers in the ZAP Model were early declares. In the 12 years prior, that number was closer to 26%.

But a lower early-declare rate doesn't mean early declaration suddenly stopped mattering. It just means the environment changed.

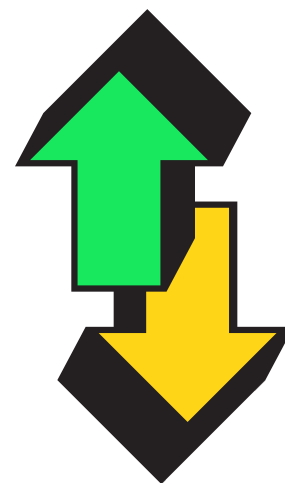
If anything, NIL raises the bar for leaving early. When staying in school comes with both financial incentives and the comfort of a familiar situation, the players who still choose to declare early are often doing so because the NFL feedback is strong enough to outweigh those benefits. In other words, the "why" behind an early declaration hasn't gone away — the decision is just being made under different circumstances.

So no, early-declare status isn't something to ignore. It's something to interpret correctly. It's not a trump card, and it's not a deal-breaker. It's a signal — one piece of a larger puzzle — and the model treats it that way.

There's also Teammate Score. When a wide receiver plays alongside other pro-caliber players, it matters. Intuitively, that makes sense: it's harder to command a large share of an offense when you're competing for targets with legitimate NFL talent.

Teammate Score isn't perfect, but it's built using the draft capital of a player's college teammates from the current draft class and recent seasons. As a result, a receiver's ZAP score can shift slightly as the NFL Draft unfolds, depending on where those teammates are selected. The changes are usually small, but the signal is real.

The final non-production-related input in the wide receiver ZAP Model is size.



Smaller wideouts aren't incapable of posting useful fantasy seasons, but they do tend to face steeper odds when it comes to reaching true ceiling outcomes. There are situations where a player will be dinged for being on the smaller side, not because success is impossible, but because history shows it's harder to get there.

So, to recap, the wide receiver model incorporates Breakout Score, rushing production, best-season adjusted fantasy points per game, early-declare status, Teammate Score, and size. Draft capital is then layered on top — and, once again, it's the single most important piece of the puzzle — to create a player's ZAP score.

And no, athletic testing from the NFL Combine isn't part of the model.

When people hear that prospect models exist, they often assume they're driven primarily by NFL Combine numbers. That makes sense on the surface — bigger, faster, stronger sounds better than the alternative.

But in practice, athleticism is already doing a lot of its work through draft capital.

Truly unathletic wide receivers rarely get selected highly in the first place.

And if a player completely bombs the Combine, that usually shows up elsewhere: weaker draft capital, a thinner production profile, or both.

Beyond that, wide receivers win in different ways. Rome Odunze doesn't succeed the same way Ladd McConkey does. Asking a model to enforce one athletic archetype would ignore the reality of how the position actually functions.

If anything, there's a reasonable argument that athleticism at wide

receiver is often overrated. From a modeling perspective, though, it doesn't need to be debated. The information is already baked in.

The Running Back ZAP Model

We just spent a lot of time talking about wide receivers. So naturally, let's talk about running backs and the thing that matters most for them as they transition from college to the NFL.

Receiving.

Last year, it felt a bit like an episode of *Maury* when I revealed that the running back ZAP Model didn't include a single rushing statistic. Every production-related input was tied to pass-catching.

That wasn't an oversight. It was intentional.

And after more testing, that hasn't changed much in 2026.

Receiving still rules all at the running back position.

Look, these prospect models aren't built to help me run an NFL franchise. They're built to help us win at fantasy football. Draft capital remains the foundation of everything here, but when it comes to identifying when and where to diverge from a player's draft slot, receiving metrics consistently tell the most useful story for running backs.

One of the core inputs in the running back model is reception share, a metric I've leaned on for years. It's simply the percentage of a team's completions that went to a running back, prorated to account for missed time. Reception share tends to be most informative at the top of the draft, where it works alongside draft capital to separate similar profiles, but it still carries signal deeper into drafts as well.

In last year's version of the model, Breakout Score was also used at running back, not just at wide receiver. As a reminder, that metric is derived entirely from receiving yards per team pass attempt. Receiving yards per team pass attempt remains part of the running back model today, but it's no longer bundled into

Breakout Score for the position. Instead, the model now looks at a player's best season in age- and schedule-adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt.

What's new this year is that some rushing production has been allowed back into the conversation.

Some.

The model now incorporates age- and schedule-adjusted total yards per team play, calculated in the same way as receiving yards per team pass attempt, but using all offensive yards and all team plays. This gives rushing production a voice without letting it drown out the more predictive receiving signals.

I alluded to this a second ago, but one of the more meaningful tweaks in 2026 is how these production metrics are weighted depending on where a player is selected in the NFL Draft. For example, a late-round pick's yards per team play may matter more for his ZAP score than his reception share, whereas the opposite is often true for early-round selections.

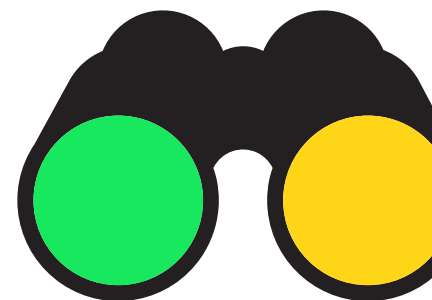
Each of these production metrics are useful on their own. But they become far more powerful once we know exactly where a player is drafted.

Keep that interaction in mind as you read through this year's running back profiles.

Collegiate production isn't the only thing the running back ZAP Model is concerned with.

We've looked at some age-related production metrics at the position, but age itself is a factor here, too. It's certainly not everything, and NIL deals are shifting this landscape a tad, but older running backs are usually worse bets to make compared to younger ones. Production will always trump age, though.

Teammate Score is an input in the running back model, too, just like the wide receiver one. This seems a little counter-intuitive, but there's actually less weight given to Teammate Score for running backs compared to wideouts – you'd figure a split backfield with a legitimate pro would boost a running back's score



more than it does. But, in the end, the ZAP Model does still care about teammate competition, even if it's a little less than at wide receiver.

The final two non-production inputs in the running back ZAP Model are also the most controversial: size and Speed Score.

Running back size appears to matter less and less in today's NFL. We watch players like James Cook, De'Von Achane, Jahmyr Gibbs, and Kyren Williams put up big fantasy numbers on a weekly basis, and none of them fit the traditional mold of a "big" running back.

Because of examples like those, it's easy to dismiss the idea that size matters at all. But they're better viewed as exceptions than proof that the rule no longer exists.

It's also important to be clear about how the ZAP Model treats size. Weight is not evaluated in a vacuum.

Take Jahmyr Gibbs. He entered the league at 199 pounds, which led to a bizarre fixation on an arbitrary 200-pound threshold. Some film evaluators understandably pushed back, pointing out how silly it is to treat a one-pound difference — something that could be dictated by what a player ate earlier that day — as meaningful.

The ZAP Model agrees. A strict cutoff like that is bad analysis.

But Gibbs is on the smaller side. That fact simply doesn't matter much when everything else checks out. Draft capital. Receiving profile. Yards per team play. When all of those boxes are checked, size becomes a footnote, not a deal-breaker.

That's why Gibbs owns one of the highest ZAP scores the model has ever produced. The same logic applies to De'Von Achane. Yes, he's small, but he also posted an absurd college production profile. The model accounts for both.

Size isn't irrelevant — larger backs, all else equal, have historically been more reliable fantasy producers — but it's nowhere near sufficient on its own to forecast NFL success. And it never operates alone within the model.

The other debated input is Speed Score.

Speed Score, originally developed by Bill Barnwell, recognizes that not all 40-yard dashes are created equal. Running a 4.40 at 200 pounds isn't the same thing as running a 4.40 at 230. When adjusted for weight, faster backs generally produce better fantasy outcomes.

Generally.

Once again, the mistake is treating a single metric as definitive. Kareem Hunt is a good example. His Speed Score was unimpressive, but the rest of his profile was strong. He entered the league before his 22nd birthday, had solid size, and posted excellent age- and schedule-adjusted production numbers. As a result, he still graded well in the ZAP Model despite lacking straight-line speed.

If it were entirely up to me, running back size wouldn't matter much at all. But it does matter to NFL teams. Smaller backs are less likely to be handed massive workloads, and in fantasy football, volume still drives everything.

The good news is that smaller backs can absolutely offset that disadvantage with elite production and receiving profiles. The model allows for that flexibility.

That's the running back ZAP Model, though.

On the production side, it uses reception share, receiving yards per team pass attempt, and yards per team play. On the profile side, it incorporates age, weight, Teammate Score, and Speed Score. Layer draft capital on top, and you've got the full picture.

Well — maybe not the entire picture.

Draft capital is obviously a key part of the model, but it's calculated a little differently than it is at wide receiver and tight end. After doing some investigating last year, I found that combining NFL Mock Draft Database's consensus mock drafts with actual draft capital gave the running back ZAP Model more

signal — it made it more predictive.

In practice, that means the model uses a slight blend of real and projected draft capital — about an 83/17 split between actual draft capital and consensus projections.

Why would this help?

For one, it introduces a data point that isn't tied to a single team's decision. And it may simply be that the collective football brain — the analysts, scouts, and evaluators contributing to those mock drafts — does a pretty good job identifying running back talent. Interestingly, that same signal doesn't appear to hold as strongly for wide receivers and tight ends.

This might sound like a big change, but it really isn't. In most cases, projected and actual draft capital aren't drastically different.

But in the name of transparency, I wanted you to know.

The Tight End ZAP Model

Over the last couple of years, I've been building a tight end version of the ZAP Model. And it hasn't been easy.

The results have been solid — you saw some of that in last year's guide — but tight end is a different animal. Unlike wide receivers, tight ends don't run as many routes. There are fewer players putting up flashy receiving totals. They block more. And NFL teams draft them not just to catch passes, but to function as an extension of the offensive line.

In other words, what we're trying to solve in fantasy football isn't always what an NFL team is trying to solve.

That disconnect makes prospecting at the position more difficult. Draft capital, for example, doesn't carry quite the same weight for tight ends as it does for running backs and wide receivers.

At the start of the year, Brandon Gdula joined Late-Round Fantasy Football as a Senior Analyst. Brandon and I go way back to our numberFire and FanDuel days, and we've worked together in different capacities for years. As Late-Round has grown, I've needed support. Brandon brings deep data experience, he's a strong writer, and he's just an incredibly sharp thinker. When the opportunity came to bring him on board, I jumped at it.

Since he started, we've built a brand-new tight end model. More accurately, I oversaw the project while Brandon handled much of the heavy analytical lifting. And I can confidently say the new tight end ZAP Model is freaking awesome.

Like the other ZAP Models, this one predicts B2S — a player's best two-season average across his first three NFL years. And like the others, it looks at every tight end who was drafted or invited to the NFL Combine since 2011.

But this model works a little differently.

Instead of primarily leaning on draft capital and adjusting from there, the tight end model focuses on how three areas interact: draft capital, athleticism, and collegiate production.

Draft capital is straightforward — it's where the player was selected. Athleticism, in this model, is height-adjusted Speed Score. It's traditional Speed Score, but adjusted for height, and it carries more weight here than it does in the running back model.

On the production side, we're looking at Breakout Score, calculated similarly to the wide receiver model through age- and schedule-adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt.

Technically, the model also incorporates best-season receiving yards per team pass attempt along with height and weight, but those three core areas are the easiest way to understand what's going on.

Here's the key difference with tight ends: athleticism fundamentally changes what draft capital means.



Through a lot of research, Brandon found that draft capital doesn't operate in isolation at this position. Its signal shifts depending on the athlete.

Take Jordan Reed as an example. Reed entered the NFL as a below-average athlete but was a Day 2 pick with legitimate college production. The model really likes him. When a tight end lacks high-end athleticism, early draft capital becomes more informative. It suggests the team saw something else — route-running, spatial awareness, technical refinement — that testing numbers don't capture. A less athletic player who still produced in college is likely winning in ways that raw speed doesn't show, and if a team invests meaningful draft capital in that profile, that investment carries real signal.

Teams won't always be right. But when they draft a mediocre athlete early, and that player has strong production, the model recognizes that combination as meaningful.

On the flip side, the model doesn't automatically reward tight ends just for being elite athletes. We often assume that a freakishly athletic Day 2 tight end must have a big fantasy future because a team “has plans” for him. But if the college production profile is weak, that player will take a significant hit in the ZAP Model. Athleticism is part of the puzzle, not the entire picture.

There's a balance between investment, traits, and production, and that's what the model is trying to capture.

A good example of this balance is the gap between Hunter Henry and Michael Mayer. Henry has a ZAP score of 85.6 in the model. Mayer's is 73.0. That's a meaningful difference, even though the two players were nearly identical across most inputs. Both were selected 35th overall. Their height and weight were almost the same. Their best-season yards per team pass attempt differed by just 0.01. Their Breakout Scores were essentially no different.

The main delta was athleticism. Mayer posted a height-adjusted Speed Score of 103.4, while Henry's was 96.2.

That's not backwards.

The model prefers Henry, the slightly weaker athlete, because when two players look nearly identical in draft capital and production, lower athleticism paired with that same level of investment suggests that the draft capital is signaling other translatable traits.

The team wasn't just drafting traits. The team was drafting a complete profile.

Keep all of that in mind as you read through this year's tight end profiles — which Brandon wrote for the guide. This model isn't about adding up traits and hoping for the best. It's about understanding how those traits interact, and what that interaction tells us about future opportunity and fantasy production.



Interpreting the Data

There were snow and ice storms hitting my corner of North Carolina toward the end of January, and at times, the local forecasts missed the mark. We'd hear projections of three-quarters of an inch of ice and end up with a quarter. Power outages were warned about that never materialized.

People were not thrilled.

A big part of that frustration comes down to misunderstanding. Most of us — myself included — don't really grasp the complex atmospheric processes that create winter precipitation. And when probability-driven forecasts are treated as promises, disappointment is almost inevitable.

In this metaphor, I'm the meteorologist. You're coming to me for a forecast on prospects.

But I'm not interested in just throwing a number on the screen and moving on. If I'm going to give you an outlook, it's my responsibility — not yours — to explain what that forecast actually means, where it can go wrong, and how to properly use it.

That's why the ZAP Model got a bit of a makeover this offseason.

Staying in the spirit of transparency, it's important to point out that the ZAP score you've historically seen on a player's profile isn't the raw number the model generates. Behind the scenes, the model produces a score based on its inputs that lives in a relatively narrow range — roughly the low 20s to high 40s at wide receiver, and single digits to the high 20s at running back.

Those raw numbers aren't particularly intuitive on their own. Without context or scaling, they're difficult to interpret.

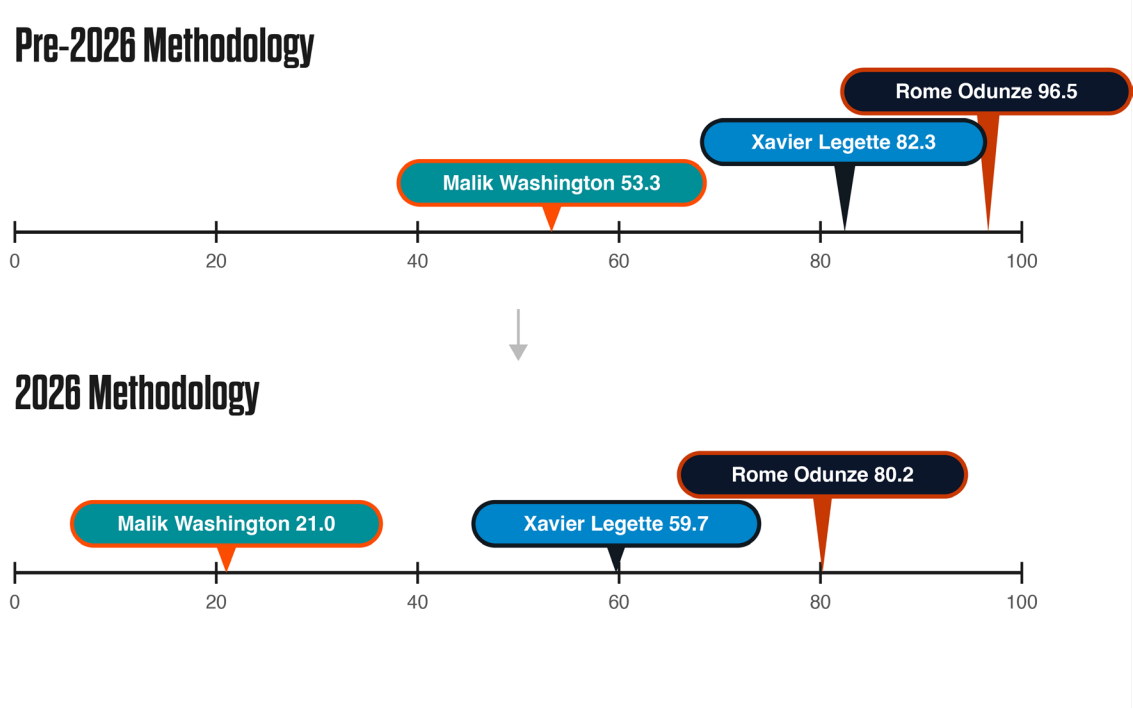
In the past, I addressed this by converting scores into percentiles. That worked fine at first, but over time, it became clear that percentiles introduced their own problems. They force the data into a linear distribution and can obscure meaningful gaps between prospects who shouldn't feel interchangeable.

In turn, last year, categories were added as a step toward solving that problem. Players were grouped based on their raw model scores rather than their percentile rank, which helped frame expectations more realistically.

But even that solution never fully sat right with me. The raw score was still doing the real work behind the scenes, and it still wasn't being presented in a way that felt clear or intuitive enough.

So this year, that changes.

Player scores are now scaled in a more intuitive way to better reflect true talent gaps between prospects. Rather than compressing players into overly similar ranges, the updated presentation makes it easier to see where meaningful separation actually exists, as you can see in the visual below:



As part of this update, a new top-end category has also been added: **Legendary Performer**.

Below is a general breakdown of the categories and the ZAP score ranges you can expect for each tier:

Legendary Performer (90–100):

Real potential to be a generational talent. These players hit at an outstanding rate historically and profile as cornerstone dynasty assets.

Elite Producer (75–90):

Capable of reaching ceilings similar to Legendary Performers, but with meaningfully lower odds.

Weekly Starter (60–75):

Players you can usually trust in your lineup — think RB2s and WR2s.

Flex Play (40–60):

Unlikely to become league-winners, but capable of providing usable fantasy production.

Benchwarmer (30–40):

Best suited as bench depth or insurance.

Waiver Wire Add (20–30):

Generally not roster-worthy, but occasionally useful in the right situation.

Dart Throw (0–20):

Little chance of sustained fantasy success.

This new scaling does a much better job showing how separated one prospect truly is from another — and that separation is helpful when analyzing a draft class.

With that framework in place, let's look at how the running back ZAP Model has performed historically through the lens of these categories.

Running Back (Best Two-Year Average; Years 1-3)

	>10	>12	>14	>16	>18	>20
Legendary Performer	100.0%	100.0%	87.5%	87.5%	75.0%	75.0%
Elite Producer	85.7%	71.4%	71.4%	21.4%	14.3%	7.1%
Weekly Starter	62.5%	45.0%	32.5%	22.5%	12.5%	5.0%
Flex Play	36.6%	14.6%	7.3%	7.3%	4.9%	0.0%
Benchwarmer	14.8%	9.8%	4.9%	3.3%	0.0%	0.0%
Waiver Wire Add	6.7%	3.3%	1.7%	1.7%	1.7%	0.0%
Dart Throw	3.7%	2.6%	1.1%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%

The table above includes all running backs in the ZAP Model drafted between 2011 and 2023. We need the full three-year window to calculate B2S, which is why more recent classes aren't included.

The leftmost column shows the ZAP categories. Moving across the table, you'll see the percentage of players within each category who reached specific B2S thresholds.

For example, 85.7% of Elite Producers recorded a B2S of at least 10 PPR points per game. In other words, the vast majority of players in that tier delivered baseline fantasy usefulness. Meanwhile, every Legendary Performer reached that same threshold — though it's worth noting that the sample size is understandably small, given how difficult it is to earn that label.

At a high level, this table is showing us that the model works.

Of course, it isn't perfect. Occasionally, a Waiver Wire Add will spike a B2S north of 16 points per game. Sometimes, a Weekly Starter will completely flame out. That's the nature of probabilistic modeling.

What matters is that the model has been back-tested, and that both the scores and the categories derived from them are reliable over time.

Now let's look at the same breakdown for wide receivers.

Wide Receiver (Best Two-Year Average; Years 1-3)						
	>10	>12	>14	>16	>18	>20
Legendary Performer	88.9%	77.8%	66.7%	33.3%	22.2%	5.6%
Elite Producer	58.8%	38.2%	23.5%	11.8%	5.9%	2.9%
Weekly Starter	33.3%	22.2%	11.1%	6.3%	1.6%	0.0%
Flex Play	25.7%	20.3%	13.5%	6.8%	1.4%	0.0%
Benchwarmer	8.7%	4.3%	2.9%	2.9%	1.4%	1.4%
Waiver Wire Add	3.7%	0.9%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%
Dart Throw	1.6%	0.8%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%

Wide receivers have a harder time reaching truly elite B2S thresholds, but the trend remains clear. As the ZAP category improves, so do the hit rates. The signal is consistent, even if the position behaves a little differently.

The same story exists at tight end.

Tight End (Best Two-Year Average; Years 1-3)						
	>7	>8	>9	>10	>11	>12
Legendary Performer	100.0%	100.0%	100.0%	71.4%	42.9%	14.3%
Elite Producer	60.0%	46.7%	40.0%	13.3%	13.3%	13.3%
Weekly Starter	35.7%	35.7%	35.7%	28.6%	14.3%	7.1%
Flex Play	22.5%	20.0%	7.5%	5.0%	5.0%	5.0%
Benchwarmer	11.1%	3.7%	3.7%	3.7%	3.7%	3.7%
Waiver Wire Add	2.7%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%
Dart Throw	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%

Tight end can act a little goofier with these hit rate tables, mostly because we'll see a wide variety of archetypes selected at the position. Because Weekly Starters may look better than Elite Producers at certain thresholds doesn't mean that category is

better. And it certainly doesn't mean the model isn't working.

It's just showing us that the category is still capable, and perhaps the lines aren't as clear-cut between those two groups. Nevertheless, Elite Producers have still provided a much higher ceiling.

Draft Capital Delta

You may have noticed a glaring outlier in the wide receiver hit-rate table — a Benchwarmer who posted a B2S north of 20 PPR points per game.

That player was — is — Puka Nacua.

The model labeled him at the top of the Benchwarmer category.

Holy L.

Or... maybe not.

Draft capital anchors ZAP scores by design. And historically, Day 3 wide receivers — players drafted on the third day of the NFL Draft — simply haven't been very fantasy relevant. Since 2011, the list of wideouts selected after Pick 100 who've averaged at least 14 PPR points per game in B2S is extremely short: Puka Nacua, Tyreek Hill, Amon-Ra St. Brown, and Martavis Bryant. Bryant didn't even provide production in Year 3.

That's the list.

Nacua was drafted 177th overall. No sane model is going to treat a player with that type of draft capital as a top-tier prospect. And if a model does rank a Day 3 wide receiver near the top of a class, there's almost certainly some overfitting happening.

So yes — a low ZAP score for a late-round pick is common. But that doesn't mean the model is telling us to completely ignore those players.

That's where Draft Capital Delta comes in.

Every prospect has two things: a ZAP score, and an implied score based solely on his draft capital. A first overall pick might carry a draft-capital score near 100. An undrafted player would be close to zero.

Draft Capital Delta measures the difference between those two values. In effect, it asks: How does the model view this player once we strip away what the NFL told us?

In Nacua's case, his ZAP score came in at 40.5. Based on his draft position, his score "should've" been closer to 33.9.

That seven-point gap is meaningful, especially for a Day 3 pick. It tells us that, while his profile wasn't pristine, there were still positive indicators — a respectable Breakout Score, some rushing involvement, and enough underlying production to separate him from a typical 177th-overall selection.

Draft Capital Delta buckets players into three risk tiers: low risk, neutral, and high risk. Low-risk players are those the model likes more than their draft capital would suggest. High-risk players are the opposite — prospects whose ZAP scores lag behind how the dynasty market is likely valuing them.

As you'd expect, low-risk players outperform their expected B2S at a much higher rate than high-risk players.

It's not foolproof. There will always be exceptions. But Draft Capital Delta adds valuable context — especially when you're deciding whether a late-round prospect is worth taking a swing on, or whether an early pick carries more downside than the market realizes.

Adding Subjectivity

Some people make New Year's resolutions about going to the gym more. Others want to read more books. Some try to drink less.

Me? One of my New Year's resolutions is to put more faith in the ZAP Model.

This process is mostly objective. I say “mostly” because I’m human, and humans bring biases with them whether they like it or not. Total objectivity is a myth.

But modeling does give us something incredibly valuable: a baseline. A way to stay grounded when narratives start to creep in and rookie drafts get chaotic.

That baseline isn’t the end-all.

There are times when I disagree with the model and lean more heavily on subjective evaluation. Historically, that hasn’t always gone well for me — hence the resolution — but the ZAP Model isn’t flawless. You’ve already seen that. Misses are part of the deal.

My goal isn’t to tell you exactly what to do. It’s to give you tools. To offer a framework that helps you think differently about prospects and make more informed decisions.

Fantasy football is about winning — mostly. But it’s also about enjoying the process. Digging into players. Debating evaluations. Getting your hands dirty.

You don’t need to follow the ZAP Model blindly.

In fact, I don’t want you to.

Use this guide as another weapon in your arsenal. Read other analysts. Listen to other podcasts. Check out what pure film-based evaluators have to say. There are a lot of sharp people doing great work.

Just don’t completely ignore what the ZAP Model is telling you.

Because having that baseline — that anchor — can give you a very real edge.

2026 Prospect Profiles

Overview

It's rare for a running back or wide receiver to become a fantasy football star without an NFL Combine invite. It certainly happens — Austin Ekeler and Adam Thielen both became studs after being skipped over. But exceptions don't invalidate the rule.

From a probability standpoint, if we're playing fantasy football, we should care most about the players who were invited to the NFL Combine. Period.

That's the focus of these prospect profiles.

There were 46 wide receiver invites to this year's NFL Combine. There were 20 running backs — well, 20 running backs and a fullback — who were awarded the same honor. And we've got 27 tight ends this year, too.

**Late-Round Fantasy Football Senior Analyst
Brandon Gdula and yours truly profiled them. All
of them.**

We studied their profiles, and we analyzed the type of players they may become at the next level.

These outlooks are going to change after the draft — and, when they do, I'll send you an updated version of this guide. But understanding a class before draft capital and landing spots enter the equation is part of the edge.

Key Terms

ZAP Score: The score given to an incoming rookie in the ZAP Model. It's based on the factors outlined in the ZAP Model Overview section of this guide. For pre-draft scores, the draft capital input is based on projected draft capital from NFLMockDraftDatabase.com. All scores range from 0 to 100.

ZAP Score Category: Every player's ZAP score coincides with one of seven categories, which were talked about earlier. Those categories will be listed on every player's prospect page.

Breakout Score: The score given to a wide receiver and tight end for his age-adjusted production. This is based on yards per team pass attempt. All scores range from 0 to 100.

B2S: The ZAP Model attempts to predict how well a player will do in fantasy football across his first three years in the league. In doing this, it tests against the average of a player's top-two seasons in PPR points per game during his first three years as a pro. This is referred to as B2S (Best Two Seasons).

Draft Capital Delta: The difference between a player's ZAP score versus where he was drafted in the actual NFL Draft. A very low Draft Capital Delta will be displayed as a "high risk" profile. A very high one will be shown as a "low risk" profile. Most players will simply be "neutral". *Draft Capital Deltas will be published in the post-draft version of the guide.*

Speed Score: A concept developed by Bill Barnwell to help appropriately weight 40-yard dash times based on a player's size.

Statistical Comparables: Players in history who appear to have similar analytical profiles to the player being analyzed. This is based on things like size, age, Breakout Score, and other production metrics.

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Jordyn Tyson • WR

 **92.2**

ZAP Score

ARIZONA STATE

LEGENDARY PERFORMER

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'2 Weight: 203 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: CeeDee Lamb ▪ Marvin Harrison Jr. ▪ Corey Davis

The ZAP Model is in love with Jordyn Tyson. And once you open the hood, it's easy to see why.

Tyson began his collegiate career at Colorado, playing nine games and posting 22 catches for 470 yards and 4 touchdowns as a freshman. He then transferred to Arizona State, where he spent three seasons. He's not an early-declare receiver, but that's about the only minor nit to pick analytically.

After an injury-impacted sophomore stretch, Tyson exploded as a junior in 2024. He caught 75 passes for 1,101 yards and 10 touchdowns, producing a prorated receiving yards per team pass attempt mark of 3.36. Adjusted for strength of schedule, that jumps to 3.58, the best top-season mark in this year's class.

Tyson won't even be 22 years old on draft day, meaning he hit that production threshold at a young age. That translates to a Breakout Score of 95.1, the best among this year's Combine invitees. That's a 99th-percentile number.

If Tyson lands as a top-20 selection – as currently projected – he'd join an exclusive group of nine ZAP Model wide receivers with a Breakout Score above 90 and top-20 draft capital: Mike Evans, Sammy Watkins, Amari Cooper, Corey Davis, CeeDee Lamb, Ja'Marr Chase, Chris Olave, Jaxon Smith-Njigba, and Malik Nabers. That's serious company.

And it doesn't stop there. Tyson posted a top-five first downs per route run rate in the class, per PFF data, and his best season in yards per route run cleared 3.0 – a mark only seven Combine invitees reached.

Aside from early-declare status, the one area where Tyson underperformed was missed tackles forced per reception – he was second-worst in the class. Since 2020, it's been a mixed bag for players who ranked low within the metric. On the plus side, there's Chris Olave and DeVonta Smith. On the not plus side, there's Jalen Reagor and Jahan Dotson. It could be an issue for Tyson at the next level.

Durability is also a huge concern. Tyson missed multiple games in each of his four collegiate seasons, adding a layer of risk. Teams may not want to invest heavily in him as a result – it's been a huge talking point this draft season.

But zoom out: Tyson is tagged as a Legendary Performer. Historically, players in that tier have delivered 18-plus PPR points per game in B2S at a 22.2% rate, and 84% have produced at least one WR2-or-better season within their first three years.

Analytically speaking, Jordyn Tyson looks fantastic.



Carnell Tate • WR

 **84.2**

ZAP Score

OHIO STATE

ELITE PRODUCER

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'2 Weight: 192 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: George Pickens ▪ Calvin Ridley ▪ Will Fuller

There's a lot of comfort with Carnell Tate. Just look at the first-round Ohio State wide receivers over the last five years: Chris Olave, Garrett Wilson, Jaxon Smith-Njigba, Marvin Harrison Jr., and Emeka Egbuka. It's been an absolute pipeline.

Tate has the traits to be a strong fantasy asset. His Breakout Score of 65.3 falls short of those Buckeye stars, but it still lands in the 86th percentile and ranked fourth-best in this year's class. His career yards per route run finished top-10 in the class – impressive when you consider the target competition. As a freshman, he shared the field with Marvin Harrison Jr. and Emeka Egbuka. As a sophomore, it was Egbuka and Jeremiah Smith. And as a junior, he once again competed with Smith. There are no free lunches in that receiver room.

Tate is also a relatively clean evaluation because he operated almost exclusively on the perimeter throughout college, running 88% of his routes from the outside. In an NFL environment that increasingly leans on heavier personnel groupings and multiple tight end sets, boundary receivers who can win outside are more likely to stay on the field as true every-down players.

It's not a flawless profile, though. Tate wasn't a massive target earner in college, topping out at a 21.7% prorated target share in his best season, per PFF. He played with tougher competition, yes, but that figure ranked in the bottom half of this class.

The saving grace is what he did with those opportunities. Tate was efficient – particularly on downfield looks – which helps soften the concern. His career contested catch rate was an impressive 68.8%, one of the better marks you'll find in the database.

Tate didn't dominate volume, but he maximized the chances he got.

The projected draft capital matters a ton here, too. Tate is tracking toward top-16 selection range – possibly even top-10. Since 2011, wide receivers drafted in the top half of Round 1 who played at least three seasons have averaged a best-season output of 13.9 PPR points per game in their first three years. When filtering for players with a Breakout Score above 60, that number jumps to 15.0.

That's a strong median outcome.

Tate may not have quite the nuclear upside of some recent Ohio State stars, but analytically, this is a stable, high-probability profile.



Makai Lemon • WR

 **80.2**

ZAP Score

SOUTHERN CALIFORNIA

ELITE PRODUCER

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 5'11 Weight: 192 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Nelson Agholor ▪ Odell Beckham ▪ Jayden Reed

If you want a quick-and-dirty comp for Makai Lemon, think Amon-Ra St. Brown, another USC receiver. St. Brown is a popular stylistic comparison – both are technicians with elite short-area quickness and a relentless edge to their game. Like St. Brown, Lemon has that dog in him.

Interestingly, St. Brown doesn't surface as a direct comp in the ZAP Model, largely because Lemon's analytical profile is actually stronger. And that's saying something – St. Brown entered the league with a great résumé and a low-risk Draft Capital Delta tag.

Lemon played three seasons at USC and improved every year. He caught just six passes as a freshman, but that jumped to 52 as a sophomore and 77 as a junior. His prorated receiving yards per team pass attempt hit 2.98 last season and climbed to 3.35 when adjusted for strength of schedule. That was the third-best top-season adjusted mark in the class. That production translated to a Breakout Score of 67.1, also third-best among Combine invitees.

Lemon's deployment is where things get interesting.

The Trojans had Lemon run more than 75% of his routes from the slot in college. St. Brown was at 69%, per PFF. That deployment isn't irrelevant. Over the last five years, Day 2 receivers with slot rates north of 70% have generally struggled. The first-rounders in that bucket, however – Jaylen Waddle, Treylon Burks, Kadarius Toney, Jaxon Smith-Njigba, and Emeka Egbuka – have had much better outcomes. And stylistically and statistically, Lemon looks nothing like Burks or Toney.

There's naturally a bit more volatility in a profile with heavy slot usage. But as was the case with Jaxon Smith-Njigba when he entered the league, draft capital tells the story. If a team invests in Lemon in Round 1 – possibly early Round 1 – they're likely viewing him as more than just a slot specialist.

And that projection isn't blind optimism. Lemon actually posted the best career perimeter yards per route run rate among this year's NFL Combine invites.

In other words, he can win outside.

Lemon is the real deal. Even if Nelson Agholor shows up as a top statistical comp.



KC Concepcion • WR

 **73.4**

ZAP Score

TEXAS A&M

WEEKLY STARTER

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'0 Weight: 196 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Christian Kirk ▪ Emeka Egbuka ▪ Randall Cobb

Jordyn Tyson, Carnell Tate, and Makai Lemon are getting most of the “Big 3” attention in this class, but don’t overlook KC Concepcion.

Unlike the more prominent names, Concepcion brings legitimate gadget work to the table. And that’s not a knock. He spent two seasons at NC State before transferring to Texas A&M for his final year, and across those three seasons, he carried the ball 70 times for 431 yards. That production gives him a modest bump in the ZAP Model.

And it’s not as though the receiving work was weak.

Concepcion posted a 53.9 Breakout Score, a 76th percentile number and fifth-best in the class. The score isn’t higher because he never truly had a crazy season – his best mark in receiving yards per team pass attempt was 2.25, right around the class average. But he contributed early and consistently, which the model rewards.

Concepcion isn’t huge, but he compensates with elite quickness and separation ability. Like Makai Lemon, Concepcion logged heavy slot usage throughout his collegiate journey – over 70% of his routes came from the slot. But, like Lemon, Concepcion’s yards per route run rate was actually better on the perimeter than inside.

That trend became clearer after his transfer.

According to PFF, Concepcion’s slot rate dropped from 93% and 82% at NC State to just 34% at Texas A&M in 2025. And his yards per route run peaked during that lower-slot season.

You love to see it.

There’s a chance an NFL team initially views Concepcion as a slot-heavy weapon. But the data suggests he’s capable of more than that. His movement skills and perimeter effectiveness hint at a broader deployment.

If the draft capital works out – particularly if he lands solidly in Round 1 – there’s little reason to believe he can’t grow into a legitimate fantasy asset.

Concepcion may not carry the same ceiling narrative as the “Big 3,” but analytically, most of the boxes are checked.



Omar Cooper • WR

 **66.3**

ZAP Score

INDIANA

WEEKLY STARTER

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'0 Weight: 199 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Rashee Rice ▪ Deebo Samuel ▪ Carlos Henderson

Looking at Omar Cooper's statistical comps gives you a good sense of the archetype. He's a create-after-the-catch receiver who can make defenders miss. Among this year's Combine invitees, Cooper ranks third-best in career missed tackles forced per reception. Notably, the two players ahead of him failed to record a Breakout Score.

Cooper's Breakout Score is solid, but not special at 41.7 – roughly the 54th percentile. That middling mark is largely due to the fact that he didn't post a truly strong adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt season until 2025, his fourth and final year at Indiana.

Non-receiving work is helping Cooper's ZAP score, though. He shared the field with fellow Combine invite Elijah Sarratt, and he contributed on the ground as well, totaling 97 rushing yards and a pair of scores over his final two seasons. It's a well-rounded profile, even if it lacks a truly dominant season.

The Deebo Samuel comparison is particularly interesting. Samuel owns a thicker build, but analytically, they're closer than you might think. Their Breakout Scores are just five points apart. Their career yards per route run marks were 2.47 (Cooper) and 2.43 (Samuel). Their first downs per route run rates were nearly identical. And their best adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt seasons were 2.63 and 2.64.

The key difference was deployment. Samuel saw a lot more manufactured looks behind the line of scrimmage, and he was rarely a slot receiver at South Carolina, never topping a 20% slot rate in any season, per PFF. Cooper, meanwhile, finished his career with a 47.5% slot rate.

That's not disqualifying or anything. Cooper's perimeter yards per route run was 2.40, actually 0.19 higher than Samuel's collegiate mark. That outside efficiency ranks ninth-best in this class and fifth-best among wide receivers projected to go inside the top 100.

There's a lot to like here. Cooper brings the versatility the ZAP Model values, and even though he wasn't deployed as a full-time boundary receiver, he showed he could handle it when asked.

That gives us dynasty managers something to work with.



Denzel Boston • WR



66.1

ZAP Score

WASHINGTON
WEEKLY STARTER

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ
Height: 6'4 Weight: 212 NFL Team: TBD
Statistical Comps: Jayden Higgins ▪ Courtland Sutton ▪ Mike Williams

Denzel Boston is a prototypical X receiver who spent four seasons at Washington, overlapping early in his career with Rome Odunze, Jalen McMillan, and Ja'Lynn Polk. Unsurprisingly, he produced very little during those first two years.

Once that trio left, Boston emerged as one of Washington's primary options. He posted 63 and 62 receptions over his final two seasons and scored 20 touchdowns in that span.

On one hand, Boston's Breakout Score was naturally suppressed by sharing the field with NFL-caliber wideouts early in his career. On the other hand, even after they departed, the production wasn't overwhelming. In 2024, his receiving yards per team pass attempt mark was 2.00. Last year, it rose to 2.58 – 2.75 when adjusted for strength of schedule. That translated to a Breakout Score of 43.8, roughly the 60th percentile.

That's not bad. But for a possible first-round selection, it's not pristine either.

Within the ZAP Model database, among receivers who have played at least three NFL seasons, 12 were drafted in Round 1 with a Breakout Score between 30 and 60 – and Boston sits in the lower half of that band. That list includes Tavon Austin, Breshad Perriman, Kevin White, Phillip Dorsett, Josh Doctson, Laquon Treadwell, John Ross, Mike Williams, Calvin Ridley, Henry Ruggs, Kadarius Toney, and Zay Flowers.

Not the best.

You can reasonably grant Boston some leeway for the early-career target squeeze. But other advanced metrics are less forgiving. His career yards per route run, per PFF, was 2.02 – essentially average within this class. Since 2020, eight first-round wide receivers have entered the league with career yards per route runs below 2.20: Jalen Reagor, Jahan Dotson, Zay Flowers, Brian Thomas, Xavier Legette, Ricky Pearsall, Travis Hunter, and Matthew Golden.

That's not exactly elite company.

All of this may sound more negative than it truly is. Boston isn't far from the Elite Producer tier. In a slightly different career arc – with earlier opportunity – his Breakout Score likely climbs, and his ZAP score follows. That context matters.

Boston could be legitimate. The size, the boundary skill set, the touchdown production – those traits will boost his draft stock. But analytically, he carries more volatility than some of the receivers ranked ahead of him.

The upside is real. The range of outcomes just happens to be wide.



Chris Brazzell • WR



61.6

ZAP Score

TENNESSEE

WEEKLY STARTER

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'4 Weight: 198 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Josh Reynolds ▪ Denzel Mims ▪ George Pickens

The Tennessee offense hasn't been the easiest to evaluate under Josh Heupel, and we've got another wideout from the program in this class: Chris Brazzell.

Brazzell stands 6'4", 198 pounds – long, lean, and built to run. He used that frame to stress defenses vertically. Among wideouts in this class, he saw deep targets at a top-15 rate, and nearly 18% of his receptions came on those throws, a top-10 figure. His career average depth of target, per PFF, ranked top-five.

The usage fits the archetype. Brazzell lined up in the slot on fewer than 7% of his collegiate snaps, the lowest rate in the class. He's a true boundary receiver whose job was to stretch the field pretty often.

From a ZAP Model standpoint, the inputs are solid but not insane. After starting at Tulane, Brazzell transferred to Tennessee in 2024. His real breakout came in his final season, when he first cleared a 2.0 adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt mark. That resulted in a 45.7 Breakout Score, good for the 63rd percentile.

We've seen this type hit before. Bigger-bodied vertical receivers taken on Day 2 in recent years – Nico Collins, Tee Higgins, George Pickens, Christian Watson – show there's a real ceiling here.

The catch is that most of those hits came with stronger efficiency profiles than Brazzell's 2.09 career yards per route run. When you look around that threshold, you start getting into names like Denzel Mims or Cedric Tillman.

That's the tension with Brazzell. The upside is obvious. So is the volatility. And his comparables do a good job capturing that.



Germie Bernard • WR

 **60.4**

ZAP Score

ALABAMA

WEEKLY STARTER

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'1 Weight: 206 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Parris Campbell ▪ Mohamed Sanu ▪ Lynn Bowden

The ZAP Model likes Germie Bernard's versatility. Last season at Alabama, he frequently aligned in the backfield, finishing with 18 carries for over 100 rushing yards.

But Bernard didn't spend all four collegiate seasons in Tuscaloosa. He began at Michigan State in 2022, catching just four passes as a freshman, before transferring to Washington in 2023. There, he joined a loaded receiver room featuring Rome Odunze, Jalen McMillan, Ja'Lynn Polk, and fellow 2026 Combine invite Denzel Boston.

Impressively, Bernard carved out a role anyway. As a sophomore, he caught 34 passes from Michael Penix and added 13 carries for 43 yards and 2 scores. He out-targeted Boston 44 to 7 that season. Per PFF, Bernard posted a 1.90 yards per route run mark compared to Boston's 0.89.

After 2023, Bernard transferred again, finishing his career at Alabama. There, he cleared the 2.0 receiving yards per team pass attempt mark just once prior to strength-of-schedule adjustments. His Breakout Score settled at 40.4 – a 51st percentile figure. Solid, but not dominant.

Given the variety of ways Bernard was deployed, it's no surprise some of his touches were manufactured. That's not inherently negative – coaches were clearly trying to get him the ball – but there's risk baked into that archetype. Since 2020, 15 Day 2 wide receivers have seen 20% or more of their targets come from behind the line of scrimmage, like Bernard. The only clear hits (or projected hits) from that group are Rashee Rice, Wan'Dale Robinson, Ladd McConkey, and Luther Burden. The rest have largely disappointed.

NFL Mock Draft Database projects Bernard as a Day 2 pick. Historically, receivers drafted in that range who receive the rushing bonus in the model average about one additional PPR point per game across their first three seasons compared to those who don't.

The concern lies in the efficiency. Bernard's 1.90 career yards per route run is below the class average, and recent second- and third-round picks with sub-2.00 marks have struggled. Since 2020, Day 2 wide receivers in that bucket have underperformed their draft-capital-based B2S expectation by 1.6 PPR points per game.

Receivers like Bernard often need the right ecosystem. They're rarely plug-and-play dominators, but in creative offenses, they can become useful chess pieces.

Bernard isn't built on overwhelming production. But the versatility – and his ability to carve out roles in crowded rooms – keeps him somewhat intriguing. Though his comps leave a lot to be desired.



Elijah Sarratt • WR

 **57.4**

ZAP Score

INDIANA

FLEX PLAY

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'3 Weight: 210 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Michael Thomas ▪ Pat Bryant ▪ Rome Odunze

It's no surprise we're seeing Indiana wide receivers in this draft class given what that program has built over the last couple of seasons. Elijah Sarratt followed Curt Cignetti from James Madison to Indiana, finishing his career there, but his climb started well before that.

A zero-star recruit, Sarratt began at Saint Francis before breaking out with an 82-catch sophomore season at James Madison. He then transferred to Indiana and posted 53 receptions for 957 yards and 8 touchdowns in 2024.

That season marked Sarratt's best adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt, but the bigger takeaway is consistency. Across his three non-Saint Francis seasons, he posted marks between 2.58 and 2.75. He's one of only three wide receivers in this class with multiple adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt seasons above 2.5 – and the only one to do it three times.

The ZAP Model doesn't fully reward that steadiness, as Sarratt lands with a 51.0 Breakout Score (71st percentile), but the broader profile is strong. Sarratt posted a 2.56 career yards per route run (top-six in the class) and gained a first down on 12.5% of his routes, trailing only Makai Lemon.

There is some nuance, though. Reception Perception's Matt Harmon has flagged separation concerns, and the data offers mild support: over 28% of Sarratt's career targets were contested, per PFF.

That's not disqualifying – especially for a bigger-bodied receiver – but it does introduce volatility. Among Day 2 wideouts since 2020 with contested target rates above 25%, the range of outcomes includes Tee Higgins and Nico Collins on the high end, and players like Denzel Mims, Terrace Marshall, and Keon Coleman on the lower one. Alec Pierce and Michael Wilson have settled somewhere in between, but keep in mind that it took time for them to get there.

The lack of separation, however, could be why we're seeing Michael Thomas and Pat Bryant as top comps, two players who moved to more slot work in the NFL.

The ZAP Model views Sarratt favorably overall. Analytically, he may be the most intriguing bigger-bodied receiver outside of Round 1 in this class.

That doesn't eliminate the variance. It just frames it.



Zachariah Branch • WR

 **57.0**

ZAP Score

GEORGIA

FLEX PLAY

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 5'9 Weight: 177 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Mecole Hardman ▪ Tre Tucker ▪ Phillip Dorsett

Zachariah Branch weighs just 177 pounds, so it's no surprise that 77.5% of his routes came from the slot during his three-year collegiate career, the third-highest rate in this class.

That deployment was consistent across stops. At USC, his slot rates were 74% and 79% during his two seasons played there. After transferring to Georgia for his final year, that number stayed at 79%.

The speed and shiftiness pop immediately on film. That elusiveness is almost certainly driving his projected draft capital. But analytically, there are red flags.

Branch's production never truly got there. His raw receiving yards per team pass attempt failed to reach 2.0 in a season, and even when adjusted strength of schedule, he maxed out at 2.11. The result was a very ordinary 31.2 Breakout Score.

The usage profile is even more concerning. An enormous 45.5% of Branch's career targets came behind the line of scrimmage. That doesn't mean he can't grow into something more at the next level, but it does mean the projection requires a significant leap.

Historically, that's been dangerous territory. If Branch is selected inside the top 100 – as NFL Mock Draft Database currently projects – he'll be the 11th player drafted in that range since 2020 with a career behind-the-line target rate above 30%. And the first to exceed 40%. Only two players in that bucket – Wan'Dale Robinson and Luther Burden – posted Breakout Scores above 75. The others? Lynn Bowden, Amari Rodgers, Anthony Schwartz, Kadarius Toney, Rondale Moore, Velus Jones, Tre Tucker, and Malachi Corley.

Big yikes.

A large driver of that is screen usage, with over 35% of Branch's career yards came on screens. Among top-100 picks since 2020, only two wideouts saw over 30% of their career yardage total stem from screens: Malachi Corley and Anthony Schwartz.

Bigger yikes.

To put it bluntly, this archetype has burned teams before. If Branch receives strong draft capital and dynasty managers push him up rookie boards, it'll be a tough sell. That's especially true in an NFL that's leaned into heavier personnel packages, reducing the standalone fantasy dominance of pure slot specialists.

You can squint and see a Tyreek Hill-like prospect with Branch, but that's not something we should ever bank on.



Antonio Williams • WR

 **54.5**

ZAP Score

CLEMSON

FLEX PLAY

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'0 Weight: 187 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Ladd McConkey ▪ Markus Wheaton ▪ Roman Wilson

Antonio Williams has kind of a weird production profile. As a freshman at Clemson, he caught 56 passes for 604 yards and 4 touchdowns. On the surface, that looks strong – especially since he led the team in receptions and yards. But Clemson threw the ball 480 times that season, which muted the impact. His receiving yards per team pass attempt was just 1.26, so the Breakout Score didn't get much of a boost.

Injuries limited him to five games as a sophomore. Then, over his final two seasons – again at Clemson – his receiving yards per team pass attempt never exceeded 1.70.

In other words, Williams was consistently productive. He just never delivered a high-end season. That resulted in a 38.4 Breakout Score (48th percentile).

Historically, that's a tough needle to thread. Across the ZAP Model database, only seven wide receivers have posted a 12-plus PPR points-per-game season within their first three NFL campaigns after failing to record a max-season receiving yards per team pass attempt above 2.0. Williams topped out at 1.70.

Lower the threshold to 1.80, and the list shrinks to Tyreek Hill, Hunter Renfrow, Terry McLaurin, and Ladd McConkey. Hill won with generational traits. Renfrow's peak was short-lived. McConkey, ironically his top comp, had elite per-route efficiency that wasn't fully reflected in his raw team-share numbers. McLaurin is simply an outlier.

That context suggests Williams has an uphill analytical battle.

There are positives. He offers versatility – 25 carries for 187 rushing yards during his Clemson career and more than 40 punt returns. That multifaceted usage hints at ways he can carve out a role early.

The concern is role type. Williams ran nearly 80% of his routes from the slot in college. That type of deployment in the NFL would really limit his fantasy upside.

Williams looks like the type of player who can help a team move the chains and contribute in multiple phases. We should question how that translates to fantasy football, though, unless he finds a team very willing to pepper him with looks.

At least there's a nice top comparable to keep us interested.



Chris Bell • WR

 **54.4**

ZAP Score

LOUISVILLE

FLEX PLAY

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'2 Weight: 222 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Jonathan Mingo ▪ JJ Arcega-Whiteside ▪ DK Metcalf

You're going to hear this theme throughout the guide: big-bodied X receivers with average to above-average production profiles tend to bring variance. When they hit, they tilt leagues. When they miss, it's rough.

Chris Bell fits that archetype. At 222 pounds, he played almost exclusively on the boundary at Louisville and is projected to go as high as Round 2. His 48.2 Breakout Score is comfortably above average.

Historically, that combination lives in boom-or-bust territory. In the ZAP Model database, 10 wide receivers drafted after Round 1 and before Pick 100 weighed at least 215 pounds and posted a Breakout Score between 40 and 60. The list includes Courtland Sutton, DK Metcalf, Michael Pittman, and Tee Higgins – but also Greg Little, Devin Funchess, Dorial Green-Beckham, Chase Claypool, and Jonathan Mingo.

This is a go big or go home type of profile, folks.

Bell spent all four collegiate seasons at Louisville, and his production climbed each year: 0.29, 1.00, 1.73, and 2.59 in receiving yards per team pass attempt. That steady progression – paired with a tougher senior-year schedule – is doing heavy lifting for his Breakout Score.

There is an added wrinkle: Bell tore his ACL late in his senior campaign. That clouds his draft capital outlook and makes the evaluation a bit trickier.

Given his size, it's no surprise Bell lined up in the slot on just 8.9% of his routes. He's a true boundary receiver. The concern is efficiency. His perimeter yards per route run was only slightly above the class average, and 26.6% of his targets were charted as contested by PFF, a top-five rate among Combine invites. That could reflect quarterback trust, but it may also hint at separation challenges.

There are several big, high-variance perimeter bets in this class. Bell is firmly in that bucket. He's not at the top of the archetype for me, but he's certainly not at the bottom either.



Malachi Fields • WR

 **53.3**

ZAP Score

NOTRE DAME

FLEX PLAY

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'5 Weight: 218 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Mack Hollins ▪ Miles Boykin ▪ Michael Pittman

The concern with Malachi Fields' profile is simple: the production never truly arrived.

Fields began his collegiate career at Virginia in 2021, catching just 11 passes as a true freshman before suffering a foot injury that limited him to one game as a sophomore. His junior season showed promise – 58 receptions, 811 yards, and 5 touchdowns – resulting in a solid 2.24 adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt mark.

Unfortunately, that was the peak.

Fields played two more seasons – one at Virginia and one at Notre Dame – but neither delivered a stronger statistical campaign. For a player with five collegiate seasons, the lack of a serious breakout is notable.

And that's the crux of the issue.

Fields brings rare size at 6'5", 218 pounds, but his Breakout Score sits at a below-average 33.6. His best season in yards per route run was 2.20, ranking 34th among the 46 wide receivers in this class. His career mark was well below 2.0.

If Fields is selected on Day 2, as projected, he'll need to buck recent historical trends. Since 2020, only nine wide receivers drafted between Picks 33 and 100 posted a best-season yards per route run below 2.30. Fields falls short of that threshold, as you just read.

That group includes the following: Van Jefferson, Josh Palmer, Jonathan Mingo, Keon Coleman, Adonai Mitchell, Ja'Lynn Polk, Luke McCaffrey, Savion Williams, and Isaac TeSlaa.

There are a whole lot of draft busts in there.

There's size to dream on, but the body of work suggests he'll need significant development to outkick the profile. An older breakout and the absence of a truly elite season leave little analytical margin for error.



Ja’Kobi Lane • WR

 **46.8**

ZAP Score

SOUTHERN CALIFORNIA

FLEX PLAY

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'4 Weight: 200 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Justin Hunter ▪ Terrace Marshall ▪ Adonai Mitchell

Ja’Kobi Lane is one of just five early-declare wide receivers in this year’s class, spending all three collegiate seasons at USC. After catching just seven passes in six games as a freshman, he increased that total to 43 and 49 over his next two seasons.

The production profile, however, isn’t overly impressive. His 2024 adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt mark was just 1.14, rising to a respectable 2.35 as a junior. That best-season figure still ranked outside the top-20 in the class. The result was a 35.9 Breakout Score – a below-average number within the ZAP Model database.

To be fair, Lane shared the field with likely first-rounder Makai Lemon throughout his career, so Teammate Score is giving him a modest boost. But even accounting for that context, the résumé is fairly ordinary. His career yards per route run, per PFF, ranks 26th in the class. He was serviceable at generating first downs, but nothing in the production profile screams difference-maker.

Lane’s draft buzz likely stems from the role he could play for an NFL team. He has rare length for a prototypical X receiver, and that body type remains in high demand.

There are concerns, though. While long, Lane’s frame is leaner than you’d expect for a true contested-catch specialist – and that was a major part of his game in college. Among this year’s Combine invitees, Lane ranked first with a near 33% contested target rate. If he’s selected inside the top 100, as projected, he’d become just the fourth wideout since 2020 drafted in that range with a career contested target rate above 30%.

The other three? Josh Palmer, Nico Collins, and Alec Pierce. That’s not bad company. But each of those receivers entered the league with stronger Breakout Scores and more mass to support their contested-catch profiles. That likely aided in their transition into the NFL.

Lane isn’t a bad prospect. Early declaration plus physical tools always provide a path. But analytically, he profiles more as a bet on traits than on demonstrated production. And those bets tend to carry more variance than upside certainty.



Ted Hurst • WR

 **42.5**

ZAP Score

GEORGIA STATE

FLEX PLAY

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'4 Weight: 206 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Josh Malone ▪ Romeo Doubs ▪ Nico Collins

Ted Hurst (not related to Limp Bizkit's Fred Durst) joins Albert Wilson and Robert Davis as the only Georgia State wide receivers in the ZAP Model. While Hurst owns the best projected ZAP score of the trio, he also carries the weakest Breakout Score.

That's because the peak production never truly popped. He was steady across four seasons, but his best receiving yards per team pass attempt mark topped out at 2.14 – just 2.08 after strength-of-schedule adjustments. A 42.0 Breakout Score (54th percentile) is respectable, though it's more solid than special.

What stands out is in his usage. Hurst brings length and was deployed aggressively downfield during his collegiate career. His 28.6% career deep-ball target rate ranks top-10 in this class, and more than 21% of his receptions came on deep throws, fourth-highest among Combine invitees. That naturally drove a top-10 average depth of target.

The question is translation. Much of that production came against lower-tier competition.

Historically, that archetype has struggled to fully convert. Since 2020, 22 non-first-round wide receivers entered the league with at least 20% of their receptions on deep balls and a 25%-plus deep target rate. Only one – Nico Collins – posted a 12-plus PPR points-per-game season within their first three years.

Interestingly, Collins is one of Hurst's top-three comparables, even though he weighed a little more at the NFL Combine. So the potential is definitely there.

Hurst can find a role on a team, as his statistical comparables suggest. It wouldn't surprise me at all if he's a Day 2 pick given his size and the story you can tell. But we should at least be cautious about how this type of profile translates to the next level. Even with solid statistical comparables.



Skyler Bell • WR

 **40.6**

ZAP Score

CONNECTICUT

FLEX PLAY

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'0 Weight: 192 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Ricky Pearsall ▪ Luke McCaffrey ▪ Jaylin Lane

Skyler Bell played just one game as a freshman at Wisconsin, but he emerged in Year 2 with 30 receptions for 444 yards and 5 touchdowns. After a statistical dip as a junior, he transferred to UConn.

The production improved, as you'd expect. Over his two seasons with the Huskies, Bell posted prorated receiving yards per team pass attempt marks of 2.17 and 2.82. The problem is that UConn's strength of schedule pulled those numbers down after adjustment, and because Bell didn't hit his peak until later in his career, his Breakout Score sits at a mediocre 22.2.

Bell is maybe slightly undersized, but he played both inside and outside throughout his collegiate career. Interestingly, his perimeter yards per route run rate ended up a little higher than his slot mark.

The 2025 season is doing a lot of work for his draft projection. That 2.82 receiving yards per team pass attempt figure ranked top-10 in this class, and his 3.13 yards per route run was a top-five best-season mark among Combine invites.

Bell also has stuff going on beyond receiving in his profile. As a redshirt freshman at Wisconsin, he logged 13 carries for 160 yards. That usage didn't follow him to UConn, but it hints at his athletic profile – something that shows up in a fringe top-10 yards-after-the-catch mark within the class. That said, he wasn't particularly strong at forcing missed tackles, per PFF data.

Zooming out, despite the low Breakout Score, there's legitimate intrigue here. Bell can align across the formation and was targeted at multiple levels of the field.

The hesitation comes from the adjustments and the age. It's easier to post numbers at UConn than at Wisconsin, and Bell will be nearly 24 at draft time. That shouldn't remove him from our consideration set, but historically, many of fantasy football's true difference-makers enter the league younger.

Bell has traits, a strong final season, and a good top comparable. Keep a close eye on him throughout the draft process.



Eric McAlister • WR

 **36.6**

ZAP Score

TEXAS CHRISTIAN

BENCHWARMER

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'4 Weight: 194 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Tory Horton ▪ Cedrick Wilson ▪ Ricky White

Texas Christian wide receivers haven't exactly inspired confidence lately. Since 2020, we've seen Jalen Reagor, Derius Davis, Quentin Johnston, Savion Williams, and Jack Bech enter the league from there. There's a very real chance none of them ultimately outperform their draft-capital-based B2S expectation.

Eric McAlister could be next up in late April's draft. Interestingly, though, he owns the second-best Breakout Score of that group, trailing only Quentin Johnston. And just barely – Johnston posted a 76.6, McAlister sits at 75.0.

McAlister actually has the second-best Breakout Score in this entire class.

That's either exciting...or mildly terrifying.

Breakout Score is predictive, especially in the earlier portions of the draft. But once you move into the Day 3 range, chaos tends to take over. Draft capital itself barely matters after Pick 170 or 180.

McAlister's Breakout Score is impressive. It would just be more impressive if he were projected inside the top 100 picks instead of Round 5 or 6.

How did McAlister get there? Well, he spent two seasons at Boise State before transferring to TCU for his final two years. As a sophomore at Boise, he caught 47 passes for 873 yards and 5 touchdowns in just nine games. That prorated to a massive 3.56 adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt (3.65 raw), which supercharged his Breakout Score.

McAlister never quite reached that level again, but his final-season adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt of 2.78 was still strong – it would rank 10th in this class.

Historically, Day 3 receivers with strong Breakout Scores have at least offered mild optimism. Among 230-plus wideouts drafted after Pick 100 from 2011 through 2023 (that gives them three-year NFL samples), only 25 posted a Breakout Score above 60. That group outperformed its draft-capital-based B2S expectation by 1.8 PPR points per game. The rest, predictably, underperformed.

The odds of McAlister becoming a long-term fantasy staple are slim. Day 3 receivers always face steep odds. But if you're taking swings late in rookie drafts, betting on strong underlying production is rarely the wrong way to do it.



Brenen Thompson • WR

 **35.7**

ZAP Score

MISSISSIPPI STATE

BENCHWARMER

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 5'9 Weight: 164 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Tank Dell ▪ Calvin Austin ▪ JJ Nelson

Brenen Thompson spent one year at Texas, two at Oklahoma, and one at Mississippi State, where he finished his college career. He didn't eclipse 250 receiving yards in a season until that final campaign, when he broke out for 57 receptions, 1,054 yards, and 6 touchdowns.

That's the textbook definition of a late breakout. And it shows in a 35.4 Breakout Score, a 41st percentile mark.

Size is the bigger concern for fantasy. At 5'9", 164 pounds, Thompson falls into a bucket that historically hasn't produced many true difference-makers. In the ZAP Model database, the only sub-180-pound wide receivers to post a 15-plus PPR points-per-game season within their first three years are first-rounders DeVonta Smith and Jordan Addison. Smaller receivers can still offer usable production – think Josh Downs or Darnell Mooney – but many of those mini-hits came with significantly stronger Breakout Scores than Thompson's.

That said, his size shouldn't automatically remove him from consideration. Interestingly, he barely played in the slot in college, running just 12.2% of his routes there, per PFF. On only 86 slot routes, though, he posted a ridiculous 4.15 yards per route run, the highest mark in the class. It's a small sample, but it suggests some untapped deployment flexibility.

And then there's the 4.26 speed. His ability to stress defenses vertically – Thompson posted the fifth-highest deep-ball target rate in the class – could boost his draft capital. And if that happens, his ZAP score will rise with it. NFL teams covet that type of field-stretching juice, and stronger investment increases the odds he earns early snaps.

Just don't let the athleticism cloud the bigger picture. As we know, teams often overdraft this kind of speed.

Thompson is intriguing – his comps are actually pretty fun, all things considered – but the overall profile still calls for tempered expectations.



Bryce Lance • WR

 **34.8**

ZAP Score

NORTH DAKOTA STATE

BENCHWARMER

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'3 Weight: 204 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Jehu Chesson ▪ Kenny Golladay ▪ Marquez Valdes-Scantling

There's no "bloodline" metric in the ZAP Model, which is probably a good thing for Bryce Lance, whose brother is former first-round pick Trey Lance.

There is a Breakout Score, though. And Bryce Lance didn't record one.

Lance spent five years at North Dakota State, redshirting as a true freshman before primarily playing special teams as a redshirt freshman and sophomore. Through the 2023 season, he had caught just one collegiate pass. At a powerhouse FCS program, he didn't see meaningful production until his fourth year on campus when he was past his 23rd birthday.

Lance's final two seasons were a different story, to be clear. He posted a 2.70 prorated receiving yards per team pass attempt mark in 2024 and followed that with a massive 4.00 rate in 2025.

That's where the model's adjustments come in. Once strength of opponent is overlayed, that 4.00 drops below 2.50. And it stands as the only meaningful adjusted season of his career. With such a late spike, there's no Breakout Score for Lance.

Failing to register a Breakout Score isn't rare. Failing to do so and still becoming fantasy relevant is. Among 100-plus wide receivers in the ZAP Model without a Breakout Score, only Hunter Renfrow, Tyreek Hill, and Terry McLaurin have posted a double-digit PPR points-per-game season within their first three years. Hill is a unicorn. McLaurin had strong draft capital. Renfrow's peak was short-lived.

Lance does have traits. At 6'3", 204 pounds, he brings size, and his career 3.07 yards per route run ranks at the top of this class. But that number lacks context. Since 2020, wide receivers without a Breakout Score who entered the league with a career yards per route run above 2.0 – a much lower threshold than Lance's – have produced zero hits out of eight players. Even expanding the pool to those with a Breakout Score of 30.0 or worse, Christian Watson – another North Dakota State product – is the only one to deliver even an eight-PPR-point-per-game season early in his career.

Could the adjustments be too harsh? Possibly. We should be open to the idea that Lance gets good capital and is someone we're fine with drafting, as long as his average draft position is reasonable. The size-speed combination is evident.

But this is undeniably a late-breakout profile. And historically, that's been a tough bet in fantasy football.



Reggie Virgil • WR

 **33.8**

ZAP Score

TEXAS TECH

BENCHWARMER

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'3 Weight: 187 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Ihmir Smith-Marsette ▪ Devontez Walker ▪ Tai Felton

Reggie Virgil spent three seasons at Miami of Ohio before transferring to Texas Tech in 2025. The early production was quiet – just two receptions across his first two years. As a junior, though, he flashed with a 2.20 receiving yards per team pass attempt mark, which translated to a respectable 40.9 Breakout Score.

The problem is that the production didn't meaningfully elevate once he moved to the Big 12 in 2025.

Virgil has a lean frame and was frequently deployed as a vertical threat. Among the 46 wide receiver Combine invites this year, his career deep-ball target rate and average depth of target both ranked third-highest. That role helps explain why his first downs per route run was so low – he was operating in a true boom-or-bust capacity.

From a fantasy perspective, that's concerning. Since 2020, there have been 12 wide receivers in the ZAP Model with a career deep-ball rate above 30% and a first downs per route run rate below 8%. Not one of them has become close to fantasy relevant.

Could Virgil buck the trend and carve out a field-stretching role in the NFL? Sure. Teams always need ways to thin out defenses. But historically, that archetype has struggled to translate into consistent fantasy production.

More likely than not, Virgil will end up as a depth receiver who helps an NFL offense in specific packages. He's probably not someone who will meaningfully impact rookie drafts.



Kevin Coleman • WR

 **33.4**

ZAP Score

MISSOURI

BENCHWARMER

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 5'10 Weight: 179 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Joe Adams ▪ Richie James ▪ Diontae Johnson

Kevin Coleman traveled everywhere in college. He began at Jackson State in 2022, transferred to Louisville, then moved to Mississippi State, and finally finished at Missouri in 2025.

Coleman's best season came at Mississippi State. As a junior, he posted a 2.53 receiving yards per team pass attempt mark, which jumped to 2.86 after strength-of-schedule adjustments. That performance fueled a 48.2 Breakout Score, seventh-best in this class.

At 180 pounds, though, Coleman profiles as a true slot. Over 91% of his career routes came from that area of the field, the highest rate in the class. And that wasn't scheme-specific – four different programs deployed him the same way, with slot rates of 87% or higher at each stop.

That level of slot specialization can be limiting from a fantasy standpoint. Since 2020, wide receivers drafted with a 90% slot rate or higher include KJ Hamler, KJ Hill, Dazz Newsome, Jaelon Darden, Kyle Philips, Derius Davis, Tre Tucker, Malachi Corley, and Jimmy Horn. Draft capital wasn't strong for that group, but it's unlikely to be for Coleman either, with current projections placing him as a Day 3 pick.

Coleman can carve out a role on special teams and in the slot at the next level. The question is ceiling. In a league increasingly leaning into heavier personnel and flexible alignments, pure slot specialists without standout draft capital tend to lack fantasy football upside.



Deion Burks • WR

 **33.3**

ZAP Score

OKLAHOMA

BENCHWARMER

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 5'10 Weight: 180 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Hunter Renfrow ▪ Travis Benjamin ▪ TJ Graham

Projected draft capital is doing heavy lifting in Deion Burks' profile, because the production doesn't stand out.

Burks spent three seasons at Purdue before transferring to Oklahoma for two more. Across that five-year career, his adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt never reached 2.0. He did manage a 34.6 Breakout Score, but that's more middling than encouraging.

The deeper efficiency numbers are even tougher. Burks posted a 1.35 career yards per route run rate, third-worst in this class. Since 2020, the ZAP Model has tracked 24 wide receivers entering the league with career yards per route run below 1.50. The only one to provide any meaningful fantasy production from that group is Josh Palmer. And are we even rostering him in dynasty at this point?

Burks' deployment adds another layer of uncertainty. In two of his seasons, he ran over 85% of his routes from the slot. In two others, he was below 25%. Given his smaller frame, the slot feels like the probable NFL home.

That's where things get even more concerning. His slot yards per route run sits at just 1.14 – bottom-six in this class.

There's not much analytical support here. If Burks sneaks into Day 2, that will be the primary argument in his favor. Otherwise, he profiles as a late-round rookie draft flier. And even then, there may be stronger bets on the board.



Barion Brown • WR

 **26.4**

ZAP Score

LOUISIANA STATE

WAIVER WIRE ADD

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 5'11 Weight: 177 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Jalen Cropper ▪ Bo Melton ▪ Josh Stewart

Barion Brown is fast. Legit fast. A former track athlete, he was heavily involved as a kick and punt returner across four collegiate seasons – three at Kentucky and one at LSU. He showed off that speed at the Combine, running a 4.40 40.

And, all things considered, the production profile isn't terrible.

At his size and with his speed, he likely projects as more of a gadget or space-oriented receiver at the next level. Historically, those players aren't consistent fantasy league-winners.

But there's at least something to work with. Brown posted a 1.97 adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt mark as a freshman – the best season of his career – which helped generate a 47.6 Breakout Score (66th percentile). That's a strong number.

Brown's usage looks exactly how you'd expect for a player with his profile. He ranked top-10 among Combine-invited wide receivers in both behind-the-line and deep-ball target rates. Roughly 18% of his collegiate receiving yards came on screens – comfortably a top-10 figure in this class.

In other words, most of his opportunities came on manufactured touches or vertical shots. That doesn't scream nuanced route technician – it suggests a player offenses were trying to scheme into space or send downfield to generate explosives.

Again...speed.

There's intrigue because traits like his are rare enough to warrant attention. But this archetype tends to require overwhelming athletic dominance to truly hit in fantasy. Brown has juice. The question is whether it's enough to overcome the limitations in his route profile and overall usage history.



Kendrick Law • WR

 **25.4**

ZAP Score

KENTUCKY

WAIVER WIRE ADD

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 5'11 Weight: 203 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Kaelin Clay ▪ Juwann Winfree ▪ Chris Moore

The ZAP Model isn't fond of Kendrick Law. He failed to register a Breakout Score, and he's not expected to go early in the draft.

But his profile is undeniably unique.

Law spent three seasons at Alabama doing very little as a receiver – just 33 total catches and no meaningful efficiency spike. He transferred to Kentucky in 2025 and had his most productive year, catching 53 passes for 540 yards. That translated to a 1.47 receiving yards per team pass attempt mark, the fourth-worst top season in this class.

So why is he even interesting?

Because stylistically, he's a bruiser. Law forced 0.35 missed tackles per reception – the best rate among Combine invites. Nearly half of his targets (49.5%) came behind the line of scrimmage, per PFF, the second-highest rate in the class. Roughly 44% of his career receiving yards came on screens, and his average depth of target was the lowest in this year's group.

This was a manufactured-touch profile through and through.

There's a world where an NFL team leans into that and deploys Law as a gadget weapon. And that kind of role can do something in real football.

Fantasy is another story.

Since 2020, the only ZAP Model receivers with 25% or more of their yards coming from screens are Lynn Bowden, Anthony Schwartz, Derius Davis, and Malachi Corley. Remember, Law was at nearly 50%. That's not exactly a list of league-winners.

Still, there are a few of these quirky, gadget-leaning profiles in this class, and Law could realistically become the best value of that bunch. If he lands in a creative offense and earns early manufactured touches, there's at least some theoretical upside at a cheap rookie draft cost.

Just understand what you're buying. This is a scheme-dependent bet.



Jeff Caldwell • WR

 **24.8**

ZAP Score

CINCINNATI

WAIVER WIRE ADD

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'5 Weight: 216 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Da'Quan Felton ▪ Marcell Ateman ▪ Tyre Brady

Jeff Caldwell might be the biggest size-speed outlier in this entire class. He's 6'5", 216 pounds, and ran a 4.31 at the Combine. On top of that, he posted the second-best broad jump and vertical among wide receiver invitees. That's absurd movement at that frame.

Those testing numbers probably shifted him from fringe-undrafted territory into "someone will take a shot" range.

But Caldwell's outlook is almost entirely traits-based.

Caldwell began his career at Lindenwood in 2022, and he stayed there for three seasons. On the surface, a 3.24 receiving yards per team pass attempt mark in 2024 looks impressive. Once adjusted for strength of competition, though, it falls below 2.0. We have to always remember that raw dominance at a lower level doesn't carry the same signal.

Caldwell transferred to Cincinnati for his final season and finished with 32 catches for 478 yards and 6 touchdowns. His 1.31 receiving yards per team pass attempt there didn't move the needle analytically.

The result is a 29th percentile Breakout Score and a best-season adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt of 1.94. That's not the kind of production profile that typically overcomes mid-to-late-round draft capital.

However, there's no denying the athletic profile. Caldwell's one of the best athletes we've seen come out of the Combine. It's rare. But historically, betting on testing without meaningful, translatable production is tough.

Unless draft capital comes in far stronger than expected, Caldwell is more of a last-round rookie draft dart throw than someone you need to prioritize.



Josh Cameron • WR

 **23.0**

ZAP Score

BAYLOR

WAIVER WIRE ADD

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'2 Weight: 220 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Travis Fulgham ▪ Amara Darboh ▪ Michael Wilson

Josh Cameron often looks like a running back playing wide receiver. He's got a thick, sturdy build, and Baylor leaned into that across his five seasons there. He wasn't used out of the backfield much, but he also wasn't asked to win deep – his career deep-ball target rate was the second-lowest in this class. His average depth of target sat a bit higher because he lived in that intermediate range.

Cameron is more of a traits bet than a production one. He'll be past his 23rd birthday at draft time, and he had five seasons to post a truly strong receiving yards per team pass attempt mark. It never happened. His best adjusted season came in at 1.90, and that translated to a 28.1 Breakout Score – just 30th percentile in the model.

The ZAP Model isn't overly enthusiastic. But one input does quietly like him: adjusted fantasy points per game. Among the 46 Combine invite wideouts, Cameron ranks 15th in that metric after age and schedule adjustments. That at least tells us he wasn't *totally* unproductive.

There are some interesting attributes here – size, play strength, and a profile that suggests he can handle physical work over the middle. Cameron just never showed high-end dominance.

Cameron is the type of player who could hang around as a depth receiver and surprise if things break right. But unless the draft really swings in his favor, he's not someone you need to aggressively prioritize in rookie drafts.



CJ Daniels • WR

 **22.8**

ZAP Score

MIAMI (FL)

WAIVER WIRE ADD

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'2 Weight: 202 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Dez Fitzpatrick ▪ Jalen Tolbert ▪ Chimere Dike

My three-year-old son's favorite wide receiver in this class is CJ Daniels. And that's strictly because my son's name is CJ.

The ZAP Model does not share his enthusiasm.

Daniels' College Football Reference page reads like a 700-page novel. He spent four years at Liberty, where his only truly meaningful production came in Year 4. That season was legitimately impressive: a 3.14 adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt mark – the fourth-best max-season number in this class – which helped fuel a strong 47.3 Breakout Score.

The issue? Every other season he played was below 1.70 in that metric.

After Liberty, Daniels transferred to LSU for a year, then finished at Miami. That's six collegiate seasons. He'll be 24 when the draft rolls around.

Late breakouts can work, but they usually need draft capital support. In the ZAP Model database, 32 wide receivers failed to go top-100 while posting a Breakout Score below 60 but a best-season adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt above 3.0. In other words, they had one monster efficiency year, but age suppressed the overall breakout profile.

Of those 32 players, 30 never even reached 7 PPR points per game in any of their first three seasons.

Then there's the age bucket itself. Prior to this class, 35 wide receivers entered the league at age 24 or older. Only one – John Brown – produced a 10-plus PPR points-per-game season within his first three years. Brown also had top-100 draft capital, something Daniels isn't likely to receive.

Now, could the model be a little too mean towards older prospects given the NIL era, transfer portal freedom, and COVID eligibility ripple effects? That's fair to consider. College football has changed.

But it's also fair to acknowledge that Daniels really only gave us one high-end season across six years.

There's juice in that peak campaign. But the rest of the profile is just thin.



De'Zhaun Stribling • WR

 **22.3**

ZAP Score

MISSISSIPPI

WAIVER WIRE ADD

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'2 Weight: 207 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Charone Peake ▪ Jordan Payton ▪ Cornelius Johnson

With the modern transfer portal era, some players end up building résumés across half the country. De'Zhaun Stribling is one of them. He began at Washington State, transferred to Oklahoma State for two seasons, and finished in 2025 at Ole Miss.

The analytical profile is...fine. He posted a 28.5 Breakout Score, driven by a 2024 season where his adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt cleared 2.0. That was his high-water mark. In 2025 at Ole Miss, he dropped back to 1.70.

Nothing really jumps off the page. His 18.3% deep-ball target rate was below average in this class, yet his contested target rate was above average – a combination that can hint at separation concerns rather than pure vertical specialization.

If there's momentum behind Stribling, it may stem from timing. He had several strong showings on big stages: 5 catches for 79 yards and a score against Tulane in the College Football Playoff, 7 for 122 against Georgia, and 5 for 77 in a loss to Miami. Three of his top-four yardage games came in high-visibility spots, and he also went for 96 earlier in the season against Georgia.

Those flashes matter for some evaluators. They just don't override the broader body of work.

Unless draft capital surprises in a meaningful way, Stribling isn't someone you'll need to prioritize in rookie drafts.



Aaron Anderson • WR



21.3

ZAP Score

LOUISIANA STATE

WAIVER WIRE ADD

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 5'8 Weight: 191 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Braxton Berrios ▪ Tommy Shuler ▪ Bralon Addison

There are four LSU wide receivers at the NFL Combine this year, but all of them are projected to go on Day 3 – including Aaron Anderson.

Anderson began his career at Alabama, redshirting as a freshman before transferring to LSU. He then spent three seasons in Baton Rouge, where his production profile settled in as below average. His best adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt was 1.88, which translated to a 25.5 Breakout Score.

That's not moving the needle much analytically.

To his credit, Anderson posted the best yards per route run figures among the LSU wideouts in this class. His 2.07 career yards per route run is slightly above the class average among Combine invites. But that efficiency came almost entirely from the slot – he ran over 88% of his routes from there, the second-highest slot rate in the class.

That archetype hasn't treated us well recently.

Since 2020, there have been 12 wide receivers in the ZAP Model database with a Breakout Score below 40 and a career slot rate above 80%. None of them have reached 10 PPR points per game in one of their first three seasons. And two of those players were top-100 picks. Anderson likely won't get that kind of draft capital boost.

It's hard to see a clear path to fantasy relevance here. Anderson could carve out a depth role as a slot specialist, but from a rookie draft perspective, this isn't a profile you need to prioritize.



Dillon Bell • WR



17.9

ZAP Score

GEORGIA
DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'1 Weight: 209 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Deondre Douglas ▪ Keon Hatcher ▪ Zach Pascal

The ZAP Model database now has six wide receivers with the last name Bell. Three of them are in this 2026 class.

That's analytics.

Dillon Bell is generally viewed as the least exciting of the trio. He spent four seasons at Georgia – which is never a bad line on the résumé – but he never topped 466 receiving yards in a season. His best-year receiving yards per team pass attempt was under 1.0. Before this cycle, the ZAP Model had seen only nine wide receivers with a max-season mark that low. The only player even remotely relevant in fantasy was Russell Gage.

That's tough company.

Where Bell gets interesting is in the versatility bucket. Like several others in this class, he was used as a Swiss Army knife in college. Unlike many of them, he brings legitimate size to the table.

At Georgia, Bell logged 51 carries for 373 yards and 5 touchdowns. His usage lines up with that profile – he had one of the lower average depths of target in the class, and 18.4% of his collegiate receiving yards came on screens, sixth-highest among Combine-invited wide receivers.

You'll probably hear Deebo Samuel comparisons tossed around with Bell. Archetype-wise, it's understandable. But Samuel entered the league with far stronger receiving production, and he had premium draft capital. Bell would need both opportunity and development to align perfectly to approach that kind of NFL impact.

Bell's not devoid of intrigue. Big, versatile players with backfield utility always catch attention.

But analytically, this is a long runway bet.



Kaden Wetjen • WR



15.6

ZAP Score

IOWA

DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 5'9 Weight: 193 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Kaelin Clay ▪ Marcus Green ▪ Johnnie Dixon

Chances are, whoever drafts Kaden Wetjen is doing so with special teams in mind. He returned 56 kicks and 54 punts during his three seasons at Iowa – after beginning his career at Iowa Western Community College – and his return work earned him the 2024 Jet Award as the nation's top return specialist.

That's the selling point.

From a receiving standpoint, Wetjen is one of the least productive wide receivers in ZAP Model history. He does get a bump for versatility – late-round prospects with any sort of differentiating trait tend to look slightly better in the model than pure replacement-level profiles.

But the résumé through the air is extremely thin. Wetjen caught just 23 passes across three seasons at Iowa, and over 54% of his targets came behind the line of scrimmage. That aligns with how he was used: get him the ball in space and let him create. Unsurprisingly, he left college without a Breakout Score.

Wetjen actually owns the second-lowest best-season adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt mark in the ZAP Model database. His best-season adjusted fantasy points per game also ranks in the bottom two. And that's out of hundreds of wide receivers.

That's...not encouraging.

To his credit, he reportedly impressed at the Shrine Bowl, and Iowa's offense hasn't exactly been known for high-volume passing attacks. But historically, when collegiate receiving production is this limited, the NFL fantasy translation rate is near zero.

Wetjen has a unique profile. It's just one that's far more likely to matter in the return game than in your rookie drafts.

Eric Rivers • WR



14.6

ZAP Score

GEORGIA TECH

DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 5'10

Weight: 176

NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Daniel Braverman ▪ Jalen Nailor ▪ Terry Godwin

Eric Rivers owns the second-best single-season yards per route run mark in this class. Seriously. His career yards per route run sits at 2.40 – eighth-best among Combine invite wide receivers.

So... do we have something here?

Probably not.

Rivers will turn 24 in September, putting him on the older side of the prospect spectrum. He played two years at Memphis with minimal production, transferred to Florida International for two more, and then finished at Georgia Tech. That eye-popping 3.57 yards per route run season came in his second year at FIU. The seasons surrounding it? 1.32 and 2.07.

One of those years is not like the others.

That outlier campaign was strong enough to earn him a 32.8 Breakout Score, which isn't nothing for a projected Day 3 pick. But it's not particularly impressive either – especially for a 176-pound receiver.

We saw a ceiling season, sure. But it came at FIU, not exactly against elite competition. When you zoom out, this looks more like a one-year spike than a sustainably dominant profile.



Zavion Thomas • WR



13.3

ZAP Score

LOUISIANA STATE

DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 5'10 Weight: 190 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Jeremy Kerley ▪ Ray-Ray McCloud ▪ Isaiah Burse

Carnell Tate is the only receiver in this class younger than Zavion Thomas. The difference? Thomas isn't an early declare. He spent two seasons at Mississippi State and two more at LSU.

For a Day 3-type prospect, Thomas is at least somewhat interesting.

The problem is the receiving backbone, which is no small deal. He failed to register a Breakout Score despite being one of the youngest players in the class. His best season in receiving yards per team pass attempt never cleared 1.60, a threshold that all but five wide receivers in this class surpassed.

That's a tough starting point. Historically, only three wide receivers in ZAP Model history have reached 12 PPR points per game in one of their first three seasons without registering a Breakout Score.

So no, we shouldn't be projecting some massive ceiling.

But, look, once you get into Day 3 territory, it's hard to find any meaningful analytical hooks. Thomas at least brings speed and versatility. He carried the ball 40 times for 198 yards in college and handled 60 punt returns and 35 kick returns. That profile screams gadget piece – someone who could carve out a role in the right offense and maybe give you the occasional spike week.

The receiving efficiency just isn't there, though. His 1.52 career yards per route run, per PFF, ranks sixth-worst in the class. Out wide, he was even less effective, posting the fourth-worst perimeter yards per route run mark among Combine invites.

The pass-catching profile leaves a lot to be desired.

Still, for a late-round dart throw, at least there's speed and multi-phase utility to hang your hat on. That's more than you can say for some of the names in this range.



Caleb Douglas • WR



13.1

ZAP Score

TEXAS TECH
DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'4 Weight: 206 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Mekale McKay ▪ Geronimo Allison ▪ Kaden Prather

There's not a lot to get excited about with Caleb Douglas. At least from an analytical perspective – I'm sure he's a good dude. He got some love at the Senior Bowl, but the overall profile really isn't that strong.

Douglas spent two seasons at Florida before transferring to Texas Tech for two more. He did register a Breakout Score due to his time with the Red Raiders, but his adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt never exceeded 1.84 in a single season, resulting in a modest 23.3 Breakout Score.

The efficiency metrics don't offer much encouragement either. His overall yards per route run ranked in the bottom half of the class, and his perimeter yards per route run was bottom-10 at just 1.65. For a 6'3" receiver expected to live on the boundary, that's concerning. Since 2020, the most notable Day 3 wide receiver at 6'3" or taller with a sub-1.80 perimeter yards per route run mark is probably Devaughn Vele.

That's not exactly a high bar.

Douglas' size will likely earn him a look late in the draft. Teams always bet on length and catch radius. And, like I said at the top, some really liked what he brought to the Senior Bowl.

But from a fantasy perspective, the profile offers very little historical optimism. Barring surprisingly strong draft capital, it's difficult to see a clear path to meaningful production.



Harrison Wallace • WR



12.1

ZAP Score

MISSISSIPPI

DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'0	Weight: 192	NFL Team: TBD
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Statistical Comps: Tony Jones ▪ Malik Knowles ▪ Cam Phillips

It's tough to find an analytical hook in Harrison Wallace's profile that screams upside. His Breakout Score sits below 30, he'll already be 23 by draft day, his career yards per route run is just 1.86, and his best adjusted fantasy points per game season topped out at 12.7. He gained a first down on only 8.9% of his routes – an ordinary rate – and he doesn't bring overwhelming size to compensate.

Across the board, it's hard to build a strong fantasy case.

Wallace spent four years at Penn State before transferring to Ole Miss for his final season. He didn't clear 300 receiving yards in any of his first three seasons with the Nittany Lions, and while his final two years produced adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt marks of 2.00 and 1.96, those are more "fine" than impactful. Just 14% of his routes came out of the slot, so he was mostly deployed as a perimeter guy.

But there's just not much separation in the data – literally or figuratively.

Wallace *might* hear his name called late in the draft, but even if he does, the profile suggests a depth receiver fighting for a roster spot rather than someone likely to matter in fantasy formats.



Colbie Young • WR



12.0

ZAP Score

GEORGIA
DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'5 Weight: 218 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Marcell Ateman ▪ Jamal Custis ▪ Bryce Ford-Wheaton

We've only had six wide receivers in the ZAP Model database average 14 or more PPR points per game in one of their first three seasons after being drafted outside the top 100: Allen Hurns, Martavis Bryant, Tyreek Hill, Hunter Renfrow, Amon-Ra St. Brown, and Puka Nacua.

That's rare air.

And if you know those names, you know there's no consistent size archetype there. So Colbie Young checking in at 6'5'' and 218 pounds might intrigue an NFL team, but it doesn't completely move the needle for fantasy purposes.

Young is projected as a Day 3 pick out of Georgia. He spent two seasons there after two at Miami and one at a place everyone's heard of called Lackawanna College.

Across those five years, the production never truly materialized. Even at Lackawanna, against lesser competition, Young posted just a 1.68 prorated receiving yards per team pass attempt mark as a freshman. Once adjusted, that just faded into irrelevance.

His best adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt season came last year at 1.68 – as an almost 23-year-old. Because of the age-adjusted component and the modest efficiency, he failed to register a Breakout Score.

Young posted elevated deep-ball and behind-the-line target rates, suggesting teams were trying to scheme him explosive touches. He also forced missed tackles at an above-average rate within the class, which hints at some after-the-catch ability.

But zooming out, this is a long-odds bet. Day 3 receivers with limited production and no Breakout Score rarely turn into fantasy difference-makers.

Young may get a shot based on size and flashes. The odds of it turning into something meaningful for fantasy, though, are slim.



Chase Roberts • WR



11.0

ZAP Score

BRIGHAM YOUNG
DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'3 Weight: 209 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Andrei Iosivas ▪ J'Mon Moore ▪ Javon Wims

The last time a BYU wide receiver was drafted was 2023. You might've heard of him – Puka Nacua.

Those are pretty large shoes to fill for Chase Roberts.

Let's be clear, though: Roberts is almost certainly not the next Nacua.

For starters, he'll be 25 at draft time. In ZAP Model history, only four wide receivers have entered the league at 25 or older. The most notable recent example is Devaughn Vele – and even that's more “solid depth piece” than fantasy cornerstone.

Like Vele, Roberts is older largely because of a mission trip out of high school, which delayed his collegiate timeline. That context is important to know, but age still feeds directly into the model. Because of it, Roberts didn't register a Breakout Score. If we pretend he entered college immediately and was 23 instead of 25, his Breakout Score would've been 30.9, which isn't *amazing* anyway.

At BYU, Roberts improved each season, peaking at a 2.39 adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt mark in 2025. He was a reliable presence in the offense, finishing with the sixth-highest first downs per route run rate in this class.

Roberts has solid size and played both inside and outside in college. Most impressively, his perimeter yards per route run was 2.61 – fifth-best in the class. That's not nothing.

The age is what drags this profile down more than anything else. Without it, Roberts would still be more “interesting Day 3 flier” than priority target, but there'd be less friction.



Vinny Anthony • WR



10.4

ZAP Score

WISCONSIN
DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'0 Weight: 183 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: James Quick ▪ Jarrod West ▪ Tyron Johnson

Vinny Anthony spent four years at Wisconsin and topped 400 receiving yards in just one of them. That junior-season spike was enough to get him to a 33.5 Breakout Score, but that's about where the optimism peaks.

From there, the profile gets shaky.

Anthony's best single-season yards per route run mark was a respectable 2.29, but the consistency and drive-ending impact just weren't there. Anthony gained a first down on only 6.4% of his routes in college, the fourth-worst rate in this year's class.

Historically, that's a major red flag.

Since 2020, the ZAP Model has logged 32 wide receivers drafted outside the top 100 with first downs per route run rates below 7%. Not one of them reached 10 PPR points per game in one of their first three seasons. In fact, all but two failed to even hit 3.0 PPR points per game.

You can get that kind of production off the waiver wire. Even in dynasty leagues.

Anthony could carve out a depth role, but from a fantasy perspective, the odds of him becoming someone you're confidently starting on Sundays are extremely slim.



Emmanuel Henderson • WR



9.3

ZAP Score

KANSAS
DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'1 Weight: 185 NFL Team: TBD
Statistical Comps: Josh Harper ▪ James Quick ▪ Ja'Corey Brooks

Among the 46 wide receivers invited to this year's NFL Combine, Emmanuel Henderson ranked second with a 40.5% career deep-ball target rate. He was also fourth in collegiate average depth of target.

What's interesting is that Henderson wasn't strictly a boundary-only player. He ran about 36% of his routes from the slot, which is a fairly healthy rate for someone with that kind of downfield profile.

Henderson's college path took him to Alabama for three seasons before transferring to Kansas for his final year. At Alabama, there was essentially no meaningful receiving production – he caught just five passes across three seasons. His final year there resulted in an adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt rate of 0.28.

Kansas is where things finally clicked. In 2025, he caught 45 passes for 766 yards and 5 touchdowns, posting a 2.39 adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt. That was enough to get him on the board with a Breakout Score, but it was just 21.1.

So we've got one productive season, and it came late.

Henderson also contributed in the return game, bringing back 18 kicks for 455 yards and a touchdown in his final season. That special teams juice could play a role in NFL outlook.

But from a fantasy perspective, this is a historically fragile archetype. Since 2020, 17 wide receivers have entered the league with a deep-ball target rate of 35% or higher. Henderson was north of 40%. None of those 17 averaged 10 or more PPR points per game in one of their first three seasons.

When a player's offensive profile is heavily tilted toward vertical shots, it usually signals a limited route tree and volatile usage.

Henderson could carve out a role as a speed-based rotational receiver and special teams contributor. That can absolutely help an NFL team. Fantasy managers, though, shouldn't expect much beyond the occasional splash play.



Jordan Hudson • WR



9.0

ZAP Score

SOUTHERN METHODIST

DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'1 Weight: 191 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Drew Morgan ▪ Levi Norwood ▪ James Quick

Jordan Hudson was a highly recruited prospect who chose Texas Christian out of high school. He spent the 2022 season at TCU alongside a group that included NFLers Quentin Johnston, Derius Davis, Savion Williams, Jared Wiley, and Kendre Miller before transferring to SMU, where he played three seasons.

The production at SMU was... fine. Nothing more.

Hudson's receiving yards per team pass attempt cleared 1.0 just once, and that came in 2025, his final year. He technically registered a Breakout Score, but it landed at just 27.8, well below where you'd want it for someone you're hoping can outkick Day 3 draft capital.

There aren't many standout traits in Hudson's profile. His first downs per route run were slightly above the class average, and his 1.93 career yards per route run is respectable enough for a likely late-round pick. But dig a little deeper and you see the imbalance: his perimeter yards per route run was just 1.77, while his slot yards per route run was a strong 2.94, sixth-best in the class.

Oddly, he barely played in the slot. Only about 14% of his collegiate routes came from that alignment. If an NFL team leans into that more heavily, maybe there's something to unlock. He was also slightly above average in missed tackles forced per reception, which at least hints at some after-the-catch juice.

As it stands, though, he projects more like a traditional boundary receiver without the boundary-dominant efficiency you'd want to see. And for late-round bets, you usually want at least one clear, bankable trait.

Hudson's profile just doesn't offer that hook.



Jalen Walthall • WR



8.9

ZAP Score

INCARNATE WORD
DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'1 Weight: 191 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Tyson Johnson ▪ Alex Wesley ▪ Jon'Vea Johnson

No player in the ZAP Model database had come from Incarnate Word. Until now with Jalen Walthall. That's where he spent two of his four collegiate seasons.

The other two? Hawaii.

What a wild, wild collegiate journey for a player looking to be drafted to the NFL.

At Hawaii, Walthall's production never got off the ground. As a freshman and sophomore, he posted sub-1.0 prorated receiving yards per team pass attempt rates. He appeared in just five games during his second year, but even on a full-season pace, the numbers weren't trending toward anything meaningful.

Walthall then transferred to Incarnate Word, where the level of competition dipped. Even there, though, his best receiving yards per team pass attempt rate topped out at 2.39. And once that was adjusted for strength of opponent, it wasn't enough to earn a Breakout Score.

That's a major hurdle.

In the ZAP Model database, 61 wide receivers have posted a sub-1.5 best-season adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt rate. Walthall falls into that group. Of those 61, only Tyreek Hill and Hunter Renfrow managed to score more than 12 PPR points per game in one of their first three seasons.

Hill, as you've read in other blurbs, had elite speed and rushing production to buoy his profile. Renfrow's peak was modest and short-lived.

The odds are overwhelmingly against this turning into something meaningful for fantasy. Walthall's path has been unique, but analytically, it's a long shot bet.



Donaven McCulley • WR



6.3

ZAP Score

MICHIGAN

DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'5 Weight: 203 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Michael Jefferson ▪ Alonzo Russell ▪ Binjimen Victor

Donaven McCulley's path to wide receiver is one of the more unique ones in this class.

McCulley arrived at Indiana in 2021 as a quarterback. That experiment didn't last long – he completed just 35 of 82 pass attempts as a freshman before making the switch to wide receiver. Per a USA Today piece, McCulley noted that he'd grown taller and always had good hands, so he made the switch. The athleticism was obvious. The position just needed to change.

Year 2, his first as a receiver, was understandably quiet. But in Year 3, we saw real progress: 48 receptions for 644 yards and a 1.91 adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt mark. For a converted quarterback, that's respectable.

After appearing in just four games for Indiana in 2024, McCulley transferred to Michigan to close out his career. He slightly edged his previous efficiency mark, improving his adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt by 0.02.

According to Rich Hribar of Sharp Football Analysis, no wide receiver in this draft class had a higher uncatchable target rate than McCulley. That likely suppressed his counting stats and may have capped what could've been a slightly better Breakout Score (he finished at 34.8).

At 6'5" with legitimate athletic traits, there's clearly clay to mold here. The issue is that the underlying efficiency never truly popped. His career yards per route run sits at 1.56. And that wasn't meaningfully better on the perimeter, where he's almost certainly destined to line up in the NFL.

It's a fun story and an intriguing athletic bet. A team could absolutely take a late-round swing on the size and developmental upside.

But from a fantasy perspective, this is still a long-range projection rather than a profile built on proven production.



Caullin Lacy • WR



5.4

ZAP Score

LOUISVILLE

DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 5'9 Weight: 183 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Isaiah Williams ▪ Tayvion Robinson ▪ Trent Taylor

Caullin Lacy measured in at 5'9", 183 pounds at the Combine and ran a 4.55 40. That translated to a 14th percentile Speed Score. In a wide receiver class loaded with high-end testers, that kind of number is going to hurt him on NFL boards.

The saving grace is that, for someone this low in the ZAP Model, the production profile isn't a total disaster.

It's just not especially inspiring, either.

Lacy will turn 25 in December, making him one of the older prospects in the class. That's the byproduct of six collegiate seasons – four at South Alabama and two at Louisville. Not ideal.

To Lacy's credit, he did post a legitimate ceiling season. In 2023, he recorded a 3.33 receiving yards per team pass attempt rate. Even after strength-of-schedule adjustments, that number remained strong – his adjusted mark ranks sixth-best in the class.

The issue is the broader context. At his size, Lacy operated primarily from the slot, with over 74% of his routes coming from that alignment. And despite the volume and role, his career slot yards per route run stayed under 2.0. That's not the type of efficiency you'd like to see from a smaller, slot-heavy receiver who isn't bringing plus speed to the table.

When you combine the age, average athleticism, and middling efficiency, you're left with a fairly low-ceiling projection for fantasy. He could stick as depth or as a role player if things break right.

But from a rookie draft perspective, Lacy's not someone you need to prioritize.



Malik Benson • WR



5.1

ZAP Score

OREGON

DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'0 Weight: 189 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Michael Rector ▪ Braylon Sanders ▪ Jon'Vea Johnson

Malik Benson can absolutely run. The former track athlete clocked a 4.37 40 at the Combine, and when you watch him, the vertical juice is obvious. He's built to threaten defenses over the top.

The path to this point, though, has been anything but linear. Benson spent two seasons in JUCO before landing at Alabama in 2023, where he caught just 13 passes across 14 games. That led to a transfer to Florida State, where he managed only 25 receptions. He then finished his career at Oregon in 2025, his fourth college stop.

That final season was technically his most productive, but even then, his adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt peaked at just 1.88. That's a bottom-10 mark in this class.

Deployment helps explain some of it. Over his final three non-JUCO seasons, Benson posted a 25.6% deep-ball target rate, 11th-highest in the class. He was used as a field-stretcher. The problem is that he was rarely featured. He never reached even a 15% prorated target share in any season, the third-worst rate among Combine invite wide receivers.

So what we're looking at is a 23-and-a-half-year-old prospect with plus speed, minimal target-earning ability, and no season that truly stands out from a production standpoint.

The athleticism gives him a puncher's chance. But analytically, this is a thin profile. It's tough to get overly optimistic without meaningful draft capital to force opportunity.



Chris Hilton • WR



4.9

ZAP Score

LOUISIANA STATE

DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'0 Weight: 188 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Braylon Sanders ▪ Damian Copeland ▪ Tyron Johnson

All four LSU wide receivers invited to this year's Combine checked in under 200 pounds – Aaron Anderson was the heaviest at just 191. Chris Hilton fits the mold, and with that lighter frame came good speed. He ran a 4.41 40-yard dash, which is a strong time.

That's about where the positives taper off.

Hilton spent five seasons at LSU – credit to him for staying put in the portal era – but he never topped 250 receiving yards in a single year. As you'd expect, that means he failed to register a Breakout Score.

Hilton's role was extremely narrow. Per PFF, over 42% of his targets came on deep-ball throws, the highest rate in this class. He was essentially a lid-lifter. The problem is that he was rarely a focal point. He never reached a double-digit prorated target share in any season, giving him the lowest best-season target share among Combine invite wide receivers.

When you combine the lack of volume, the one-dimensional usage, and the absence of any meaningful production, you're left with a very rough fantasy projection.

LSU's receiver room has been great in recent years, so that context is important to know. But projecting that profile forward – into a league where the competition only gets tougher – makes it difficult to see a path to consistent fantasy relevance.



J. Michael Sturdivant • WR



1.6

ZAP Score

FLORIDA

DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'3 Weight: 207 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Cayleb Jones ▪ Michael Bennett ▪ Traeshon Holden

We actually did see a flicker of early-career promise from J. Michael Sturdivant, the least user-friendly database name in the class (if you know, you know).

Sturdivant began at Cal, and in his second season there, he posted an adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt mark that barely missed the (low) Breakout Score threshold. Unfortunately, that ended up being the high point of his collegiate journey in that metric, so he never officially recorded a Breakout Score.

After Cal, Sturdivant transferred to UCLA for two seasons and then finished at Florida. The cumulative profile is rough: a career 1.40 yards per route run, fourth-worst in this class. Over the last five years, no wide receiver in the ZAP Model database with a sub-1.50 career yards per route run and no Breakout Score has produced more than 6.0 PPR points per game in a season.

There are legitimate physical tools. At 6'3", 207 pounds, Sturdivant ran a 4.40 40-yard dash. His Speed Score is excellent, and his broad and vertical jumps were strong as well. On paper, that's a really appealing athletic foundation.

If those measurables belonged to a 21-year-old prospect, you could talk yourself into a developmental upside case. But Sturdivant will be over 23-and-a-half at draft time. At that age, with that age-adjusted production, it's a difficult sell.

The physical tools are there. The track record isn't. And historically, that combination – especially for an older prospect – hasn't led to fantasy relevance.

Running Back



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Rahsul Faison..... 101



Jeremiyah Love • RB

 **93.9**

ZAP Score

NOTRE DAME

LEGENDARY PERFORMER

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'0 Weight: 212 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Bijan Robinson ▪ Ezekiel Elliott ▪ Melvin Gordon

Jeremiyah Love is the clear top running back in this year's class. Projected to go in the first round – and almost definitely in the top half of it – Love brings one of the most complete production profiles we've seen in recent cycles. He even shared a backfield with fellow draft hopeful Jadarian Price and still stood out.

Love spent all three collegiate seasons at Notre Dame, and his final two were particularly impressive. In 2025, he captured the Doak Walker Award as the nation's top running back and finished as a Heisman finalist.

From a ZAP Model standpoint, there aren't any glaring red flags. His best-season prorated reception share sits at 12.4%. His peak adjusted total yards per team play checks in at 2.51. His receiving yards per team pass attempt comes in at 0.99. All strong numbers.

If Love does land in the front half of Round 1, history becomes overwhelmingly encouraging.

Since 2011, we've seen 10 running backs drafted in that range. Excluding Ashton Jeanty, who has only completed one NFL season, every single one delivered at least one 17-plus PPR points-per-game campaign within their first three years in the league. Six of them topped 20 PPR points per game in a season.

That's absurd.

Love may not grade quite as cleanly as some of the elite first-round backs from recent classes, but zoom out and the picture is clear: he's a well-rounded producer with first-round capital and no meaningful analytical holes.

Wherever he ends up, Love projects as a major fantasy asset. His statistical comparables are ridiculous.



Emmett Johnson • RB

 **69.7**

ZAP Score

NEBRASKA

WEEKLY STARTER

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 5'10 Weight: 202 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Michael Carter ▪ Kenneth Gainwell ▪ James White

When you look strictly at ZAP Model inputs, Emmett Johnson may have the strongest pure production profile of any running back in this class.

The dude can catch.

Johnson proved that over four seasons at Nebraska, hauling in 85 receptions across his final two years. That translated to a best-season prorated reception share of 19.2% and a peak adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt of 1.13 – both top-three marks in the class. For fantasy purposes, that's huge.

The question is what he brings as a runner.

Among the 20 Combine-invited running backs this year, Johnson's career yards after contact per attempt ranks third-worst, per PFF. His explosive run rate also sits in the bottom half of the class. On the surface, that suggests limited tackle-breaking and chunk-play upside.

There's some nuance, though. Per Rich Hribar of Sharp Football Analysis, Johnson was hit at or behind the line on a class-low 33.9% of his runs. And when he was hit at or behind the line, he gained yardage on a class-high 75.3% of those carries. That hints at some subtle efficiency that box-score metrics don't fully capture.

Johnson's unlikely to be a big-play threat in the NFL, though – you can see that with his career explosive run rate. He also ran a 4.56 40-yard dash at 202 pounds, which led to a mediocre 93.4 Speed Score.

But that doesn't automatically disqualify him.

Since 2011, 10 running backs weighing under 210 pounds have produced a 12-plus PPR points-per-game B2S after being drafted outside Round 2. Only 4 of those 10 had a Speed Score above 94.0. In other words, elite straight-line speed hasn't exactly been a prerequisite for a back like Johnson.

We've seen receiving-centric backs with modest athletic testing hit before – Kyren Williams, Bucky Irving, Aaron Jones. We've also seen it fail, of course, and it fails more often than not. But the range is wide.

Realistically, Johnson likely projects as a third-down back in many offenses. But in the right ecosystem – where receiving usage turns into full-scope opportunity – there's at least a path to something more. And in this running back class, that kind of path isn't incredibly common.



Jadarian Price • RB

 **64.2**

ZAP Score

NOTRE DAME

WEEKLY STARTER

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 5'11 Weight: 203 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Ronald Jones ▪ Jordan Scarlett ▪ Darrynton Evans

Jadarian Price is probably the most difficult analytical evaluation in this class. That's what happens when you spend your career behind a likely first-round back.

Price ruptured his Achilles as a freshman and didn't record a touch. His second season was quiet, as you'd expect. In 2024 and 2025, he handled just 120 and 113 carries while Jeremiah Love soaked up the majority of the workload. Across his entire college career, Price caught only 15 passes – a glaring red flag for fantasy translation.

Price's best-season prorated reception share was 2.8%. In ZAP Model history, 18 backs have fallen below the 3% threshold. None became fantasy-relevant. If you expand to backs below 5%, there are 46 of them – and only Derrick Henry produced a 10-plus PPR points-per-game season within his first three years.

Draft capital could change the equation. If Price goes inside the top 100, he'd join only Henry, D'Onta Foreman, and Ty Davis-Price as backs with that level of investment and a sub-5% reception share. The problem? The two good to elite backs in that sample, Henry and Foreman, were dominant collegiate runners with strong adjusted total yards per team play marks. Price's rate sits at 1.12 – well below that tier – in large part because he was a secondary option in his offense.

The model does attempt to account for that via Teammate Score, but that adjustment is inherently imprecise. It's much easier to evaluate a back who owned most of his backfield than one who shared it with a star. Price's score gets a boost, but the range of outcomes around that boost is wide.

There is a path. If the draft capital hits, Price becomes an outlier bet. And that's where subjectivity can reasonably enter the process.

But the athletic profile complicates things. Price entered the Combine with the second-best career 15-plus-yard run rate among invites, suggesting real big-play juice. But at 203 pounds with a 4.49 40-yard dash, his Speed Score came in at 99.9 – solid, not special.

And here's the historical hurdle: no back in the ZAP Model database has reached 10 PPR points per game in the NFL after posting a sub-105 Speed Score, an adjusted total yards per team play below 1.20 (Price: 1.12), and an adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt below 0.40 (Price: 0.30).

There are contextual reasons for those numbers. But at some point, context stops being an explanation and starts being an excuse.



Mike Washington • RB



61.0

ZAP Score

ARKANSAS
WEEKLY STARTER

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'1 Weight: 223 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Latavius Murray ▪ Brian Robinson ▪ DJ Giddens

Mike Washington took the scenic route through college, playing five seasons across three programs. He opened at Buffalo, where he never cleared 150 carries in a season. After a year at New Mexico State – splitting work with 2026 classmate Seth McGowan – he finished at Arkansas.

Volume was never overwhelming. Even at his peak, Washington didn't reach 170 carries in a season, topping out at a 41% rush attempt share in 2025. What he did have that year was efficiency, averaging 6.4 yards per carry – comfortably the best mark of his career.

At 223 pounds, Washington fits the bigger-back mold. That archetype doesn't always bring receiving juice, but his pass-game profile is at least acceptable. He posted a 12.1% reception share in 2025 – a career high – though it translated to just a 0.67 adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt rate. Fine. Not special.

Some of the deeper metrics raise eyebrows. Despite his size, Washington ranked bottom-five in the class in missed tackles forced per attempt, per PFF. His 15-plus-yard run rate was also below the class average.

Which makes what happened at the Combine all the more jarring.

At 223 pounds, Washington ran a 4.33 40-yard dash. That gave him the second-best Speed Score in ZAP Model history. It was one of the more eye-popping testing performances we've seen from a back of that size, and it likely boosted his draft stock in a meaningful way.

Historically, there isn't a glaring red flag attached to backs who test fast but didn't post elite explosive-run rates in college. The real hope with a profile like this is that the testing nudges draft capital upward. The model gives him a small bump for that weight-adjusted speed, but it's just one input among many. We can't draft solely off a 40 time.

Still, in a class without a ton of obvious RB2 candidates, Washington's Combine pushed him firmly into that conversation. The overall profile isn't flawless, but it's sturdy. And that's not always the case with workout warriors.



Jonah Coleman • RB

 **58.7**

ZAP Score

WASHINGTON

FLEX PLAY

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 5'8 Weight: 220 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Doug Martin ▪ Zac Stacy ▪ Zack Moss

Jonah Coleman is a true do-it-all back.

Coleman began his collegiate career at Arizona, logging over 200 combined carries in his freshman and sophomore seasons. After transferring to Washington for his final two years, he elevated his profile even further.

Coleman peaked in total yards per team play as a junior, though that season featured a reception share under 8%. As a senior, he brought everything together, posting a similar yards-per-team-play mark while nearly doubling his prorated reception share to 13.2%.

Stylistically, Coleman profiles as a powerful workhorse back. According to PFF, no running back in this class posted a better missed tackles forced per attempt rate. He also ranked top-five in yards after contact per attempt and earned one of the strongest pass-blocking grades among NFL Combine invitees.

Some evaluators question his long speed, but his career explosive run rate sits above the class average. He's not a pure burner, but he's not devoid of big-play ability, either.

If Coleman lands on Day 2, his outlook meaningfully improves.

Since 2011, the ZAP Model database includes 39 running backs drafted after Round 1 but inside the top 100 who weighed at least 215 pounds. Of the 34 who've played at least three NFL seasons, 18 posted a best-season reception share above 10%. The other 16 did not.

The higher-reception group outperformed their draft-capital-based expectation (via B2S) by 4.2 PPR points per game. The lower-reception group underperformed by 1.3 points per contest.

Coleman's senior-year receiving profile places him on the right side of that split – assuming the draft capital cooperates.

And draft capital will matter here. If he hears his name called inside the top 100, you're looking at a well above-average prospect with size, tackle-breaking ability, pass-blocking competence, and a growing receiving résumé.

That'd be a profile worth betting on.



Nick Singleton • RB



51.0

ZAP Score

PENN STATE
FLEX PLAY

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'0 Weight: 219 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Jay Ajayi ▪ Javorius Allen ▪ CJ Prosise

The Senior Bowl is invaluable for getting to know prospects on a deeper level. Unfortunately, injuries still happen there.

That's what happened to Penn State's Nick Singleton in January, when he broke his foot during practice. The injury could cause him to slide a bit on draft day.

According to the ZAP Model, it probably shouldn't.

Among running backs invited to this year's NFL Combine, Singleton ranks sixth in best-season prorated reception share, fifth in adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt, and sixth in adjusted total yards per team play. That, to reiterate, is out of 20 players.

All of that's even more impressive when you consider he shared a backfield with fellow 2026 draft hopeful Kaytron Allen for all four seasons at Penn State. Singleton was clearly the superior pass-catcher between the two, highlighted by a 41-catch season in 2024 compared to Allen's 18 receptions that year.

There *are* some non-model concerns. Per PFF, Singleton avoided tackles at a below-average rate in college. And despite flashing explosive athletic traits, his rate of generating 10-plus-yard runs was below the norm among Combine invitees. The traits are evident – the consistency just wasn't always there.

Still, the broader profile is encouraging.

In ZAP Model history, only 13 drafted running backs past Pick 100 have entered the league with a prorated reception share above 12%, a best-season total yards per team play mark north of 1.6, and an adjusted best-season receiving yards per team pass attempt above 1.0. Singleton cleared all three thresholds comfortably, posting a 15% reception share, a 1.74 yards-per-team-play season, and a 1.07 receiving yards-per-team-pass-attempt mark.

Of those 13 backs, 9 exceeded their draft-capital-based expectation (via B2S), and on average, the group outperformed expectation by 3.5 PPR points per game.

This archetype has historically beaten expectation. It's not a lock that Singleton will follow suit, but his production profile – particularly through the air – is stronger than the injury storyline might suggest.

Kaytron Allen • RB



41.0

ZAP Score

PENN STATE		FLEX PLAY	Low Risk Neutral High Risk
Height: 5'11	Weight: 216	NFL Team: TBD	

Draft Capital Δ

Statistical Comps: Kendre Miller ▪ Wayne Gallman ▪ Mike Gillislee

When you first look at Kaytron Allen's production profile, the lack of receiving output immediately jumps out. His best-season prorated reception share was just 8.6%, sixth-worst in the class, and his adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt sat at 0.50 – also sixth-worst.

Allen spent all four collegiate seasons at Penn State alongside fellow 2026 Combine invite Nick Singleton. Singleton absorbed more of the passing-game work, which naturally suppresses Allen's receiving résumé in the model. Teammate Score helps offset that context, but the raw receiving numbers still matter.

Stylistically, Allen was the thunder to Singleton's lightning. He's a bruising, downhill runner who posted a stronger missed tackles forced per attempt rate than his teammate. That said, his tackle-breaking numbers were fairly ordinary relative to the rest of this year's class, and his career yards after contact per attempt was similarly average.

When you combine grind-it-out rushing metrics with limited receiving involvement, the profile can look concerning. And historically, it often is.

The ZAP Model database includes more than 170 running backs who entered the league with a sub-10% best-season prorated reception share and a peak adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt below 0.60 – Allen, again, sits at 8.6% and 0.50. Of that 170-plus group, only 7 managed to score 14 or more PPR points per game in one of their first three seasons: Alfred Morris, Andre Ellington, CJ Anderson, Carlos Hyde, Jordan Howard, Chris Carson, and Isiah Pacheco.

This is where adjusted total yards per team play becomes important. Allen was highly productive overall – in fact, he's Penn State's all-time leading rusher. Despite the weaker receiving marks, he posted a 1.96 adjusted total yards per team play rate. Among those seven historical "hits," only Jordan Howard and Carlos Hyde reached that level.

Add in the fact that Allen operated alongside legitimate backfield competition throughout his career, and the profile doesn't look quite as bleak as the receiving numbers alone might suggest.

There are real red flags here – particularly for true RB1 upside. But if draft capital is there, Allen has a path to carving out early-down value with contingent ceiling. It's just a narrower path than some of his peers in this class.



Demond Claiborne • RB

 **32.8**

ZAP Score

WAKE FOREST

BENCHWARMER

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 5'10 Weight: 188 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Brashard Smith ▪ Jason Huntley ▪ Akeem Hunt

Size could be an obstacle for Wake Forest's Demond Claiborne. At 5'10", 188 pounds, he handled a solid – but not dominant – workload over four seasons. His high-water mark came as a junior with 228 carries, the only time he cleared 200 attempts.

Claiborne did flash some pass-game involvement, posting a 13.1% best-season reception share. But the impact wasn't strong. He never exceeded a 0.63 adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt mark, and with the layer of age and strength-of-schedule fixes, that number falls below the class average.

The straight-line speed is real. He backed that up with a 4.37 40-yard dash at the Combine.

The problem is that the big-play profile doesn't fully match the testing.

Per PFF, Claiborne's collegiate explosive run rate was 12.3%. The average among this year's Combine-invited backs is 13.8%. Over the last five years, the only sub-200-pound back with a collegiate explosive run rate below 15% to even reach 4.0 PPR points per game in a season is Kyren Williams. And Williams brought much stronger overall production to the table.

Claiborne also failed to stand out in missed tackles forced or yards after contact per attempt. For a lighter back, you'd ideally want one of those areas to pop.

The odds of Claiborne developing into a true bell-cow are slim, particularly since he never fully owned that type of role in college. The more realistic path is a complementary or committee role in an NFL backfield.

And for this archetype, opportunity tends to require both patience and the right ecosystem – if it comes at all.



Eli Heidenreich • RB



31.6

ZAP Score

NAVY

BENCHWARMER

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'0 Weight: 198 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: LeQuint Allen ▪ Akrum Wadley ▪ Dylan Laube

The ZAP Model isn't built to detect pure weirdness. You know, like Navy's offense.

Service academies simply don't throw the ball. Since 2011, Army, Navy, and Air Force have combined to reach 300 team pass attempts in a season just twice.

When that's your environment, passing metrics can get... strange. And that's exactly what happened with Eli Heidenreich in 2025.

Heidenreich was a productive part of Navy's offense for three seasons, but 2025 was the breakout. He caught 51 passes and posted a staggering 48.1% prorated reception share.

That's the highest mark in ZAP Model history.

By roughly 23 percentage points.

Heidenreich isn't a traditional running back. Clearly. He's more of a Swiss Army knife – a movable chess piece who can align in the backfield, in the slot, or out wide. He carried the ball 77 times last season but was deployed all over the formation as a receiver. Any team that drafts him would be doing so with that versatility in mind. He's not projecting as an early-down grinder.

Heidenreich's receiving metrics are, frankly, absurd. His adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt sits at 4.96, best in the model's database. Second place? Christian McCaffrey at 2.36.

That tells you how distorted this profile is.

The model will naturally inflate Heidenreich's score because the inputs are extreme.

But historically, tweener utility players like this tend to be more valuable to real-life offenses than to fantasy managers. And often, they don't stick at all – think Jaylen Samuels.

Heidenreich is fascinating analytically. In a class that lacks a lot of firepower, there's at least something to latch onto with him. Just don't get carried away.



Seth McGowan • RB



28.1

ZAP Score

KENTUCKY
WAIVER WIRE ADD

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ
Height: 6'0 Weight: 223 NFL Team: TBD
Statistical Comps: Dwayne Washington ▪ David Johnson ▪ Keaontay Ingram

Prior to this draft class, only one ZAP Model running back – Martez Carter – entered the NFL at age 25 or older.

This year, we have two. One of them is Seth McGowan.

Does age matter? Yes. The model accounts for it, and historically, older prospects have produced weaker outcomes. But context is needed. College football has shifted dramatically in recent years. Transfer rules changed. The pandemic extended eligibility. NIL deals altered incentives. As a result, we're seeing older backs more frequently.

Over the last two draft classes (excluding this one), 10 running backs either attended the NFL Combine or were drafted at age 24 or older. From 2011 through 2023, there were 11 total. Last year alone, RJ Harvey, Woody Marks, and Jacory Croskey-Merritt were all 24 or older at selection.

Adjusted for draft capital, the hit rates for these older prospects haven't been disastrous of late.

As long as the production profiles were strong.

McGowan's profile isn't bad – it's just uneven. He began at Oklahoma in 2020 before being dismissed following legal issues, though the charges were ultimately dropped. After time away from the game, he resurfaced at Butler Community College in 2023, then transferred to New Mexico State in 2024. There, he logged 152 carries in a backfield that also featured 2026 draft hopeful Mike Washington. More importantly for his analytical outlook, McGowan posted a career-best 16.3% reception share that year.

That season did a lot of the heavy lifting for his pass-catching profile, showing at least some ability to function on passing downs. The question is sustainability. When a receiving spike comes after multiple stops and years in the wilderness, it's fair to wonder how sticky it really is.

In 2025, McGowan transferred again – this time to Kentucky. There, he carried the ball 165 times, recorded a 9.1% reception share, and posted a career-best 1.22 adjusted total yards per team play.

McGowan is a big, physical back who plays through contact. Among this year's Combine invitees, he ranks top-five in career missed tackles forced per attempt, per PFF. His explosive run rate is average at best, but when you pair the tackle-breaking ability with an acceptable receiving profile, you can at least envision a path where he sticks as a quality backup with contingent upside.



Adam Randall • RB

 **27.9**

ZAP Score

CLEMSON

WAIVER WIRE ADD

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'3 Weight: 232 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Karlos Williams ▪ Kalen Ballage ▪ Qadree Ollison

We seem to get a wide receiver-to-running back convert in every draft class. This year, it's Adam Randall.

The key difference between Randall and recent movers like Brashard Smith and Tyrone Tracy is size. Randall checks in north of 230 pounds. In ZAP Model history, he's just one of 11 running backs at that weight to post a best-season reception share above 10%.

Many of the players in that bucket – Saquon Barkley, Leonard Fournette, Eddie Lacy, Jeremy Hill, James Conner, Najee Harris – carried strong draft capital. Of the ones who didn't, the NFL returns have been minimal.

And that's where things get tricky.

Randall's story makes you want to buy in. Big-bodied former receiver. Positional versatility. Untapped upside. But the underlying data isn't overly impressive. His reception share cleared 10%, but his best season in adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt was just 0.59, seventh-worst in the class. His adjusted total yards per team play ranked fifth-worst.

Randall only spent one of his four collegiate seasons at Clemson playing running back, logging 168 carries in 2025. With that limited experience, we shouldn't expect a polished analytical profile.

And we didn't get one.

Despite the massive frame, Randall ranked below average in missed tackles forced per attempt within the class. Same story with yards after contact per attempt. For a player built like a power back, the power metrics don't really separate.

For Randall to hit, there's a lot of projection involved. He did give us a strong 113 Speed Score, which was third best at the Combine. But betting on him still requires you to make an assumption of meaningful development as a true running back, which can be a tough ask in a dynasty environment.

Randall's size is rare. The production and efficiency? Less so.



J'Mari Taylor • RB

 **25.5**

ZAP Score

VIRGINIA

WAIVER WIRE ADD

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 5'10 Weight: 199 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Trevor Etienne ▪ Ito Smith ▪ James Williams

Back in 2020, J'Mari Taylor was a walk-on at North Carolina Central. He stayed there through 2024, steadily earning more work each season and eventually topping out with a 53% rush attempt share and an impressive 18.6% reception share in his final year.

Taylor then transferred to Virginia for the 2025 season and continued to show pass-game ability, posting a 14.7% reception share against stronger competition. That's an encouraging signal – the skill set translated upward in level.

On the ground, there are some positives, too. Per PFF, Taylor ranks sixth in this class in career rushing yards after contact per attempt. Despite weighing just 199 pounds, he forced missed tackles at an above-average rate. He wasn't facing SEC defenses every week at North Carolina Central, but the data still reflects functional strength and balance.

One big concern for Taylor is age. He'll be 24 at draft time after five collegiate seasons. Historically, backs entering the league at that age haven't found sustained fantasy success in the ZAP Model database.

There's also the frame. At 199 pounds, he's unlikely to project as a true three-down option in the NFL.

But that shouldn't be the expectation anyway.

Taylor's statistical comparables lean toward satellite backs – players who entered the league as passing-down complements with a path to expanded roles if things break right. As a likely Day 3 pick, landing spot will matter immensely. If he joins a backfield with an established early-down grinder who needs a receiving complement, Taylor could carve out that niche.

The ceiling probably isn't feature-back dominance. But there's a plausible path to situational relevance in the right ecosystem.



Desmond Reid • RB

 **24.0**

ZAP Score

PITTSBURGH

WAIVER WIRE ADD

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 5'6 Weight: 174 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Tarik Cohen ▪ Deuce Vaughn ▪ Khalfani Muhammad

Desmond Reid out of Pittsburgh (Hail 2 Pitt) isn't just the smallest back in this year's class – at 174 pounds, he's the lightest running back in the ZAP Model database since 2017.

That size is going to be the headline. And it should be.

But if you zoom in on the production, it's legitimately strong. Reid posted the second-best top-season reception share in the class at 20.4%. His adjusted receiving yards per team play also ranked second. And his best-season adjusted total yards per team play – which includes rushing – came in at 2.10, a mark only two running backs in the class topped.

From a pure production standpoint, Reid is near the top of this group.

The problem is the body type. In the ZAP Model database, there are 23 running backs under 190 pounds. Only De'Von Achane – who added weight once he reached the NFL – and Tarik Cohen have delivered truly fantasy-relevant seasons. You could maybe toss Keaton Mitchell into the conversation, but that's not exactly a deep bench of hits.

So the bet with Reid is pretty clear: you're hoping for a creative offensive coordinator who leans into his receiving ability and builds a role around him. In the right system, he could be a PPR weapon.

The challenge is that the NFL has shifted. Running back target spikes aren't quite what they were in the Tarik Cohen era. It's harder now for a sub-180-pound back to live purely off receiving volume without a lot of rushing work.

Pitt allegiance aside – that's my alma mater, for those of you who don't know – Reid is fun. He's quick, he's productive as a receiver, and he's electric in space.

But fun doesn't automatically translate to fantasy difference-maker – especially at 174 pounds.



Le'Veon Moss • RB



19.5

ZAP Score

TEXAS A&M
DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ
Height: 5'11 Weight: 203 NFL Team: TBD
Statistical Comps: Kennedy Brooks ▪ Nick Wilson ▪ Abram Smith

The issue with Le'Veon Moss isn't the name – it absolutely sounds like an NFL running back's name.

It's the production.

Moss spent four years at Texas A&M and never once handled more than 25% of his team's rush attempts in a season. His best-season attempt share was only higher than Eli Heidenreich's in this class, and Heidenreich is basically a slot receiver playing running back.

The receiving profile doesn't bail Moss out. He posted just a 6.7% best-season reception share, the third-lowest mark among Combine invite running backs. His adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt came in at 0.63, well below the class average.

So we've got a limited rushing share and limited receiving involvement.

At the Combine, Moss weighed 203 pounds. That's not tiny, but it's also not the kind of frame that screams "early-down hammer" – especially when the production doesn't support that label.

Historically, that combination is rough. In the ZAP Model database, only four running backs have reached 10 or more PPR points per game in one of their first three seasons with both a sub-8% best-season reception share and a sub-30% best-season attempt share: Chris Carson, Dameon Pierce, Damien Harris, and CJ Anderson.

Pierce and Harris had decent draft capital. All four of them were over 215 pounds entering the league. Moss doesn't check either of those boxes.

Which brings us to the key question: where does Moss fit?

He doesn't project as a clear passing-down option. He doesn't profile as a high-volume early-down grinder. He didn't dominate touches in college. And as a likely Day 3 pick, he won't have investment to force opportunity.

That's an uncomfortable place to live for fantasy purposes. Without a standout trait or a defined role to lean on, Moss feels more like depth than a back you'll be excited to roster.



Jam Miller • RB



18.0

ZAP Score

ALABAMA
DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 5'10 Weight: 209 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Rico Dowdle ▪ Montrell Johnson ▪ Ty Davis-Price

Jam Miller flashed some juice at the NFL Combine. At 209 pounds, he ran a 4.42 40, giving him a Speed Score just shy of 110.

That might be the best part of the profile, if we're being honest.

Miller spent four seasons at Alabama and never reached 150 carries in a year. His best rush attempt share season topped out at 29.7%. Through the air, he never hit an 8% reception share in any campaign.

That combination – modest workload and minimal receiving – is historically tough to overcome.

There are 34 running backs in the ZAP Model database who failed to clear a 30% best-season attempt share and an 8% reception share. Just four of them reached 10 or more PPR points per game in one of their first three seasons: CJ Anderson, Chris Carson, Dameon Pierce, and Damien Harris.

All four weighed at least 215 pounds entering the league.

Miller doesn't.

Even if we loosen the thresholds – backs under 215 pounds with a best-season attempt share below 40% and a best-season reception share below 10% – there are 43 players in that bucket. Only Devonta Freeman, Elijah Mitchell, and Darrell Henderson produced meaningful fantasy seasons.

And that's before diving into the advanced rushing metrics.

Despite the strong 40 time, Miller ranked dead last in this year's class in collegiate explosive run rate, per PFF. It's one of the lowest marks we've seen in the last five draft cycles. His yards after contact per attempt also ranked dead last.

Alabama's depth chart is never easy to crack, and they obviously play some tough defenses. But the overall résumé doesn't suggest we should be pounding the table for Miller this offseason.

The Speed Score is intriguing. The production profile is not.



Robert Henry • RB



16.7

ZAP Score

TEXAS-EL PASO
DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ
Height: 5'9 Weight: 196 NFL Team: TBD
Statistical Comps: LeVante Bellamy ▪ Travis Homer ▪ Cody Schrader

Robert Henry's best-season reception share was 12.3%, which is respectable on the surface. The problem is that it came with major inefficiency, largely due to adjustments. In that same season, his age- and schedule-adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt was just 0.40, the fourth-worst mark in this class.

Context doesn't really save it, either. Henry played at Jones College and UTEP, and he reached higher than a 7% reception share in just that one campaign. He wasn't facing elite weekly competition – the production simply wasn't there in an impactful way.

Athletically, there's not much of a boost. At 196 pounds, Henry ran a 4.52 40 at the Combine, resulting in a below average 93.9 Speed Score.

Historically, that's a tough combo. In the ZAP Model database, 111 running backs have posted both a sub-100 Speed Score and a sub-0.5 adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt rate. Only nine of them reached 10 or more PPR points per game in one of their first three seasons: Alfred Morris, Stevan Ridley, Andre Ellington, Alex Collins, Thomas Rawls, Jordan Howard, Chris Carson, Ronald Jones, and James Robinson.

Every single one of those backs weighed more than Henry at the Combine.

Add in the age – he'll be 24 after five collegiate seasons – and the odds shrink even further. Older running back prospects haven't produced much sustained fantasy success historically.

Even in a favorable landing spot, Henry doesn't project cleanly into a three-down role. He's not built like a classic early-down bruiser, and the receiving profile doesn't suggest a natural passing-down specialist, either.

That's an awkward middle ground to live in. And it's not where you want your Day 3 dart throw to sit.



Roman Hemby • RB



16.1

ZAP Score

INDIANA

DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'0 Weight: 207 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Will Shipley ▪ Ty Chandler ▪ Rasheen Ali

The advanced numbers don't paint Roman Hemby as a dynamic runner. His career avoided tackles per rush rate is tied for the third-worst in this class. He gained 15 or more yards at the second-lowest rate. His yards after contact per attempt also sits in the bottom half among Combine invites.

Those are rushing indicators. And they're not flattering.

The ZAP Model is a bit more forgiving because it leans heavily on receiving inputs. At Maryland, Hemby posted an 11% reception share or better in three of his four seasons – the three in which he played more than two games. His adjusted total yards per team play and adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt were below average, but not alarmingly so.

Hemby then transferred to Indiana for his final season, where he set a career high with 230 carries. Once you account for offensive environment, though, his attempt share wasn't meaningfully different from what it had been at Maryland. He never exceeded a 40% rush attempt share in college.

Put it all together and the profile becomes fairly clear. Hemby projects as a committee back, likely with some pass-catching utility. That's exactly what his statistical comparables suggest: a complementary piece who can contribute, but probably not anchor a backfield on his own.



CJ Donaldson • RB



13.8

ZAP Score

OHIO STATE

DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'2 Weight: 230 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Ja'Quinden Jackson ▪ Bo Scarbrough ▪ David Williams

When you weigh 230 pounds and rank dead last in your draft class in career missed tackles forced per attempt, that's a red flag.

That's the starting point with CJ Donaldson. Among 220-plus-pound running backs since 2020, the only ones with missed tackles forced rates in his range are Gerrid Doaks and Stevie Scott.

Not great!

Donaldson spent three seasons at West Virginia before transferring to Ohio State for his final year. He was originally recruited as a tight end, which makes sense when you see the 6'2", 230-pound frame.

Across four collegiate seasons, Donaldson never truly controlled his team's rushing workload. His best attempt share was around 31%. Efficiency didn't pick up the slack, either. He posted the third-lowest explosive run rate in this year's class and the second-worst career yards after contact per attempt.

The receiving profile offers little relief. His best-season reception share was just 6.2%, better than only Jadarian Price among running backs invited to the NFL Combine.

So what's the bet? That an NFL team sees the size and thinks it can mold him into something more physical and efficient than he showed in college.

Maybe that happens. But historically, backs with this combination of low tackle-breaking ability, modest workload share, and minimal receiving production don't turn into fantasy staples.

If Donaldson carves out a role, it's likely as more of a situational back. That's not the kind of archetype you're drafting with confidence in any fantasy format.

Noah Whittington • RB



8.8

ZAP Score

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

OREGON		DART THROW
Height: 5'8	Weight: 205	NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Boston Scott ▪ Mike Ball ▪ Michael Smith

Noah Whittington played six seasons of college football and never reached 1,000 total yards in a single year.

Whittington's most encouraging stretch likely came in Year 3, his first season at Oregon after two years at Western Kentucky. That year, he posted his best adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt rate and his second-best adjusted total yards per team play mark. He also tied his career-high reception share at 7.1%.

And he did that in the same offense as Bucky Irving.

You'd hope the arrow would continue pointing up from there, but it didn't. Whittington tore his ACL in 2023, the following season, and the profile never really recovered. His best-season reception share ranked bottom-five in the class. His adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt was also bottom-five. His top adjusted total yards per team play mark – 1.20 – ranked third-worst among Combine-invited running backs.

Even if we soften the thresholds by 20% – pushing them to roughly an 8.5% reception share, 1.45 total yards per team play, and 0.50 receiving yards per team pass attempt – Whittington still falls well short.

In the ZAP Model database, 66 running backs have failed to meet those boosted baselines. Just two – Andre Ellington and Chris Carson – produced even one fantasy-relevant season in their first three years.

That's not encouraging.

The profile is iffy, and the lack of any true ceiling season makes it difficult to sell Whittington as anything more than a depth guy.

As always with running backs, landing spot can manufacture short-term opportunity. But analytically, this is not a profile you'd want to aggressively bet on.



Rahsul Faison • RB



8.7

ZAP Score

SOUTH CAROLINA
DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 5'11 Weight: 208 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Brittain Brown ▪ SaRodorick Thompson ▪ Wes Hills

Some prospects in this class took winding paths through college. Rahsul Faison went on a full-blown odyssey.

First, the headline: Faison is 26 years old.

He began his college career in 2019 at Marshall, transferred to Lackawanna College in 2020, then moved to Snow College, where he finally started seeing real playing time. After a couple of seasons there, he transferred to Utah State and spent two years with the Aggies. His best season came there, when he posted a 1.37 total yards per team play rate – easily the top mark of his career.

In 2025, Faison transferred again, this time to South Carolina, where he finished with 96 carries and 19 receptions. It was a quiet final chapter.

Faison is the oldest player in the ZAP Model database, so we're operating in pretty unusual territory. And age at running back isn't something you can just hand-wave away – he's already brushing up against the typical fantasy age apex before taking an NFL snap.

Even beyond the age, the production doesn't do much work. Despite spending six-plus years in college football, Faison never reached a double-digit target share in a season. His best-season adjusted total yards per team play was 1.18, second-worst in this class.

There is one encouraging note: at 208 pounds, he forced missed tackles at one of the best rates in the group. Only two backs in this class posted a better career missed tackles forced rate.

But let's be real: Faison was a 25-year-old at one point playing against teenagers. That edge doesn't translate cleanly forward.

This is the type of profile that's easy to fade in rookie drafts. The age, the lack of a true spike season, and the limited receiving production create a very mid prospect.

Tight End



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Kenyon Sadiq • TE

 **97.8**

ZAP Score

OREGON

LEGENDARY PERFORMER

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'3 Weight: 241 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Noah Fant ▪ OJ Howard ▪ Evan Engram

Kenyon Sadiq is the consensus top tight end prospect in the 2026 class, and his NFL Combine performance solidified it – even with competition from the TE2, Eli Stowers.

Tight ends as a whole tested lighter and faster than most classes at the Combine; even with that, Sadiq is pretty light – but also really fast. He makes up for his smaller frame by posting game-breaking athleticism that featured the fastest 40-yard dash ever for a tight end at the Combine (4.39 seconds), the second-best vertical leap (43.5 inches), and the third-best broad jump (133 inches).

With such a highly touted prospect (his draft capital projection is trending toward the middle of the first round after the Combine), we need to consider nitpicking a bit. If we do that, we can point out that it's not all green across the board for the Oregon Duck.

Sadiq spent three seasons at Oregon after earning a four-star recruit status coming out of high school. He got off to a slow start in a crowded offense that featured Bucky Irving and Jordan James at running back, Troy Franklin and Tez Johnson at receiver, and Bo Nix under center. As a freshman, Sadiq caught just 5 passes for 24 yards.

In 2024, with Irving and Franklin gone and Dillon Gabriel leading the offense, Sadiq's role expanded; he was fifth on the Ducks in yards (308) and seventh in receptions (24).

In 2025 – and playing with his third quarterback (Dante Moore) in as many years – Sadiq led the Ducks in receptions (51) and receiving touchdowns (8) and was second in yards (560). That's growth, and once accounting for age, the Breakout Score is still great (86th percentile).

Although Sadiq took three seasons to hit his stride, he had plenty of competition in college from future NFL prospects. He's now a virtual lock to be drafted early, typically a great sign for tight ends who go on to be high-level NFL producers.

The tape shows some good blocking ability, which should make the transition more seamless for Sadiq. Early draft capital and not being a blocking liability should raise the floor on Sadiq in the NFL. He shouldn't be used as an inline tight end if teams want to maximize his receiving anyway, so as far as a fantasy football evaluation goes, Sadiq stands out from a lot of historical prospects.

It would just be nice if his comparables were a little stronger – the profile has strong odds to hit, but we've seen some busts from this type of player before.



Eli Stowers • TE

 **79.2**

ZAP Score

VANDERBILT

ELITE PRODUCER

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'4 Weight: 239 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Sam LaPorta ▪ Mike Gesicki ▪ Luke Musgrave

Eli Stowers made a statement at the NFL Combine. He ran a 4.51-second 40-yard dash, he broke the tight end record for the broad jump, and he broke the all-time record for the vertical leap. Already considered the TE2 in the class by most big boards, Stowers' stock is on the rise after a showing like that, jumping up his pre-draft ZAP Score.

But it's not just athleticism in the profile. Far from it.

In the current NCAA landscape, traditional career arcs are getting less common, but even with that, Stowers' path needs some dissection. Especially for someone with this much spotlight on him.

A track athlete (who won the 2019 Texas 6A high jump state title), Stowers was a four-star recruit...at quarterback. He began his college career at Texas A&M for two years without making an impact before transferring to New Mexico State and becoming a tight end for a different Aggies squad.

Stowers racked up 35 catches and 366 yards as a receiver – and ran 28 times for 108 yards and 2 scores – in his first (and only) season with New Mexico State. He then transferred to Vanderbilt for two years, logging 111 receptions, 1,407 yards, and 9 touchdowns in his final two college seasons with Diego Pavia under center.

Despite five college seasons and a position change, Stowers still had a solid Breakout Score – one that was slightly higher than Kenyon Sadiq's – and will be drafted at an average age, as well. He added weight throughout his college career, growing from 215 pounds as a high school prospect to 235 in his final season, ultimately weighing in at 239 pounds at the NFL Combine.

So, yes, it was quite an unconventional career trajectory, but the reality is that Stowers has a dominant mark in max age- and schedule-adjusted yards per team attempt, plus that Breakout Score we mentioned already.

In terms of pure fantasy football upside, tight end is often dominated by elite athletes, and that's how Stowers projects. Not every tight end with a similar profile to Stowers' hits, but Stowers really checks every box.

Undersized but incredibly athletic, Stowers is more of a "big receiver" and is most likely slated for a receiving-first role on Sundays, making him a fantasy-friendly option even if he might lose snaps in short-yardage, heavy-package formations.



Max Klare • TE

 **56.2**

ZAP Score

OHIO STATE

FLEX PLAY

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'4 Weight: 246 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Greg Dulcich ▪ Jonnu Smith ▪ Pat Freiermuth

Many big board rankings (including the ZAP model) list Max Klare as the TE3, but there's a sizable gap. Klare is generally regarded as a Round 3 pick, and while we've seen plenty of stellar fantasy tight ends taken in that range, he's far from a surefire prospect with that level of draft capital (if that's where he lands).

Klare's stock has risen dramatically over the last two seasons. As a redshirt freshman at Purdue, he logged 22 catches for 196 scoreless yards in five games before an ankle injury ended his season. The next year, as a redshirt sophomore, Klare posted a 51-catch, 685-yard, 4-touchdown line, leading the team in all three categories.

He transferred to Ohio State the following season and recorded 43 receptions for 448 yards and 2 touchdowns while catching passes from Julian Sayin.

Klare's market shares at Ohio State dropped noticeably. After serving as Purdue's go-to option in 2024, he had to compete with Jeremiah Smith, Carnell Tate, and others – including another Combine-invited tight end, Will Kacmarek.

Given the competition, the decline is understandable – Klare still finished as the third option behind Smith and Tate – but the usage dip is notable.

Klare didn't run the 40, but he projects as a passable athlete compared to historical Combine-invited tight ends, putting more emphasis on his receiving production to project his NFL outlook. In a class full of strong testers, he's a bit of an outlier – not in a negative sense, but simply projecting as average athletically. Accounting for that, he still looks quite good, which helps explain why he stands out in the tight end model.

He was also used out wide fairly often (13.4% wide rate, per PFF, in 2025 – highest among tight ends in the class). He's likely a more capable receiver than he showed at Ohio State, though he'll probably face strong target competition in most NFL landing spots.

Perhaps not the highest-ceiling option, Klare profiles as a fairly high-floor player. His average depth of target and run-after-catch numbers are subpar, which isn't surprising given his athletic profile and average frame (which also leaves some uncertainty about his blocking).

Still, Klare has the highest Breakout Score in the class. It makes sense that he lands as the TE3. With slightly better-than-expected draft capital and the right role as a pass catcher, he draws some Zach Ertz vibes in the comparison model.



Michael Trigg • TE

 **48.8**

ZAP Score

BAYLOR

FLEX PLAY

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'4 Weight: 240 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Cade Stover ▪ Evan Rodriguez ▪ Tyler Higbee

Michael Trigg's profile is that of a well-rounded athlete. He played defensive end and basketball in high school and earned four-star recruiting status before heading to Southern California, the first of three NCAA schools for which he suited up.

Trigg played only six games as a Trojan in 2021 and then seven and three games at Ole Miss in 2022 and 2023, respectively. Across those 16 games, he totaled just 28 catches for 330 yards and 5 touchdowns.

But then at Baylor in 2024, Trigg notched 30 catches for 395 yards and 3 touchdowns and built on it in 2025: 50 grabs for 694 yards and 6 touchdowns, ranking top-three on the team in each of those categories in his final NCAA season.

Even with that slow start, his best season by age- and schedule-adjusted max yards per team attempt is about average among the tight end database, as was his Breakout Score.

We do have to note, though, that Trigg missed time not only for injuries but also for off-field incidents, and while it's possible that the production profile could've been markedly better, film and scouting grades put his blocking into question. It could all be interconnected. I'm focused on the data, but this is part of the equation with Trigg, whose draft stock has been declining in the months leading up to the NFL Draft.

For us as fantasy football managers, we care a lot about the receiving production, but we also know that poor blocking and commitment can mean reduced snaps. It can also translate into a new-age tight end who is tasked more with receiving than blocking. Trigg's yards per route run data was good at all his stops, including a 2.18 mark in his last season, and he led this year's Combine-invited class in slot rate, per PFF. That's what makes him appealing as a fantasy football prospect. He could be a good-to-great NFL receiver.

Trigg's long arms and big hands, as measured at the Combine, help make for a highlight-level catch radius, which he certainly flashed on tape. The big board rank has been falling, but if an NFL team sees it differently and applies some capital in the late-Round-2 or middle-of-Round 3 range where he peaked, he draws some Tucker Kraft and Brenton Strange comps. Trigg could be legit if an NFL team uses him to his best abilities.



Sam Roush • TE

 **44.7**

ZAP Score

STANFORD

FLEX PLAY

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'6 Weight: 267 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Darnell Washington ▪ Daniel Bellinger ▪ George Kittle

I know. I know the comp you're seeing. We'll talk about it. We'll talk a lot about Sam Roush, whose draft stock is on the rise after the NFL Combine. There'll probably be a lot of talk about Roush on the draft broadcasts, too.

He comes from an athletic family: his parents both played college sports, and numerous cousins and uncles played sports at a high level, including his great uncle, Pro Football Hall of Famer Merlin Olsen. He has lived in Malaysia and Indonesia and played rugby there. It's a cool backstory.

In one of the lightest tight end classes in the model's history, Roush stands out as one of three names to weigh in over 253 pounds at the NFL Combine, and he led the way at 267. At 6'6", 267, he ran a 4.70-second 40-yard dash, which works out to a 112.3 height-adjusted Speed Score. There's more than straight-line speed, though.

Roush's 3-cone time was 7.08 seconds. I have only 44 players in my Combine database (since 2000) with a weight of 267 and a 3-cone of 7.08 or faster, and most are defensive ends.

Again, going back to 2000, Roush is fifth among all tight ends in weight-adjusted vertical, coincidentally ranking third in this class alone. The leaders in this metric are Eli Stowers, Vernon Davis, Virgil Green, and Kenyon Sadiq. He's also second since 2000 among tight ends in weight-adjusted broad jump. He's big and athletic.

What about the production?

Roush had some steady production increases throughout his four years at Stanford, ultimately finishing with 49 grabs, 545 yards, and 2 touchdowns as a senior. In total, his max yards per team attempt and Breakout Score are sitting just above the 60th percentile in the model.

He didn't split out wide often but did slide into the slot at a near-average rate. He's an inline tight end with some receiving potential.

So, he should be able to find his way on the field, given his blocking, and with that speed and burst, he has more upside as a receiver than he was able to show at Stanford. George Kittle is the outlier example of being able to do more in the right offense than was asked of him at Iowa, despite mediocre draft capital; that's where Roush shows some similarities.



Justin Joly • TE

 **40.8**

ZAP Score

NORTH CAROLINA STATE

FLEX PLAY

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'3 Weight: 241 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Ja'Tavion Sanders ▪ Harrison Bryant ▪ Austin Hooper

Justin Joly is a tough prospect to nail down, and the NFL Combine may not have done him many favors. His draft stock appears to be slipping.

At the Combine, he measured 6'3½" and 241 pounds – about the same size as the class's top tight end, Kenyon Sadiq – placing him firmly in the "small" bucket. But Sadiq ran a 4.39-second 40-yard dash and dominated the explosiveness drills.

Joly didn't test at all, and the tape – and his run-after-catch data – also don't suggest that he is a game-changing athlete. Some estimates put his 40 time around 4.50, while others are less favorable, putting him in the 4.70 range.

The weight is also surprising. North Carolina State listed Joly at 263 pounds as a senior, while other sources had him at 251. Coming in at 241 changes the size-athleticism conversation and reframes his promising receiving profile. At 263, he would have been among the heaviest Combine tight ends; instead, he's one of the lightest.

Still, his receiving trajectory is intriguing. A high school wide receiver, Joly began his college career slowly with 18 catches as a freshman at Connecticut. As a sophomore, he led the team with 56 receptions for 578 yards and 2 touchdowns.

He then transferred to North Carolina State, continuing his rise with a team-high 661 yards and 4 touchdowns on 43 catches while playing alongside KC Concepcion in 2024. As a senior, Joly led the Wolfpack in receptions (49) and touchdown catches (7).

That production built a remarkably consistent four-year résumé: Joly finished between 1.75 and 1.80 yards per route run every season, per PFF.

Overall, he owns the fourth-best max yards per team attempt in the class, and a strong Breakout Score places him toward the top of the large tier of tight ends behind Sadiq and Stowers.

Simply put, there's a lot of "good" in Joly's profile, even if no single trait stands out. That balance leads to solid comparisons and an overall positive projection.

The goal is finding fantasy points – receiving production – at the NFL level. Joly should be capable of providing that. If he adds some size and earns snaps, he has a chance to emerge as the TE3 from this class purely from a fantasy perspective.



Joe Royer • TE

 **36.3**

ZAP Score

CINCINNATI

BENCHWARMER

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'5 Weight: 247 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Cade Stover ▪ Jeremy Sprinkle ▪ Tyler Higbee

Joe Royer's collegiate career is an interesting one.

He played five seasons, logging 39 total games. He appeared in 14 games over three seasons at Ohio State (including missing time due to the passing of his mother) before transferring to Cincinnati and playing in 25 games in his final two seasons.

So, while he was far from an early declare (and while he's a bit older than we'd like), he didn't have a traditional five-year career.

Given the missed time, it's understandable that his Breakout Score is below average, but it's still 40th-percentile. His max yards per team attempt number is about average for the sample, and it accounts for age. That helps to balance out the profile a bit.

Royer's career arc included a 50-catch season in 2024 at Cincinnati. He broke Travis Kelce's school record of 45 catches for a tight end. Royer followed it up with 29 catches in 2025 but improved his yards per catch numbers from 10.4 to 14.3 and scored four times, one more than in 2024.

The Tyler Higbee pre-draft comparison is already interesting, but a Julius Thomas comp? Really? Both had subpar Breakout Scores and max yards per team attempt marks (understandably for Thomas, primarily a basketball player), but they've got similar builds and athleticism, and Royer's stock was actually high last year. The Ringer's Todd McShay actually had Royer as a first-round pick in a late-April "way-too-early" mock draft in 2025.

The dip in receiving volume in 2025 has dropped that stock plenty, but the point is that there is potential at the high end for a player such as Royer, who had plus pass-blocking grades. Royer really embodies this year's tight end class: a lot of guys have something in their profiles, though only two are great across the board.



Oscar Delp • TE

 **34.9**

ZAP Score

GEORGIA

BENCHWARMER

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'5 Weight: 245 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Jared Wiley ▪ Chig Okonkwo ▪ Julius Thomas

Entering the NFL Combine, Oscar Delp was probably the name I was keeping the closest eye on among all tight ends. His projected 40 times and game tape indicate mismatch potential in the NFL.

Delp neither ran the 40 at the Combine nor participated in any other tests, so we've got just the tape and projections to examine (though he looks like an NFL talent on film).

Understandably, Delp had some target competition at Georgia. Brock Bowers and Ladd McConkey were there for his first two seasons, and Darnell Washington was fifth on the team in receptions in Delp's freshman season.

With that said, Delp's stat line remained pretty similar in his final year with Bowers and McConkey (24 catches, 284 yards, and 3 scores) as it was without them in 2024 (21 for 248 and 4) and 2025 (20 for 261 and 1).

This makes for a pretty conflicting prospect profile. Obviously, there's pedigree in that Delp is a Georgia product, but he spent plenty of time blocking when on the field and was used primarily as an inline tight end in 2025. The receiving metrics and Breakout Score were less than ideal (not breaking the 30th percentile in either).

There's definitely enough with Delp on the high end to deserve some legitimate comps, and if he lands in the right spot, I think we're looking at a player who outperforms his draft slot. His name has been falling across average draft boards, so while he was a name I was watching entering the NFL Combine, he's still very much in the spotlight for a different reason. Nothing is set in stone, though, and there's a chance Delp is even the second tight end off the board, which would signify how much a team believes in his traits.



Jack Endries • TE

 **34.7**

ZAP Score

TEXAS

BENCHWARMER

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'5 Weight: 245 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Brycen Hopkins ▪ Kylen Granson ▪ Dalton Schultz

Jack Endries has a strong tie to the 2025 Heisman Trophy winner, Fernando Mendoza.

They played two seasons together in 2023 and 2024 at Cal before transferring to different schools. Endries, as a redshirt sophomore, led the Golden Bears in receptions (56) and yards (623) before transferring to Texas, where his yards per game number (26.6) was nearly cut in half (47.9) amidst tougher competition despite starting all 11 games for the Longhorns.

Endries, in total, rates out with strong max yards per team pass attempt data (67th percentile) and Breakout Score (73rd percentile) despite raw yards-per-route rate numbers that may not grab your attention too much. He also ran a 4.62-second 40-yard dash at the NFL Combine, giving him a height-adjusted Speed Score of 116.0 at 6'5", 245.

On the flip side, despite a smaller frame and good athletic testing, Endries doesn't pop from a yards-after-the-catch standpoint. That's also tied to some average-to-below-average blocking scores from PFF and SportsInfoSolutions (and it's worth noting that he graded out with around 15th-percentile arm length).

After struggling with drops in his first season with Cal, his hands improved markedly in his final two seasons. That's promising growth.

He's the exact type of player (decent athleticism for his size with questionable blocking traits but who might still be drafted early anyway) that the new tight end model finds interesting. His draft stock will greatly affect his ZAP score, as it'll tell us a lot about how NFL teams are valuing his strengths compared to his weaknesses. That's the case for every tight end outside the top two.

Endries has a pretty wide range of pre-draft valuations, spanning from the middle of the second round to one of the first names being called on Day 3. If a team likes him and spends legitimate Day 2 capital on him, he becomes pretty interesting.



Marlin Klein • TE

 **28.4**

ZAP Score

MICHIGAN

WAIVER WIRE ADD

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'6 Weight: 248 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Tanner McLachlan ▪ Jack Stoll ▪ Stephen Sullivan

It's probably safe to say that Marlin Klein loves the game of American football. Born in Germany, Klein played football for the Cologne Crocodiles before moving to the United States in high school to play in Georgia.

Klein, though, never reached 25 catches or 250 yards in any of his four seasons at Michigan, and he scored just once. Of course, his time overlapped with Colston Loveland's in Ann Arbor, and without Loveland in the mix, Klein's role did grow in 2025 to career-bests across the board (24 catches, 248 yards, and 1 touchdown).

But you still can't really overcorrect the production enough to make him look like a standout in those departments. Beyond that, Klein rates out with bottom-five run-after-the-catch numbers among this year's Combine-invited tight end class.

The profile, overall, indicates that Klein's most likely path to NFL snaps is to be a blocking tight end with room to grow as a receiver. It's not the most exciting combination when seeking pure fantasy football upside, yet the 4.61-second 40-yard dash at his size gives him a 112.7 height-adjusted Speed Score.

With good blocking grades and tape and good athleticism, it's the right combination of underlying data that can still generate some optimism despite weak production data. He's still relatively new to the game, and while that gets him some leeway, it also suggests he's still a bit of a developmental project, one not fully NFL-ready.



Eli Raridon • TE

 **28.0**

ZAP Score

NOTRE DAME

WAIVER WIRE ADD

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'6 Weight: 245 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Dalton Keene ▪ Cole Turner ▪ Colby Parkinson

Prior to the NFL Combine, some sources listed Eli Raridon at 6'7". Others in the 6'5" range. Officially, he measured in at 6'6" and 245 pounds. He's the second-tallest of 27 Combine-invited tight ends, but he's pretty light despite the height.

Raridon played four seasons at Notre Dame, yet despite his size, he scored just 3 times on 48 catches over 40 games. Now, we have to mention that Raridon tore his ACL as a freshman in 2022 and logged only 12 games in his first two seasons. That context is necessary.

But, even with the big frame, Raridon's blocking grades and metrics are pretty average, and his dropped pass data is enough to bring pause regarding his hands.

On the flip side, Raridon is 70th-percentile or better in max yards per team attempt and Breakout Score among the tight end database, and there's still a bit of that big-bodied, basketball-background archetype in Raridon's profile that we've seen lead to some massive overperformances from late-round tight ends in the past.

We shouldn't ignore him (NFL teams won't). Just know that there are red flags here, too.

Ultimately, Raridon is interesting. In the right spot (and if a team likes his potential enough to take him earlier than consensus), there are shades of solid-to-strong fantasy football production here.

But if the height and speed aren't enough for a team to invest heavily in him, then he might be just another big, fast tight end who isn't the total package. We've seen plenty of those over the years. A Colby Parkinson-type projection at the high end is interesting for the big-bodied Raridon.



Dallen Bentley • TE

 **25.3**

ZAP Score

UTAH

WAIVER WIRE ADD

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'4 Weight: 253 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Jerrell Adams ▪ Luke Willson ▪ AJ Derby

Dallen Bentley's pre-draft big board rankings are all over the place, so we'll learn a lot about his true stock when his name gets called. But there's some stuff to like here.

Speaking of wide-ranging, let's talk about Bentley's college profile. Bentley didn't draw much attention coming out of high school and played his first college ball at Snow College, where he didn't do much (just eight catches in eight games).

He then transferred to Utah in 2023, playing special teams and some tight end initially. He finished the year with one catch over seven games. In 2024, he played 12 games, yet caught 2 passes for 15 yards.

Clearly, his 2025 season is what garnered him a Combine invite. This past season, Bentley hauled in 48 passes for 620 yards (both second-best on the team) for a team-high 6 scores. As we'd expect, the Breakout Score and age-adjusted max yards per team attempt data are subpar with a trajectory like that.

Bentley played in a high-average depth of target offense at Utah, yet he still saw a higher average depth of target than his fellow Ute tight ends in 2025. As a result, he's third among this year's class in career average depth of target, via PFF data.

Bentley's athletic testing is also noteworthy. He ran a 4.62-second 40-yard dash after clocking in at 6'4", 253 pounds, good for a height-adjusted Speed Score of 111.1. We can't get overly excited about the athleticism unless it's tied to the right draft capital (which, again, is all over the place), though.

Bentley's an older prospect, and he's probably not going to be the guy for a team, but he does check enough boxes.



Tanner Koziol • TE

 **22.0**

ZAP Score

HOUSTON

WAIVER WIRE ADD

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'7 Weight: 247 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Wes Saxton ▪ James Mitchell ▪ Charles Clay

Tanner Koziol's official NFL Combine height of 6'6½" puts him at the top of this year's class, and with a 4.70-second 40-yard dash, he rates out with a 105.2 height-adjusted Speed Score – more than enough to keep him on an NFL field. He also graded out with a really good weighted-adjusted burst score (vertical and broad jump).

Despite that, his big board hype is dropping coming out of the Combine. That has to mean something.

As a two-star recruit, Koziol's college journey actually began at Ball State before he transferred to Houston in 2025 for his final season. But he...balled out...in his final year at Ball State in 2024 and recorded 94 catches. On nearly 100 grabs, Koziol scored 8 times but had just 839 yards, 8.9 yards per catch.

Then, at Houston, he followed it up with another high-volume season: 74 catches for 727 yards (9.8 per catch) and 6 scores.

So, he led two different offenses in receptions in his final two seasons in college. He also pops in terms of an interesting stat: first downs per route run. Koziol might be a ball player.

We need to scale and adjust that production from Ball State and Houston, of course. When you do, you see that he has a max yards per team attempt and a Breakout Score around the 88th percentile in the tight end database. That's sick.

There was just minimal after-the-catch potential for Koziol, and he has bottom-15 career numbers in that category among tight ends with data since 2014, via PFF, in the model. That's interesting, given the solid athletic testing that didn't include only straight-line speed but also good explosiveness. Additionally, he gets knocked heavily for his blocking ability, and that alone could be driving down the draft capital interest.

His draft board projections are all over the place, and if drafted on the higher end of those (Round 4), the ZAP score jumps markedly. But all the traits in the world don't matter if no NFL teams see the same thing and use Koziol like similar prospects before him.



Dae'Quan Wright • TE



19.5

ZAP Score

MISSISSIPPI

DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'4 Weight: 246 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Zach Davidson ▪ Noah Gray ▪ Virgil Green

Dae'Quan Wright began his college career at Virginia Tech, making a bit of an impact (19 catches for 208 yards) as a true freshman in 2022. He then saw his role expand as a Hokie in 2023 but wound up transferring to Ole Miss and finding paydirt nine times in 28 games while being more involved as a receiver.

Overall, Wright's max yards per team attempt is a slight tick above the sample average, and his Breakout Score is about average. That's not bad, especially if he's as fast as his game tape makes him look.

While he didn't run the 40 at the NFL Combine, his yards-after-catch ability and downfield attention are what separate his profile from many in this year's class. Wright easily leads this year's tight end class in career yards after the catch per reception, per PFF, and he's 11th (out of 27 combine-invited tight ends) in average depth of target – fractions of a yard away from a top-eight number.

This all makes more sense when you learn that he had actually made some starts for Ole Miss as a wide receiver. That's a very important wrinkle to his profile, as we're obviously seeking receiving production at the NFL level.

Given the time at wide receiver and enough positives in his profile, Wright has the potential to become a relevant tight end in the NFL for fantasy purposes, but it's hard to make him a true priority in rookie drafts. His blocking seems like enough of a concern that he could find it hard to earn reliable snaps, and it seems to be reducing his draft capital.

From a fantasy football standpoint, he could be one of the bigger overperformers among this year's tight end class in the right situation. That situation being that his draft capital stays low (Round 6), but a team uses him as a big-bodied receiver and doesn't care that his blocking is below average. There's legitimate fantasy football potential here for Wright, but it's a profile that requires an NFL team buying into what he does best.



John Michael Gyllenborg • TE



18.2

ZAP Score

WYOMING
DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'6 Weight: 249 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Virgil Green ▪ Chris Gragg ▪ Zack Kuntz

John Michael Gyllenborg had some top-tier athletic testing, but we'll circle back to that – because his profile probably needs some context first.

After redshirting in 2021 (he didn't even play football until his senior year in high school), Gyllenborg was at Wyoming for four more years, maxing out with a 30-catch, 425-yard, 3-touchdown season in 2024, all career highs (or matching a career high, in the case of touchdowns) in a low-volume passing offense.

Adjusting his best season for age and schedule, Gyllenborg's max yards per team attempt does grade out well (69th percentile in the tight end database), yet his Breakout Score is about average despite that.

Gyllenborg logged just nine games in each of his final two seasons at Wyoming, missing time with various injuries, including a hamstring issue in 2025. That could easily have held back his true upside; the receiving production could've been better if he were healthier. Along those lines, his average depth of target was basically cut in half (12.4 to 6.6, via PFF) from 2024 to 2025. So, yes, it was a production decline – but at least it had some explanation.

The Combine-tested broad jump and vertical were great, as was the shuttle time. He ran a 4.60-second 40-yard dash at 6'6", 249 pounds (a 114.2 height-adjusted Speed Score), but size and scores like that are getting more and more common, particularly in this class.

While that doesn't necessarily mean that he's just another guy, it does mean that his draft capital will tell us whether NFL teams are buying into that size, athleticism, and production from a smaller school while also being tied to some iffy blocking tape.

It's a pretty decent profile that won't mean anything without a franchise buying in, but it's also not displaying many traits of elite fantasy football production, either.



Nate Boerkircher • TE



17.7

ZAP Score

TEXAS A&M
DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'6 Weight: 245 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Jackson Hawes ▪ Charlie Woerner ▪ Blake Bell

Based on the receiving production, you wouldn't expect much buzz around Nate Boerkircher in the draft process. But he's getting some mid-round attention.

Boerkircher spent his first five seasons at Nebraska (including the COVID season in 2020) before transferring to Texas A&M in (technically) his sixth season in college.

It took until that 2025 season to catch more than six passes in a year, though, and even in 2025, he caught 19 balls for 198 yards.

Despite that, he's pretty consistently regarded as a tight end who will get drafted, even with that type of background.

If he's faster than projected (he didn't run the 40), and a team really banks on the intangibles and blocking, there could be something. It would just be an all-time outlier situation with a production profile as minimal as his if he really emerged as an elite fantasy football tight end.



Josh Cuevas • TE



16.3

ZAP Score

ALABAMA

DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'3 Weight: 245 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Gavin Bartholomew ▪ Grant Calcaterra ▪ Temarrick Hemingway

Josh Cuevas enters the NFL Draft process after five years of college football at three different schools: Cal Poly, Washington, and Alabama.

As you may expect, with a trajectory like that, the Breakout Score for Cuevas isn't anything to get excited about (31st percentile). Obviously, there was increased competition with each of his landing spots, but we're tying a lot of the receiving belief in Cuevas' profile to his fifth college season at Alabama, where he was able to post a 50th-percentile max yards per team attempt rate after adjusting for schedule and age.

And after a deeper look at that receiving data, there are some red flags, like that Cuevas' average depth of target in 2025 wasn't great (it was better than for other Alabama tight ends – but not by a lot).

There are also some green flags, like that Cuevas' career yards after the catch per reception was better than average for incoming tight end prospects, and you see that potential on tape. He split out wide at the highest career rate (in his three years from Washington and Alabama, via PFF) among this year's class.

Given his size and skillset, Cuevas is very much in the fullback or H-tight end category and might wind up being more of a safety valve-type tight end than a primary pass-catcher in the NFL. This puts him into a bit of a high-floor, low-ceiling tier.

That profile actually gives him a pretty wide range of pre-draft rankings. NFL teams might welcome what he brings to the table and draft him on the early end of that spectrum. Even at the high end, his comps in the model would look similar to Ian Thomas and Nick Vannett types.



Riley Nowakowski • TE



12.5

ZAP Score

INDIANA

DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'2 Weight: 250 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Tyler Davis ▪ Ryan Taylor ▪ Eric Saubert

Riley Nowakowski played six years in college, five of them at Wisconsin, with his final year at Indiana.

It took a long while for him to find his footing as a tight end, and he didn't log more than 11 catches or 74 yards until his final season, when he caught 32 balls in 16 games for 387 yards (24.2 yards per game).

Adjusting all of that for age and schedule, Nowakowski just finds himself near the bottom of the tight end database in meaningful receiving metrics and Breakout Score.

Despite being a short tight end (6'2", 250), Nowakowski actually profiles more as a blocking tight end than an undersized pure receiver and spent most of his career as an inline player. He rates out as well as he does because tight end is a tricky position to examine for fantasy football purposes. His traits are getting him top-15 tight end draft capital projections as a top-200 pick. A top-200 pick who's primarily a blocker still has a better fantasy football outlook than a great pass-catching tight end who isn't even on a team.

There's just not a lot here to indicate future fantasy football output in a needle-moving capacity.



Matthew Hibner • TE



8.6

ZAP Score

SOUTHERN METHODIST
DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'4 Weight: 251 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Jake Stoneburner ▪ Schuyler Oordt ▪ Matt Furstenberg

Matthew Hibner is one of two tight ends from Southern Methodist invited to the NFL Combine (the other being RJ Maryland). That alone can complicate his receiving profile a bit.

Looking at the data before accounting for that competition, Hibner didn't do much to stand out. He spent six years in college (four at Michigan and two at Southern Methodist) and failed to crack 1.0 max yards per team attempt after adjusting for age and schedule.

He didn't see much volume (two catches in three years at Michigan) until his time at Southern Methodist, when he hauled in 24 passes for 368 yards in his first year as a transfer. He built on that with a 31-catch, 436-yard line in his final season and scored four times in both of his seasons with the Mustangs.

Not only did Hibner play alongside Maryland, but Romello Brinson and Jordan Hudson are also draft-eligible wide receivers, with Hudson also getting a Combine invite. It was a fairly crowded target tree. Still, we can't ignore the lack of production at Michigan and the late emergence of Hibner.

With that said, the 4.57-second 40-yard dash is good for a height-adjusted Speed Score of 115.1. It's just unlikely to lead to much at all, given the receiving profile and undrafted projection for Hibner.



Jaren Kanak • TE



7.5

ZAP Score

OKLAHOMA

DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'2 Weight: 234 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Jaheim Bell ▪ Colt Lyster ▪ Stephen Anderson

Jaren Kanak has a really noteworthy profile, but it's not leading to much in the way of projected draft capital.

Kanak, a high school track athlete and dual-threat quarterback, was a four-star recruit as an athlete with interest from a lot of big programs. He ran a 4.52-second 40-yard dash at the Combine, equating to a height-adjusted Speed Score of 109.2. While that's not bad by any means, virtually every tight end who ran this year graded out well by that metric. Still, the athleticism alone is noteworthy.

However, he measured in at the NFL Combine at 6'2", 234 pounds, making him both the shortest and lightest of all 27 invited tight ends. Noteworthy, though.

But get this: Kanak didn't have a catch at Oklahoma until his final season...because he was a linebacker before converting to tight end ahead of the 2025 season. Noteworthy.

So, if he got a Combine invite, he must have been relevant this year, right? Yep. He went out and caught 44 passes for 533 yards, both third-best on the Sooners, while playing alongside Combine-invited wide receiver Deion Burks.

Because he wound up being significantly productive, his age- and schedule-adjusted max yards per team attempt and Breakout Score are actually above average since he's still relatively young.

Transparently, Kanak has an uphill battle to fantasy football production given the size and consensus draft projections, but we've seen plenty of fantasy-relevant tight ends enter the league with minimal reps at the position – guys who came over from basketball, for example. It's the type of profile that – if NFL teams considered him a Round 4 guy – could easily be putting him in the mix. Without that buy-in, we can't get out over our skis on the speed and potential.



Will Kacmarek • TE



7.4

ZAP Score

OHIO STATE

DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'6	Weight: 261	NFL Team: TBD
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Statistical Comps: Noah Gindorff ▪ David Wells ▪ Dax Raymond

Will Kacmarek weighed in at 261 pounds at the NFL Combine, making him the second-heaviest tight end in the class (of the 27 players invited).

He ran a 4.74-second 40-yard dash at a nice size for a 106.1 height-adjusted Speed Score. While he has size and athleticism, he doesn't have the receiving background to get us too excited.

Kacmarek played three seasons at Ohio before transferring to Ohio State for two more seasons. Even at Ohio, he didn't average more than 19.0 yards per game in either season, and he caught just 23 passes in 26 games at Ohio State within one of the most crowded pass-catching groups in the country.

He was primarily a blocking tight end with some good per-route receiving data, so it's nice to see that he was functional when called upon. Grades-wise and film-wise, he's one of the best blocking tight ends in the class, and that could certainly lead to his name being called toward the end of the draft.

From there, we're probably unlikely to see too much receiving production. If we had a model centered on predicting total snaps or overall utility, Kacmarek would look better. But when seeking fantasy football production, Kacmarek probably isn't our guy.



RJ Maryland • TE



7.1

ZAP Score

SOUTHERN METHODIST

DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'4 Weight: 236 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Caleb Wilson ▪ Colt Lyster ▪ Bucky Hodges

Based on age- and schedule-adjusted data, RJ Maryland is one of the better receiving tight ends in this year's class – and, frankly, in the entire tight end database.

But you wouldn't know it based on the pre-draft hype, which is why the ZAP Score and the comps are uninspiring. Maryland, the son of Russell Maryland (the first overall pick in the 1991 NFL Draft), is projected to go undrafted most places you look.

Maryland tore his ACL during the 2024 season, ending with just seven games played. But he bounced back with a solid senior year and ran a 4.51-second 40-yard dash, tied for second-fastest among runners in this year's class.

We have to point out that Maryland weighed in as the second-lightest tight end at the Combine at just 236 pounds. His weight-adjusted vertical was also poor, yet we've seen plenty of other pass-catching tight ends play well despite that being the case (Zach Ertz, OJ Howard, Dalton Schultz types) though those players were all bigger and heavier.

Let's look at some of that production I've mentioned. Maryland spent all four college seasons at Southern Methodist, churning out 113 catches, 1,495 yards, and 19 touchdowns in 46 games, finishing with a career 13.2 yards per catch rate. He also maintained at least 1.60 yards per route run, per PFF, for each of the last three seasons: really solid for a tight end.

And for additional context here, Maryland put up these good numbers sharing time with Jordan Hudson (a Combine-invited receiver), Romello Brinson (a draft-eligible receiver), and Matthew Hibner (a Combine-invited tight end). Maryland was still pretty productive as a freshman with Rashee Rice logging 96 catches for 1,355 yards in 2022.

But if none of this age-adjusted data and a still-young draft age (he won't turn 22 until July) is getting NFL teams excited, then there's not much we can do. Maryland is small, even compared to a light tight end class. He may not transition to a plus blocker in the NFL, which he wasn't able to do in college. That might keep NFL teams from investing in his skillset.



Bauer Sharp • TE



6.5

ZAP Score

LOUISIANA STATE

DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'5 Weight: 249 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Stephen Sullivan ▪ Jack Stoll ▪ Jake Stoneburner

A better-than-projected 40-yard dash time of 4.63 at the NFL Combine raised Sharp's stock in the model – but not enough to make him particularly relevant in the fantasy football landscape. His stock could rise drastically, of course, but it seems unlikely this late in the process.

Sharp spent three seasons at Southeastern Louisiana and was a wildcat quarterback for a time before making the move to Oklahoma and then to LSU.

To say he just moved to Oklahoma would be a little bit of an understatement: he led the team in receptions and yards in his first year as a Sooner. To get too excited about that would be a bit of an overstatement, though: he had 42 catches for 324 yards (7.7 per reception) with 2 touchdowns.

At LSU in 2025, Sharp finished sixth on the team in catches (24) and yards (252) in his fifth and final college season.

That's still an overall strong progress curve, and it's a great story, but it's tied to a weak Breakout Score, and the production itself is questionable after adjusting for age and schedule.

Additionally, while he has just two years of charted PFF data, Sharp enters with the lowest average depth of target of the class: under 5.0 yards. It's still poor when you adjust for how his tight end teammates were used, and his career best aDOT was only 5.3.

Sharp's marks in max yards per team attempt and Breakout Score – both well below the model's average – are really good context for that plus athleticism.

Good athleticism with poor draft capital and production is telling us plenty about how he is able to use that athleticism. It's a core philosophy of the tight end model. As a result, Sharp isn't expected to make much of an impact on Sundays moving forward.



Miles Kitzelman • TE



6.2

ZAP Score

TENNESSEE

DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'5	Weight: 251	NFL Team: TBD
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Statistical Comps: Payne Durham ▪ Jackson Hawes ▪ James O'Shaughnessy

Poor athletic testing was rare for tight ends at the Combine this year.

Of course, only 20 of 27 Combine-invited tight ends ran the 40, but of those who did, only one ran slower than a 4.74: Miles Kitzelman (4.90). That equates to an 88.2 height-adjusted Speed Score. That's 12th-percentile in the tight end model.

That doesn't automatically mean there's nothing in the profile to get excited about. Because even with that athleticism, Kitzelman is drawing late-round draft projections, which makes him more interesting than most slow tight ends. It can mean there's something here with the production. Was there?

Eh.

Kitzelman started off his college career at Hutchinson Community College and then spent two years at Alabama before transferring elsewhere in the SEC to Tennessee.

In 2024, Kitzelman was fifth in receiving (301 yards) for the Volunteers in a crowded offense with Dont'e Thornton, Bru McCoy, and Chris Brazzell. He was fifth again in receiving (253 yards) in 2025 and struggled with drops.

There's a lack of explosiveness in the data (his career-long catch is 31 yards), and his vertical and broad jumps were weak, as well.

Even if drafted, Kitzelman rates out more as a helpful piece to the offense as a strong blocker than as a fantasy football stud.



DJ Rogers • TE



5.5

ZAP Score

TEXAS CHRISTIAN
DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'4 Weight: 258 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Beau Reliford ▪ Mason Schreck ▪ Ben Koyack

DJ Rogers isn't really registering on the tight end model much at all.

He played five years at TCU but didn't catch more than 12 passes until his fifth and final year, when he caught 34 balls for 319 yards (9.4 yards per reception) and 2 touchdowns.

In total, Rogers averaged under 1.4 yards per route run over his final three seasons, per PFF, and he was an underneath receiver by average depth of target, even after adjusting for team context.

Despite that profile – which includes some size and athleticism – film and scouting grades aren't in agreement with his baseline blocking ability, generally skewing toward the pessimistic end of the spectrum.

His lack of a good Breakout Score or peak receiving season hurts his potential for future fantasy football success. Profiles similar to Rogers' occasionally hit with some tangential fantasy relevance but rarely are tied to consistent fantasy production.

Rogers weighed in at 258 pounds at the Combine, third-heaviest in the class (out of 27 Combine-invited tight ends), and a long arm measurement could get a team interested solely based on his size.

Unfortunately, he didn't run the 40 at the Combine, so maybe a great pro day 40 vaults him up the draft board a bit, but as it is, Rogers is likely a fantasy afterthought who would spend more time blocking than running routes for an NFL team.



Khalil Dinkins • TE



5.2

ZAP Score

PENN STATE
DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'4 Weight: 251 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Bruno Labelle ▪ Shaun Beyer ▪ Keenen Brown

Khalil Dinkins is expected to go undrafted despite a 6'4", 251-pound frame.

Dinkins capped out at 14 catches and 167 yards in a single season at Penn State, and no matter how you slice the numbers, he's toward the bottom of the tight end database in terms of adjusted production.

He did post some good size-adjusted agility data at the Combine, but the explosiveness results were below-average, and the height-adjusted Speed Score (based on his 4.72-second 40-yard dash) is just about average.

Dinkins also repped 225 on the bench 25 times, which is over the threshold where we tend to see a signal that the given tight end is more of a blocking tight end than a receiving tight end.

He could find a spot on an NFL roster as a big-bodied, blocking tight end with some situational pass-catching opportunities, but at the end of the day, the receiving profile is too pedestrian to ignore for Dinkins when we're seeking pure fantasy football upside.



Lake McRee • TE



5.1

ZAP Score

SOUTHERN CALIFORNIA

DART THROW

Low Risk Neutral High Risk

Draft Capital Δ

Height: 6'4 Weight: 243 NFL Team: TBD

Statistical Comps: Quintin Morris ▪ Rory Anderson ▪ Drake Dunsmore

Lake McRee hits the NFL Draft process after five seasons at Southern California, ultimately finishing his career with 97 catches, 1,154 yards, and 7 touchdowns.

He had a production jump in 2025, turning 30 catches into 450 yards and 4 touchdowns: all career-high outputs. Whether with low volume or high (again, a max of 30 catches), McRee did average at least 10.1 yards per catch in all five seasons, ending his college career with an 11.9-yard career yards per catch rate – and a 15.0-yard mark as a fifth-year senior.

McRee's pretty light at 243 pounds, and he didn't test at the Combine (he only benched, resulting in 22 reps). Bench reps actually correlate pretty well with NFL receiving production for tight ends, and McRee is near that inflection point (around 24 reps when receiving correlations really start to swing as a whole).

In total, the max yards per team attempt and Breakout Score for McRee puts him around the 35th percentile for tight ends in the database. It's enough to keep us interested but only if draft capital follows.

Unlikely to evolve into a dominant run blocker at his size (including small hands and short arms), McRee profiles mostly as an average-to-below-average athlete after two ACL tears (one in high school and one in college).

There's unlikely to be much spike potential from McRee at the next level.

The Year 2 Model

Overview

There's a video game called *Rocket League* that's been around for a minute, and it's still wildly popular. At its core, it's simple: car soccer. You control a car and try to smash a ball into your opponent's goal.

I've played it on and off for years. It's one of those games you can jump into for 20 or 30 minutes, knock out a few five-minute matches, and move on.

When you queue up for an online game, *Rocket League* pairs you with teammates and opponents who have similar skill ratings. In theory, everyone on the field should be roughly equal.

In practice? Not always.

You can play with friends, but if you queue solo for a two-on-two or three-on-three match, you're paired with random teammates.

And those players can be total wildcards.

Within the first minute or two, you usually figure it out. Maybe your teammate is clearly outmatched. Maybe they're excellent, but their rating is suppressed by bad luck or poor teammates in previous games.

Your expectations adjust quickly once you see real information.

The same thing happens in fantasy football.

Prospects enter the league with a set of expectations based on what we knew about them coming out of college. Then they play actual NFL games. Suddenly, we have new data that either reinforces or challenges those original assumptions.

The question is: how much should those expectations change?



That's where the Year 2 Model comes in.

The goal of the Year 2 Model is to do a better job predicting a player's future performance — specifically his Year 2 through Year 4 B2S — than simply leaning on his rookie-season points per game.

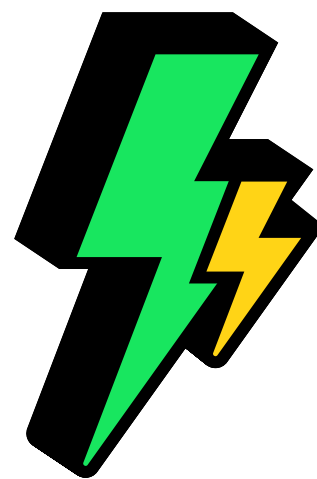
At both running back and wide receiver, the Year 2 Model combines a player's prospect score, certain rookie-season production inputs, and his rookie-year fantasy points per game to generate a Year 2 score. That score is designed to recalibrate expectations using both pre-draft information and what we actually saw on the field.

In previous iterations, the model focused on a player's best season in either Year 2 or Year 3. This year, that window has been expanded through Year 4.

Why? Because it gives us a larger, more stable sample to work with. Expanding the window allows the model to better capture delayed breakouts, injury interruptions, and uneven early-career development — all things that can distort shorter evaluations.

As you'd expect, the Year 2 Model does a much better job predicting a player's next three seasons than rookie-year points per game alone.

Just like the ZAP Model, the Year 2 Model can be summarized through probability tables. Players are grouped into the same categories you've already seen — Legendary Performer, Elite Producer, and so on — allowing us to clearly see how often different tiers of players go on to hit specific B2S thresholds.



Wide Receiver (Best Two-Year Average; Years 2-4)

	>10	>12	>14	>16	>18	>20
Legendary Performer	100.0%	100.0%	90.0%	60.0%	30.0%	30.0%
Elite Producer	88.9%	81.5%	74.1%	59.3%	22.2%	7.4%
Weekly Starter	61.8%	38.2%	21.8%	18.2%	1.8%	0.0%
Flex Play	15.3%	7.3%	2.4%	1.6%	0.0%	0.0%
Benchwarmer	1.6%	0.8%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%
Waiver Wire Add	1.1%	1.1%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%
Dart Throw	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%

Running Back (Best Two-Year Average; Years 2-4)

	>10	>12	>14	>16	>18	>20
Legendary Performer	100.0%	100.0%	100.0%	75.0%	75.0%	75.0%
Elite Producer	73.9%	65.2%	56.5%	34.8%	21.7%	17.4%
Weekly Starter	60.5%	37.2%	18.6%	14.0%	7.0%	4.7%
Flex Play	27.3%	14.8%	6.8%	2.3%	2.3%	0.0%
Benchwarmer	7.4%	3.7%	1.9%	1.9%	1.9%	0.0%
Waiver Wire Add	2.5%	1.7%	1.7%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%
Dart Throw	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%

The Year 2 Model is more predictive than the ZAP Model. Period. That's not because the ZAP Model is flawed. It's because we simply have more information. Once a player has completed his rookie season, we're no longer projecting how he might handle NFL competition — we've seen it.

We're deeper into the Rocket League match now. We've watched our teammate play. The skill rating makes more sense.

One thing you may notice when looking at the tables above is that the Year 2 Model behaves a little differently at running back than it does at wide receiver. Every elite Year 2–4 wide receiver lands in the Weekly Starter tier or above. At running back, though, a few productive players slip through the cracks.

There are real football reasons for that.

Running back production is often dictated by coaching decisions. If a staff wants a split backfield, it gets one. And for fantasy

purposes, split backfields are a problem — they lower ceilings and introduce volatility.

A running back can have a strong rookie season, but if his team decides to change roles, add competition, or rethink usage, that production doesn't always carry forward.

Wide receivers are different. There are more of them on the field. More routes. More chances to earn targets. When opportunity expands, talent tends to win out. That's ultimately what these models are trying to capture — talent — and it's why wide receiver outcomes are generally more predictable.

Running back is also a more replaceable position. That doesn't mean backs aren't valuable; it means teams know they can find usable production later in the draft or in free agency. When supply is high, demand drops — and that creates instability.

That instability shows up clearly in the data.

From 2011 through 2023, there were six running backs selected after Pick 100 who averaged at least 12 PPR points per game as rookies (minimum seven games played, relevant fantasy weeks only). When looking at those players' performances from Year 2 through Year 4, every single one of them peaked as a rookie. None improved their fantasy production after Year 1.

Ask yourself why that might be.

From a general manager's perspective, a Day 3 rookie having a big season doesn't automatically mean he's a long-term solution. Was it real talent? Or was it circumstance? Scheme? Injuries elsewhere?

Front offices will likely second guess themselves, wondering why that running back fell to the third day of the draft in the first place, regardless of his rookie-season production.

Because running backs are relatively easy to replace — and relatively inexpensive — teams often introduce competition quickly. That competition suppresses long-term fantasy ceilings, especially for later-round players.

In other words, rookie-year running back production is incredibly volatile.



That volatility is exactly why the Year 2 Model matters. It properly weighs rookie production within the broader context of prospect quality, role stability, and historical outcomes. It's not taking Year 1 numbers at face value.

Journey Comparables

At some point, every fantasy analyst ends up asking the same question:

Have we seen this before?

When something weird happens in the league, we ask it. When a player posts an absurd stat line, we ask it. When a team wins nine straight games by a field goal or less, we ask it.

The Year 2 Model helps answer that question through Journey Comparables.

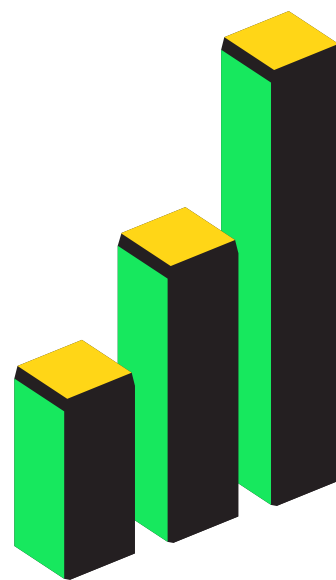
You've already seen statistical comparables tied to the ZAP Model. Journey Comparables are different. Instead of comparing player attributes as they enter the league, they compare players based on how their evaluation changes.

Specifically, Journey Comparables look at a player's ZAP score alongside his Year 2 Model score and identify historical players who followed a similar path — from pre-draft expectations to post-rookie-season reality.

They ignore play style, size, athletic testing, and role. The only thing that matters is the journey: how a player was viewed entering the league, and how that view changed after Year 1.

History doesn't repeat itself perfectly.

But in fantasy football, it rhymes often enough to matter.



2026 Year 2 Profiles

Overview

Drafting Kaleb Johnson was one of the most painful experiences a dynasty manager could've had last year. Drafting Luther Burden? It took a minute, but his managers are probably feeling pretty good right now.

But what happens next?

That's where the Year 2 Model profiles step in.

Over this final section of the guide, you'll get analysis on every wide receiver and running back from last year's draft class who ranks as at least a Flex Play in the Year 2 Model.

You'll see how the Year 2 Model scores them, and you'll get insight on how to manage each player moving forward.

It's time to fix those dynasty rosters.

Key Terms

ZAP Score: The score given to an incoming rookie in the ZAP Model. It's based on the factors outlined in the ZAP Model Overview section of this guide. All scores range from 0 to 100.

Y2 Score: The score given to a running back or wide receiver in the Year 2 Model. This is based on rookie-season numbers along with a player's ZAP score. All scores range from 0 to 100.

Y2 Score Category: Every player's Year 2 score coincides with one of seven categories, which were talked about earlier. Those categories will be listed on every player's Year 2 profile page.

Journey Comparables: Players in history who have had similar ZAP and Year 2 Model scores.

Year 2 Wide Receiver



Elite Producer

Tetairoa McMillan..... 138

Emeka Egbuka..... 139

Luther Burden..... 140



Weekly Starter

Jayden Higgins..... 141

Travis Hunter..... 142



Flex Play

Elic Ayomanor..... 143

Matthew Golden..... 144

Pat Bryant..... 145

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Chimere Dike..... 147

Jaylin Noel..... 148

Jack Bech..... 149

Isaac TeSlaa..... 150

Isaiah Bond..... 151

Kyle Williams..... 152

Tory Horton..... 153

Tez Johnson..... 154



Tetairoa McMillan • WR

88.3

Y2 Score

CAROLINA PANTHERS
ELITE PRODUCER


82.7

ZAP Score

Journey Comps: Brian Thomas ▪ AJ Brown ▪ Justin Jefferson

Tetairoa McMillan wants to be called T-Mac. Just before interviewing him on Radio Row back in early February, his reps approached us and stressed that point. T-Mac. Nothing but T-Mac.

And honestly, I'll call him whatever he wants after his fantastic rookie season. The man balled out.

McMillan – sorry, T-Mac – finished his rookie campaign with a 25.4% target share and a 1.84 yards-per-route-run rate. Since 2011, the only rookie wide receivers to clear both a 25% target share and a 1.80 yards-per-route-run mark are Odell Beckham, Mike Evans, Puka Nacua, Justin Jefferson, Brian Thomas, Malik Nabers, Drake London, Chris Olave, and... Kelvin Benjamin.

That's a lot of insane wide receiver talent. And Kelvin Benjamin.

Looking at first-down share, T-Mac clears again. His per-game first-down share sat at 32.4% last season, the fourth-highest mark among all wide receivers in the Year 2 Model database. The three players ahead of him? Malik Nabers, Odell Beckham Jr., and Puka Nacua.

Pretty great company!

T-Mac averaged just 12.4 PPR points per game thanks to a below-average catchable target rate and an offense that ranked in the bottom five in pass rate over expected. Those two factors could limit his ceiling a bit moving forward – Bryce Young isn't the most complete quarterback, and Dave Canales leans toward a run-centric offense. Over his two years in Carolina, the Panthers have had below-average pass rate over expected numbers.

That's the thing that might stop T-Mac. Because from a talent perspective, McMillan has the tools to be a true difference-maker at the next level. His Journey Comparables of A.J. Brown and Justin Jefferson underscore that point.

If you've got McMillan on your dynasty squad, you should feel great about it. The ceiling is high if the circumstances surrounding him improve. Even if they don't, he should still be very usable.



Emeka Egbuka • WR

77.7

Y2 Score

TAMPA BAY BUCCANEERS
ELITE PRODUCER


81.5

ZAP Score

Journey Comps: Kendall Wright ▪ Allen Robinson ▪ Rome Odunze

Emeka Egbuka's rookie season is difficult to summarize without sounding dramatic. Because the production split is genuinely extreme.

Over the first five weeks of the season, Egbuka averaged more than 20 PPR points per game. From that point forward, his average fell to just 8.3. That's not a gradual decline – that's a cliff.

When researching his profile, the first thing I wanted to know was whether this kind of early-season surge followed by a prolonged drop-off actually shows up in historical data. Have we seen rookie wide receivers start this strong and then fade this dramatically?

The answer? Not really.

Among Year 2 Model wide receivers, a drop like this simply hasn't happened. Puka Nacua averaged over 20 PPR points per game through Week 6 as a rookie, but finished the season closer to 16. Calvin Ridley is a better comparison – he averaged 19.7 PPR points per game through Week 4 of his rookie year before falling to 10.7 the rest of the way. Even then, that decline wasn't nearly as severe as what we saw from Egbuka.

That's why it's important to zoom out and look at the full sample. Egbuka entered the league with a strong ZAP score, and his full-season rookie numbers were impressive: a 1.75 yards per route run rate, a target share just shy of 24%, and the second-most first downs among wideouts in his draft class.

Egbuka also lands in excellent company with his Year 2 Model score of 77.7. Within the Year 2 Model database – prior to this most recent draft class – we've seen eight wide receivers with Year 2 scores within three points of Egbuka's who also posted a yards-per-route-run rate north of 1.60. Those players? Allen Robinson, DJ Moore, DK Metcalf, Terry McLaurin, Chase Claypool, Amon-Ra St. Brown, Rashee Rice, and Zay Flowers.

Not bad.

We shouldn't call Egbuka bust-proof – just take a look at that first Journey Comparable – but landing in the Elite Producer category gives him strong odds to be at least a WR2 in fantasy football moving forward. Especially now that Mike Evans is gone. And especially when his 58% catchable targets rate – a 4th percentile number – regresses favorably.

Luther Burden • WR

77.4
Y2 Score

CHICAGO BEARS

ELITE PRODUCER

 87.7
ZAP Score

Journey Comps: Brandin Cooks ▪ Xavier Worthy ▪ DJ Moore

The ZAP Model has an almost irrational love for Luther Burden. You saw it in last year’s guide, but the latest iteration of the model may like him even more.

That might not be a bad thing.

Burden didn’t see the route share we were hoping for in 2025 – he failed to reach a 70% route share in a single game – and that limited him to just 8.6 PPR points per game in relevant contests.

That low points-per-game output is a little concerning. The Year 2 Model dates back to 2011, and only 20 wide receivers in the database who averaged fewer than 10 PPR points per game as rookies went on to post a 14-plus PPR points-per-game season in Years 2, 3, or 4. That’s out of hundreds of wide receivers.

Burden, however, wasn’t quite like those other players. When he did get on the field, he was excellent.

Burden finished the season with a 2.69 yards per route run rate – the third-best rookie-season mark since 2011, trailing only Martavis Bryant and Odell Beckham (minimum 100 routes). He was also targeted on nearly 25% of his routes run.

That combination is rare, even among lower-volume wide receivers. Burden ran just 242 regular-season routes in 2025. Among Year 2 Model wideouts with between 150 and 350 routes run, only nine managed to post a yards-per-route-run rate above 2.0 and earn targets on at least 20% of their routes. Four of those nine went on to produce a season of 15 or more PPR points per game between Years 2 and 4.

There’s no doubt that projecting Burden to his ceiling requires some optimism. The volume wasn’t there in Year 1, and with a 45% slot rate (per PFF), we still haven’t seen him consistently win on the outside.

The good news is that the ZAP Model already loved him, and when Burden actually received opportunities in 2025, almost everything pointed in the right direction. Xavier Worthy is a difficult Journey Comparable to fully buy into, but a Brandin Cooks or DJ Moore outcome is well within reason. And those paths are even more realistic now that DJ Moore is out of Chicago.

If you want a high-ceiling, higher-volatility wide receiver target in dynasty this offseason, Burden’s definitely your guy. Just be aware that the market has become far more bullish post-DJ Moore trade.



Jayden Higgins • WR

63.9

Y2 Score

HOUSTON TEXANS

WEEKLY STARTER



65.5

ZAP Score

Journey Comps: Michael Pittman ▪ Dante Pettis ▪ Davante Adams

The Texans were pretty infuriating with their wide receiver usage in 2025, rotating players frequently and often giving Xavier Hutchinson more snaps than rookie Jayden Higgins. As a result, Higgins finished the regular season with just a 56% route share – a figure that ranked below players like Van Jefferson and David Sills.

When you include the playoffs, though, things look a little different. Higgins reached an 80% route share three times last year, and in those games, he scored 11.9, 10.3, and 13.4 PPR points. In his next-highest route share game (68%), he posted 13.8 PPR points.

Maybe let him run more routes?

From an efficiency standpoint, Higgins' rookie-year metrics were perfectly respectable. His 1.45 yards per route run was fairly ordinary for a first-year wide receiver, and he was targeted on fewer than 20% of his routes. His catch rate over expected was exactly average – literally 0%.

That said, Higgins was still better than both Christian Kirk and Xavier Hutchinson in Houston last season, the two wide receivers he was competing with most for snaps. He outpaced them in yards per route run, EPA per target, and catch rate over expected, while also posting an average depth of target north of 12 yards.

“Solid” is probably the best word to describe Higgins' rookie season. He was used primarily as an intermediate option, and he mostly got the job done. With Hutchinson as beatable competition and Kirk no longer on the team, there's a legitimate path for Higgins to step into a larger role in Year 2.

And that's exciting, because Higgins' Journey Comps are pretty interesting. They do paint a very high-variance picture, though.



Travis Hunter • WR

62.6

Y2 Score

JACKSONVILLE JAGUARS

WEEKLY STARTER



82.4

ZAP Score

Journey Comps: Quentin Johnston ▪ Henry Ruggs ▪ Alshon Jeffery

Travis Hunter will go down as one of the most difficult prospect evaluations I've ever had. The ZAP Model was never particularly fond of him, and the updated version likes him even less. That's largely because his collegiate analytical profile simply wasn't anything to write home about.

You can excuse some of that given Hunter's two-way role at Colorado, but that versatility only added more uncertainty to his projection. Still, thanks to his draft capital, he was slotted into the top tier of last year's rookie drafts.

At one point, it looked like Hunter might justify that investment. He appeared to be on the verge of becoming Jacksonville's top target earner before an LCL injury cut his rookie season short. That injury forced the Jaguars' front office to act, and they responded by acquiring veteran wide receiver Jakobi Meyers at the deadline.

Hunter's LCL may end up having longer-term fantasy implications. Jacksonville ultimately gave Meyers a new deal, locking him in through at least the 2027 season. While Hunter was sidelined, Parker Washington emerged as a viable slot option. And Brian Thomas remains entrenched on the outside with multiple years left on his rookie contract. (We'll see if that changes or not.)

So where does that leave Hunter in this offense?

The Jaguars don't have to force the issue with him. And analytically speaking, it's fair to ask whether they should. Nothing from Hunter's 2025 season meaningfully challenges his ZAP score. A 1.32 yards-per-route-run rate is underwhelming, and Jacksonville didn't target him at a particularly high rate when he was on the field – just 20% of his routes run saw a target. The breakout felt like it might be coming, but we can't say with confidence that it ever truly arrived.

Add in reporting from ESPN suggesting that Jacksonville views Hunter primarily as a cornerback with situational offensive packages, and the outlook becomes even murkier. As a dynasty manager, that's a tough pill to swallow.

In the short term – especially looking ahead to 2026 – the Jaguars have legitimate offensive options at wide receiver, and all signs point toward Hunter settling into something less than a lead role.

Hunter was more of a sell earlier in the offseason when the reporting wasn't as obvious about his role – his value on Keep Trade Cut has fallen by a decent bit since January. Now, you may have to wait for positive news to make any sort of sell move.



Elic Ayomanor • WR

59.3

Y2 Score

TENNESSEE TITANS

FLEX PLAY



36.0

ZAP Score

Journey Comps: Kenny Stills ▪ Tyjae Sharpe ▪ Darnell Mooney

It wasn't easy playing in the Titans' offense in 2025. Cam Ward finished the year with PFF's third-worst passing grade among quarterbacks with 200-plus drop backs, ahead of only Cleveland's Dillon Gabriel and Shedeur Sanders. His completion percentage over expected checked in at -3.0%, the fourth-lowest mark in the league.

That inefficiency bled directly into the pass-catching group. Elic Ayomanor, in particular, had it rough, finishing 71st among 76 qualified wide receivers in catchable target rate. Despite posting a respectable 18% target share as a rookie, Ayomanor averaged just 7.2 PPR points per game in relevant contests. That production was driven by inefficiency – his yards per route run rate sat at just 1.02.

Profiles like this don't hit at a high rate. In the Year 2 Model database, there are nine wide receivers – 10 if you include Ayomanor – who recorded a Year 1 target share between 15% and 20% while posting a yards-per-route-run rate below 1.20. That group includes Ace Sanders, Demarcus Ayers, Sterling Shepard, Tajae Sharpe, Corey Davis, Zay Jones, Jonathan Mingo, Rome Odunze, and Xavier Legette.

The only truly intriguing name there is Odunze, but he stands apart from the rest after posting by far the best yards per team pass attempt in the group. That's a metric that tends to be highly predictive. From that perspective, he's more the exception than the rule.

Ayomanor's Journey Comparables help clarify what his role could look like with an improved Cam Ward. During his two relevant seasons at Stanford, Ayomanor posted average depth of target rates north of 14 yards. That trend mostly carried over to the NFL, where his aDOT ranked well above average among wide receivers with 50-plus targets. His top pre-draft comp was Torrey Smith, and additional Journey Comparables like Kenny Stills and Darnell Mooney fit the same downfield mold.

Those comps aren't archetype matches, but they help frame Ayomanor properly. He's a player capable of spiked weeks and splash plays.

Given his talent profile, sustained fantasy consistency is unlikely. That's why the Flex Play tag fits him well. With that being said, the market is completely off of Ayomanor right now – you could easily argue that the Year 2 Model likes him more. So, from that perspective, it may not be a bad idea to get him as a trade throw-in.



Matthew Golden • WR

58.6

Y2 Score

GREEN BAY PACKERS

FLEX PLAY



68.5

ZAP Score

Journey Comps: Justin Hunter ▪ KJ Hamler ▪ Adonai Mitchell

There were plenty of red flags in Matthew Golden's prospect profile. For a first-round pick, his Breakout Score wasn't particularly strong, and his best single-season yards per route run mark was just 2.10 – a bottom-10 figure in last year's draft class.

Coming out of his rookie season, things didn't improve.

Golden's ZAP score was buoyed by strong draft capital, but it still wasn't anything to write home about. During the regular season, he totaled just 361 receiving yards on 267 routes run and averaged only 5.3 PPR points per game. We're still not writing home.

You could argue that Golden would've looked better had Green Bay simply used him more. His 1.35 yards per route run average isn't impressive, but we've seen worse – including from players who eventually turned into useful fantasy assets.

It's the combination of all of these factors that makes Golden such a scary investment.

Among all Year 2 Model wide receivers who failed to reach 7 PPR points per game as rookies, only seven went on to average at least 14 PPR points per game in either Year 2, 3, or 4. Two of those wideouts were Randall Cobb and Chris Godwin, and both posted yards per route run rates north of 2.0 as rookies. The peripherals were there to support future production.

That leaves five names: Davante Adams, Corey Davis, DJ Chark, Nico Collins, and Jameson Williams. Davis and Chark were never consistent WR2 assets in fantasy football, and Jameson Williams only missed that mark as a rookie because of injury.

So realistically, we're talking about Davante Adams and Nico Collins.

Sure, a bounce-back outcome exists for Golden. It's just not a likely one. And in a game of probability, that's obviously important.

Golden's Journey Comparables reinforce the concern. The published comps – Justin Hunter, KJ Hamler, and Adonai Mitchell – aren't exactly confidence-inducing. And if you zoom out beyond those names, the picture gets even bleaker: Zay Jones, Cordarrelle Patterson, Anthony Miller, Marvin Mims, Dante Pettis, Skyy Moore, Paul Richardson.

Davante Adams does appear in the behind-the-scenes comp list, but as we've already established, that's not the outcome you should be betting on.

The market still has *some* interest in Golden, but it's understandable if you'd rather just wait this thing out at this point. The Packers' wide receiver room could look different in 2026 as well, which only adds to the intrigue.

Just understand this: the odds aren't in his favor.



Pat Bryant • WR

56.0

Y2 Score

DENVER BRONCOS
FLEX PLAY


50.5

ZAP Score

Journey Comps: Donte Moncrief ▪ Nico Collins ▪ Tre'Quan Smith

For what looked like an overdrafted Day 2 selection by the Broncos, Pat Bryant's rookie season could've been worse. But make no mistake – it wasn't fantastic.

Beyond the raw numbers, Bryant posted just 1.22 yards per route run and recorded a first down on a little over 7% of his routes. He also failed to reach 5.0 PPR points per game, settling in at 4.8.

Those results aren't shocking for a Round 3 pick, but there wasn't much to get excited about with Bryant during most of the 2025 season.

If there's one positive to point to, it's how his role – and efficiency – changed as the year went on. From Weeks 1 through 8, Bryant saw just a 36% route share and averaged 3.6 PPR points per game. According to PFF data, his yards per route run during that stretch was an abysmal 0.48.

Then things shifted.

As the Broncos began to scale back Troy Franklin's usage, Bryant's route share jumped from 36% to 69% for the remainder of the regular season. His PPR points per game increased by four, and more importantly, his yards per route run climbed from 0.48 to a very respectable 1.58.

Courtland Sutton will turn 31 in October, and while Troy Franklin has proven to be a solid contributor, he hasn't shown himself to be an elite one. There's a path for Bryant to continue carving out a larger role in Denver's offense given his second-half surge.

And because the dynasty market largely views Bryant as an afterthought, he's the type of player worth throwing a dart at. The floor is low, but at this cost, seeing what he's got in 2026 makes plenty of sense.

Tre Harris • WR

LOS ANGELES CHARGERS

FLEX PLAY

53.5

Y2 Score

59.5

ZAP Score

Journey Comps: Ryan Broyles ▪ Jonathan Mingo ▪ Tyquan Thornton

The Chargers’ decision to add Keenan Allen to their wide receiver mix last summer had a clear impact on Tre Harris’ playing time. Harris finished the regular season with just a 43% route share, topping a 53% route participation rate in just three games. Unfortunately, in those contests, he scored only 4.8, 6.7, and 7.9 PPR points.

Harris exited his rookie season with a 1.10 yards per route run rate and a target on just 15% of his routes. Looking back at the ZAP Model, from 2011 to 2022, among wide receivers who posted scores between 55 and 75, there were 36 players who failed to reach both 1.20 yards per route run and a 17% targets-per-route threshold. Of those 36 wideouts, only three – Davante Adams, Michael Gallup, and DJ Chark – went on to average 10 or more PPR points per game in any of the next three seasons of their careers.

Now, those metrics aren’t the end-all. Context always matters. Harris played in an offense with three legitimate wide receivers, which naturally capped his opportunity and ceiling within these efficiency numbers. Even so, it’s hard to look at his rookie season – even after adjusting for team competition – and come away feeling particularly encouraged.

That said, Harris currently sits in WR6 territory in dynasty startups. At that cost, there’s little incentive to sell. Not only can some of the inefficiency be explained away by usage and situation, but 2026 could be a much friendlier environment for this Chargers offense. Mike McDaniel is now the offensive coordinator, and the team’s offensive line should be considerably healthier.

There’s a path to a decent rebound for Harris. Just don’t mistake that path for a guaranteed breakout.

Chimere Dike • WR

TENNESSEE TITANS

FLEX PLAY

52.2

Y2 Score



36.1

ZAP Score

Journey Comps: Greg Salas ▪ Quintez Cephus ▪ Tre Tucker

Chimere Dike was a pleasant surprise from the 2025 wide receiver class. His peripherals weren't eye-popping – he averaged just 1.02 yards per route run – but relative to expectations, Dike clearly outperformed them. After all, he finished the season leading the NFL in all-purpose yards.

That return-game production doesn't move the needle much for fantasy football, but it does speak to Dike's athleticism and ability with the ball in his hands – traits that should help him stick around the league.

The biggest problem for Dike right now is the Titans' signing of Wan'Dale Robinson. Brian Daboll brought in his former weapon from New York, and Robinson has been a career slot player, even if that slot usage dipped a bit in 2025.

Dike lived in the slot as a rookie, running 68% of his routes from that area of the field. The Titans also gave him a shallower role – 33% of his targets came behind the line of scrimmage, per PFF data. That usage likely signals some limitations in his overall route profile, and those cheaper looks could now find their way to Robinson.

Not ideal.

Pure slot receivers are becoming less fantasy relevant as offenses lean more into heavier personnel groupings, and Dike didn't enter the league as a standout route runner. Now he has Wan'Dale Robinson to deal with. You should keep him on your roster, but the odds of him becoming a significant fantasy contributor took a hit during free agency.

Jaylin Noel • WR

HOUSTON TEXANS

FLEX PLAY

50.6

Y2 Score



50.1

ZAP Score

Journey Comps: Austin Pettis ▪ Josh Palmer ▪ Marquise Goodwin

My subjective take is that the Year 2 Model is probably a little too low on Jaylin Noel. Objectively, though, his score makes sense.

The Texans barely deployed Noel in 2025 – he didn’t have a single game as a rookie with a 50% route share. It’s difficult for any player to project well in a forecasting model when the volume is that limited.

As expected, Noel was used primarily out of the slot as a rookie, just as he was at Iowa State. Houston deployed him in a very similar fashion, too. His average depth of target sat at just 9.1 yards, but nearly a quarter of his targets came on throws of 20 or more air yards. That aDOT was suppressed largely because 24% of his targets also came behind the line of scrimmage, one of the higher rates in the league.

And Noel does have downfield ability. He showed it in college, and as a rookie, he caught six of his eight deep targets, per PFF data. In fact, Noel finished second on the Texans in receptions on throws of 20-plus air yards, trailing only Nico Collins.

Where Noel may struggle – at least from a fantasy perspective – is in the intermediate area of the field. And that’s often a valuable place for fantasy production. Targets in the 10-to-19 air-yard window are likely to funnel toward Collins and Jayden Higgins, which could leave Noel with fewer of those high-leverage opportunities.

Still, Noel finished the season with a respectable 1.45 yards per route run and managed three double-digit PPR performances despite his limited role. If free agent Christian Kirk is out of Houston in 2026, Noel could carve out a slightly larger piece of the offense.

That role just isn’t likely to be as robust as we’d ideally want for fantasy purposes. Still, he’s a good player in my eyes.



Jack Bech • WR

49.8

Y2 Score

LAS VEGAS RAIDERS
FLEX PLAY


55.9

ZAP Score

Journey Comps: Taywan Taylor ▪ Mohamed Sanu ▪ Van Jefferson

We can maybe excuse Jack Bech's lack of production from Week 1 through Week 9 last season, when Jakobi Meyers was still on the roster in Las Vegas.

What's harder to excuse is what happened from Week 10 through the end of the year.

Yes, the Raiders' offense wasn't good. But Bech was competing for targets with Tre Tucker and 33-year-old Tyler Lockett during the second half of the season, and he still couldn't get much going.

Bech finished the year with just one game above 6.3 PPR points. From Week 10 onward, he posted a 42% route share. He wasn't fully healthy all season, but it's still difficult to sell a profile built on 1.15 yards per route run while drawing a target on only 15% of those routes.

Bech wasn't a ZAP Model darling coming out of college, though a score of 55.9 wasn't terrible. Here's the problem: in the Year 2 Model database, there are 18 wide receivers from 2011 to 2022 who entered the league with a ZAP score between 45 and 65 and then saw their Year 2 score end up 10 or more points below that. In other words, players who were fine prospects – whether due to draft capital or production – but had poor rookie seasons.

Of those 18 wideouts, only DJ Chark ever averaged more than 12 PPR points per game in any of his first four seasons. And even then, he was never a long-term fantasy staple.

The odds simply aren't in Jack Bech's favor.

But hey – maybe Klint Kubiak can save him.



Isaac TeSlaa • WR

49.4

Y2 Score

DETROIT LIONS

FLEX PLAY



54.4

ZAP Score

Journey Comps: Mohamed Sanu ▪ Taywan Taylor ▪ Cedric Tillman

Among all rookie wide receivers since 2011 who scored six or more touchdowns, Isaac TeSlaa did it on the fewest targets (27). He barely edged out... Mecole Hardman.

The whole “all he does is score touchdowns” narrative with TeSlaa is cute, but it’s not especially predictive. In fact, if you look at the rookie wideouts over the past 15 or so years who rank best in touchdowns per target (minimum six scores), the list is... not great: TeSlaa, Martavis Bryant, Hardman, Jalen McMillan, Anthony Miller, Jahan Dotson, Gabe Davis. Christian Watson, Ja’Marr Chase, and Mike Evans converted efficiently, too, but touchdown scoring alone isn’t a particularly meaningful piece of the puzzle.

Volume is. And efficiency on that volume is.

TeSlaa had neither in 2025.

Yes, TeSlaa faced serious competition in Detroit with Amon-Ra St. Brown and Jameson Williams, but he still finished the year with a 0.81 yards per route run rate. In the Year 2 Model database, there are 21 wide receivers who ran at least 200 routes as rookies and posted a sub-0.90 yards per route run figure. Only one of them – Nelson Agholor – ever averaged more than 10 PPR points per game in Year 2, 3, or 4. And even then, Agholor was more waiver-wire filler than fantasy cornerstone.

TeSlaa is a fun story, and he’s a fun player to watch – he throws his body around like Puka Nacua does. But it would be beyond shocking if he followed in Puka Nacua’s footsteps. Even 50% of Nacua’s production would be a win.



Isaiah Bond • WR

47.2

Y2 Score

CLEVELAND BROWNS
FLEX PLAY


23.1

ZAP Score

Journey Comps: AT Perry ▪ Jordan Whittington ▪ Albert Wilson

Out of the 200-plus undrafted wide receivers in the ZAP Model, Isaiah Bond's 23.1 score ranks sixth-best. Undrafted wideouts rarely go on to succeed at the NFL level, but Bond's situation was a little different. He slipped out of the draft due to off-the-field issues and eventually signed with Cleveland in mid-August.

And all things considered, his rookie season wasn't, like, horrific.

No one truly got it done for the Browns last year outside of Harold Fannin, but Bond finished second on the team in wide receiver targets. He trailed Jerry Jeudy in yards per route run by just 0.04, and while Cleveland's offense struggled to sustain drives, Bond still accounted for roughly 9.5% of the team's first-down receptions when active – a top-12 first-down share among last year's rookie class.

Still, peripherals like these rarely translate into long-term fantasy production. Bond finished just below the 1.0 yards per route run mark, and in the Year 2 Model database, only DJ Chark and Davante Adams have gone on to post WR2 seasons or better in any of the following three years after failing to reach that threshold as rookies.

And even if Bond beats those odds – do we really feel great about Cleveland's offensive environment in the short term?



Kyle Williams • WR

46.7

Y2 Score

NEW ENGLAND PATRIOTS
FLEX PLAY


51.6

ZAP Score

Journey Comps: David Bell ▪ Anthony Schwartz ▪ Tyler Johnson

The hype train was real for Kyle Williams last summer – and I’ll admit it, I bought in, too.

Unfortunately, that train came to a screeching halt midway through the season when it became clear this just wasn’t going to happen in 2025.

Williams finished the year with 10 catches. He played all 17 games, but topped a 50% route share only three times – and that came on a team that frequently rotated its wide receivers.

To his credit, Williams flashed some speed. He caught three touchdowns of 30 or more yards, including a 72-yard bomb against Tampa Bay in November. That was fun. But beyond his role as a deep-ball specialist, there isn’t much in the underlying profile to get excited about. Among wide receivers with at least 150 routes, Williams ranked 11th in 20-plus air-yard target rate last season.

His Journey Comparables don’t inspire much confidence, either. David Bell was a college production monster who never found footing in the NFL. Anthony Schwartz, another speed-based prospect, caught 10 passes as a rookie before totaling just four the rest of his career. And Tyler Johnson was well-liked by the ZAP Model as a Day 3 pick, but has since settled in as a journeyman wide receiver.

Hopefully, Williams beats those outcomes. But the most likely path here is that he becomes a high-variance bench asset in dynasty formats.



Tory Horton • WR

45.9

Y2 Score

SEATTLE SEAHAWKS

FLEX PLAY



31.5

ZAP Score

Journey Comps: Mack Hollins ▪ Marvin Jones ▪ Justin Hardy

Tory Horton put together a 4-catch, 48-yard, 2-touchdown performance in Week 9 against Washington. And then we didn't see him on a football field again.

Groin and shin injuries cut Horton's rookie season short, and that absence likely played a role in Seattle trading for Rashid Shaheed at the deadline.

Before the injury, Horton was doing his best Isaac TeSlaa impression, scoring five touchdowns on just 22 targets. As we've already established, those touchdown totals aren't particularly predictive. And unfortunately, the underlying metrics for Horton don't offer much reassurance, either.

Horton finished Year 1 with modest efficiency marks, posting 1.16 yards per route run and a 16% targets-per-route rate. His 10.6% target share wasn't notable, either.

Still, there's a reasonable case to give Horton the benefit of the doubt. We're working entirely with early-season data, and we know rookie wide receivers often take a step forward during the second half of their first campaigns. Horton also graded out reasonably well as a prospect – his 31.5 ZAP score as the 166th overall pick resulted in a strong Draft Capital Delta.

Looking ahead, there's at least some reason to like Horton as a talent, but the Seahawks re-signing Shaheed definitely hurts his short-term outlook. We shouldn't view Horton as anything more than a deep bench stash at this point.



Tez Johnson • WR

44.9

Y2 Score

TAMPA BAY BUCCANEERS
FLEX PLAY


11.0

ZAP Score

Journey Comps: Jake Bobo ▪ Darius Johnson ▪ Jakobi Meyers

Tez Johnson has already handed the ZAP Model an L. Seriously. The model viewed Johnson as a weak prospect, and he's already outperformed those expectations at the NFL level.

You win some, you lose some.

Johnson's rookie season was a bit funky. His per-route metrics were well below average, but from roughly Week 5 through Week 12, he was at least usable in fantasy football. That window closed once Chris Godwin, Jalen McMillan, and Mike Evans all returned to the lineup. There was never going to be sustained opportunity for Johnson in an offense that deep at wide receiver.

Because of Tampa Bay's depth, Johnson didn't spend as much time in his natural slot role as expected. According to PFF, he lined up in the slot on fewer than 40% of his snaps. That said, the Buccaneers have largely ignored strict receiver alignments in recent years, so if there's a team that won't immediately pigeonhole Johnson into one role, it's probably them.

Still, the slot is almost certainly where Johnson fits best long term. Per PFF data, he averaged 1.19 yards per route run from the slot last season, compared to roughly 1.01 when aligned out wide. That gap isn't massive, but it lines up with what we saw in college, where Johnson lived – and thrived – inside.

The problem is opportunity. A consistent slot role isn't likely to open up as long as Chris Godwin is healthy in Tampa Bay, and Godwin is expected to stick around for at least another year. Mike Evans is now gone, which should give Johnson a chance to settle in as a top-four option in the offense, but it's still a tough environment for a young, fringe wide receiver.

At the very least, we know Johnson can function as a flex fill-in if injuries hit that receiver room again. And having Jakobi Meyers as a top comp can't be a bad thing for a player this low on the list.

Year 2 Running Back



Legendary Performer

Ashton Jeanty..... 156



Elite Producer

Omarion Hampton..... 157

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Weekly Starter

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Flex Play

Bhayshul Tuten..... 162

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Devin Neal..... 168



Ashton Jeanty • RB

99.6

Y2 Score

LAS VEGAS RAIDERS

LEGENDARY PERFORMER



100.0

ZAP Score

Journey Comps: Todd Gurley ▪ Jahmyr Gibbs ▪ Christian McCaffrey

Ashton Jeanty scored a perfect 100 in the updated ZAP Model, something only Christian McCaffrey, Saquon Barkley, and Jahmyr Gibbs have also done. And yet, you could argue – fairly convincingly – that Jeanty had the worst rookie season of the four.

Among 48 qualified running backs last year, Jeanty ranked dead last in both success rate and EPA per rush, per Next Gen Stats. He was 43rd in yards per carry.

That's scary. But let me calm your fears: it doesn't *really* matter.

Running back production is driven heavily by situation in a given year, and Jeanty's situation was brutal. Among backs with at least 100 carries, Quinshon Judkins was the only one, per PFF, to see fewer yards before contact per attempt than Jeanty. Unsurprisingly, Las Vegas' offensive line ranked 30th in PFF's run-blocking grades.

With Year 2 backs, volume is the signal we care about most – it tells us the team wanted to feature the player. Jeanty had that signal. The Year 2 Model uses a weighted opportunity formula to capture workload, and Jeanty's volume score ranks 10th-best in the database. He saw meaningful work both as a rusher and receiver, which carries strong predictive value for future seasons.

Especially when paired with a perfect prospect score.

Running back ZAP scores are actually more predictive of future success than Year 1 PPR points per game. Jeanty's 14.5 PPR points per game wasn't disastrous – it simply fell short of lofty expectations. The underlying profile still does the heavy lifting.

If there's one area worth monitoring, it's his big-play rate. Jeanty recorded a 20-plus-yard run on just 1.1% of his carries last season. Among the six other running backs to reach Legendary Performer status in the Year 2 Model, only Christian McCaffrey failed to clear a 3% big-play rate. That's at least mildly concerning.

Still, Jeanty's comparables couldn't be any stronger. And yes, it's a little uncomfortable seeing his name alongside those guys after a relatively underwhelming rookie campaign. I understand that hesitation.

But this is where trusting the process matters.

You don't have to rank him as the RB1 in dynasty. You don't even need to push him aggressively above his current market price. But you should feel confident about Jeanty's three-year outlook – especially with the change to the coaching staff and, ideally, the quarterback position.



Omarion Hampton • RB

87.2

Y2 Score

LOS ANGELES CHARGERS
ELITE PRODUCER


89.5

ZAP Score

Journey Comps: Leonard Fournette ▪ Ezekiel Elliott ▪ Trent Richardson

Does the ZAP Model like Omarion Hampton a little too much? Maybe. But aside from injury, it's not as if he flopped as a rookie.

Out of 48 qualified running backs, Hampton ranked 15th in rushing yards over expected per attempt last season, per Next Gen Stats. He was 22nd in success rate – and that came behind an offensive line that graded out as the worst run-blocking unit in the league, according to PFF.

It was also encouraging to see him involved as a pass-catcher. The ZAP Model viewed Hampton as a capable receiver entering the league, and in an offense (Greg Roman was offensive coordinator) that doesn't typically feature running backs heavily through the air, he posted a target share north of 12%.

From 2011 through 2022, there have been 10 running backs in the Year 2 Model database who entered the league as Legendary Performers or Elite Producers and then earned at least a 12% target share as rookies. Among those backs, only Trent Richardson and Giovani Bernard failed to provide an RB1 season within their next three campaigns.

The situation in LA also appears to be trending in the right direction. The Chargers added Mike McDaniel to coordinate the offense, and both Rashawn Slater and Joe Alt are expected to be healthy in 2026. Even if Kimani Vidal's emergence trims Hampton's workload slightly – or even the addition of Keaton Mitchell – there's little reason to believe Hampton can't ascend into high-end fantasy territory as soon as this season.

Yes, seeing Trent Richardson pop up as a Journey Comparable is uncomfortable. But Hampton-type profiles historically perform far better. That comp exists to keep us grounded, not to define the projection.



TreVeyon Henderson • RB

76.2

Y2 Score

NEW ENGLAND PATRIOTS
ELITE PRODUCER


67.0

ZAP Score

Journey Comps: Josh Jacobs ▪ Javonte Williams ▪ Kenneth Walker

TreVeyon Henderson had a strange rookie season.

We didn't see a true breakout until Week 10, when Rhamondre Stevenson was sidelined. But when it happened, it was loud. Henderson rushed for 147 yards on 14 carries against Tampa Bay and then posted at least 80 total yards in each of the next four games.

A concussion in Week 16 stalled that momentum. And even once he returned during New England's playoff run, Stevenson handled the majority of the backfield work – Henderson logged a sub-40% snap share from the Divisional Round onward.

One clear takeaway from Year 1 was Henderson's explosiveness. He gained 20 or more yards on over 3% of his rushes, the highest rate in this rookie class. Only 33 other running backs in the Year 2 Model database have reached that threshold on 100-plus carries as rookies. Of those backs who've played four years in the league, they averaged a best PPR points-per-game season of 14.5 between Years 2 and 4. That's a very solid high-end RB2 campaign.

The less encouraging takeaway was in pass protection. Henderson entered the league with a reputation as an elite blocker, but that didn't translate immediately. Among backs with 100-plus attempts in 2025, he ranked 41st out of 49 in PFF pass-blocking grade. Stevenson ranked third. That discrepancy likely played a role in Stevenson maintaining his role, especially early in the year.

And to be fair, Stevenson earned it late in the season. After a rocky start, he finished strong. That allowed him to post the highest rushing yards over expected per attempt among qualified backs, per Next Gen Stats.

Henderson's receiving profile also didn't fully materialize. An 8.7% target share isn't poor, but for a player whose collegiate résumé suggested more pass-game involvement, that number needs to grow for him to hit his ceiling.

Stevenson's late-season surge – combined with the fact that he remains under contract in 2026 – makes Henderson's short-term outlook a bit murky. We should expect more volume in Year 2, and his long-term upside remains substantial. But given his current market price, the direction you go with Henderson likely depends on where your team stands – a win-now roster may want to capitalize and sell, while a rebuilding one may prefer to hold.

The good news? Henderson's Journey Comparables are pretty strong.



Cam Skattebo • RB

69.1

Y2 Score

NEW YORK GIANTS

WEEKLY STARTER



60.0

ZAP Score

Journey Comps: Miles Sanders ▪ James Cook ▪ Zack Moss

Anyone selling modeling as perfect and flawless is lying. We're trying to project something that's inherently difficult to forecast. And with these Year 2 Models, we're working off just one season of NFL data. Weird outcomes can, and will, happen.

Injuries are one of the biggest challenges for any model. And Cam Skattebo is a perfect example.

Before suffering a gruesome ankle injury last season, Skattebo looked like a legitimate league-winning player. His bruising college play style carried over to the NFL – something that doesn't always happen. Among running backs with 100-plus attempts last year, he ranked inside the top 10 in missed tackles forced per rush, per PFF.

The volume signal was there, too. Skattebo's weighted opportunity per game trailed only Ashton Jeanty and Omarion Hampton in the 2025 draft class. And perhaps most importantly, he earned a 13% target share when active – second-best in the class behind Jeanty.

The primary concern – beyond recovery – is Skattebo's lack of big-play production. Fewer than 1% of his rushes went for 20 or more yards last season. That does carry signal for future production, and a new coaching staff may want more of that from the run game.

It's worth remembering that some big-name players like Christian McCaffrey and Derrick Henry also failed to post strong big-play rates as rookies, so this isn't automatically disqualifying. Big plays can be somewhat situational, and they often improve with better blocking or more stable offensive environments.

But Skattebo *did* enter the league with legitimate long-speed questions. He was never projected as a home-run hitter, and the rookie data didn't exactly silence those concerns. So while the sub-1% rate isn't a red flag on its own, it does reinforce the idea that his fantasy ceiling is more likely to come through volume, tackle-breaking ability, and receiving usage than through explosive chunk gains. That's not a horrendous archetype – it just narrows the margin for error a bit.

The wildcard here is the new coaching staff in New York. Rumors are swirling that the Giants could take Jeremiyah Love at the top of this year's draft, and that would completely crater Skattebo's fantasy value without some sort of trade. The dynasty market seems to be baking that possibility in to some degree, but in situations like this, you have to ask yourself how much higher Skattebo's value could realistically go if that move *doesn't* happen. In my opinion, it's not much higher than his current RB20 price tag on KeepTradeCut. After all, Skattebo's already 24 years old.



Quinshon Judkins • RB

68.2

Y2 Score

CLEVELAND BROWNS

WEEKLY STARTER



66.0

ZAP Score

Journey Comps: Cam Akers ▪ Le'Veon Bell ▪ Eddie Lacy

Quinshon Judkins' 2025 season was a win for fantasy football. Back in August, we weren't even sure he'd suit up for the Browns. Instead, he delivered an impressive – albeit potentially slightly overrated – rookie campaign.

“Overrated” might sound harsh, so let me provide some context. Judkins came out firing, with his three best rushing yards over expected per attempt games occurring within his first four contests. Fantasy managers were understandably excited. From there, the efficiency tapered off.

That doesn't mean he was bad. Far from it. Judkins averaged over 12 PPR points per game – a mark only four other running backs in the class reached. And he did so in brutal conditions. Among higher-volume backs, he ranked dead last in yards before contact per attempt, a clear reflection of Cleveland's offensive line issues. Pro Football Focus graded the Browns' run blocking as bottom-five in the league.

Where there is reason for mild concern is in the passing game.

Judkins' ZAP score wasn't super elite coming out because he was never deployed as a full-time receiving back in college. That theme carried over to the NFL. As a rookie, he ran a route on just 30% of Cleveland's dropbacks, a lower participation rate than Derrick Henry.

That kind of usage can cap a running back's fantasy ceiling. It's not necessarily a talent deficiency – Judkins isn't incapable as a receiver – but Cleveland preferred to use fellow rookie Dylan Sampson in more obvious passing situations. A new coaching staff could shift that deployment, but Sampson is a capable player who figures to remain part of the equation throughout their rookie contracts.

Judkins is a good player. Arguably the best pure runner in the 2025 class. But Cleveland's offensive outlook is shaky, and without growth in receiving usage, his path to true RB1 upside narrows.

That's not a massive red flag – it's just something to keep in mind.



RJ Harvey • RB

66.1

Y2 Score

DENVER BRONCOS

WEEKLY STARTER



58.7

ZAP Score

Journey Comps: Ameer Abdullah ▪ Zack Moss ▪ David Montgomery

We should always take single-season running back efficiency metrics with a grain of salt. They're not overly predictive, and it's easy to overstate their importance.

With that being said, poor marks still matter. And RJ Harvey had some in 2025.

Among 48 qualified backs, Harvey ranked 46th in rushing yards over expected per attempt, per Next Gen Stats. His success rate was 32nd – notably well behind teammate JK Dobbins, who ranked 12th in the same offensive environment.

On the positive side, Harvey's burst – one of his strongest traits entering the league – did show up at times. His 109.4 Speed Score translated into a 2.1% rate of 20-plus-yard runs. Only 55 other backs in the Year 2 Model database have cleared that 2% threshold on 100-plus rookie carries.

The issue is that the explosiveness wasn't consistent. While he connected on a few long gains, Harvey's 5.5% rate of 10-plus-yard runs ranked sixth-worst all-time among Year 2 Model backs with 100-plus first-year carries. In other words, the home runs were there – the steady stream of chunk plays wasn't.

We also saw a solid 10% target share, and he was efficient enough through the air. That's meaningful in a Sean Payton offense that has historically featured running backs as receivers. That part of his profile carries real weight for long-term fantasy value.

And, of course, there were the touchdowns. Harvey scored 12 total times – rare for a rookie back. But touchdowns are far less reliable than prospect scores, early-career volume, and core efficiency metrics. While plenty of rookie backs with double-digit totals went on to strong careers, the list also includes players like Antonio Gibson, James Robinson, Eddie Lacy, and Alfred Morris – productive, but not long-term fantasy cornerstones.

The fact that Harvey didn't fully seize the starting job until Dobbins was injured is at least mildly concerning, though it's not uncommon for rookies to require time before a takeover. The larger concern is that his rushing efficiency never truly separated.

So, where do we go from here? Well, Dobbins re-signed in Denver, which creates somewhat of a roadblock for Harvey's short-term outlook. But honestly, it was still one of the better outcomes for the second-year player in free agency. Denver could've landed a bigger name like Kenneth Walker, after all. The Broncos may add another back in the draft, but at least for Harvey's sake, this year's class isn't particularly strong. From that perspective, he may end up in an OK spot.

Harvey's age is a concern – he's already 25 – but if you set proper expectations, you should be able to navigate his market. He's capable of delivering an RB2 season over the next few years, but the ceiling is likely capped. He, to me, is not a bell-cow back.



Bhayshul Tuten • RB

52.3

Y2 Score

JACKSONVILLE JAGUARS
FLEX PLAY


52.9

ZAP Score

Journey Comps: Trey Benson ▪ Derrick Henry ▪ Darrell Henderson

At the start of the offseason – back in January – yours truly listed Bhayshul Tuten as a buy candidate. Then, a couple of weeks later, I sent a newsletter out with a copy of this very player page, telling people not to be too aggressive. It now seems like, based on general sentiment, people don't know where I stand. So I decided to re-write this whole thing to be clear: Bhayshul Tuten is more of a buy than a sell. That feeling may not be an intense one, but that's the side I lean.

It's no secret that the ZAP Model liked Tuten. And it's no secret that he didn't live up to the hype in 2025.

After Tank Bigsby was dealt to Philadelphia, Travis Etienne took firm control of the Jacksonville backfield. There were moments when it felt like Tuten might carve out a larger role, but something always intervened – an injury, a hot stretch from Etienne – and Tuten would slide back into the background.

Tuten's ZAP Model profile was legitimately strong. And there were positives to his rookie season. He, for instance, posted a 47% success rate compared to Etienne's 36%. That grinder mentality led to the Jags using Tuten frequently at the goal line – he had 7 goal-line attempts to Etienne's 12, which is notable given Etienne's workload advantage. Tuten also gained positive yardage on over 85% of his rushes, a top-two mark among 50-plus carry rookies from the 2025 class.

One issue is that the explosiveness that fueled his prospect appeal didn't really show up in Year 1. On 83 rush attempts, Tuten failed to record a single run of 20 or more yards (though he did hit a 20-yard run in the playoffs). He had just two runs of 15-plus yards.

In the Year 2 Model database, 13 other running backs have logged at least 50 rookie carries without a 20-plus-yard run in the regular season. Of those 13, only one went on to average more than 10 PPR points per game in Years 2 through 4. The sample is small, but that's not exactly comforting.

So this, at the moment, is a high-variance profile. On one end, you have a player beloved by the ZAP Model relative to draft capital expectations. And he had some encouraging marks as a rookie. On the other, the explosiveness that we – the model – liked to see wasn't totally evident in Year 1.

Travis Etienne is gone now, though. All that's left on the Jacksonville running back depth chart is Tuten, LeQuint Allen, and now Chris Rodriguez.

Tuten should at least get some shot this year, even if it's in tandem with Rodriguez, who hasn't been much of a pass-catcher in college or the NFL. And I'm more on the side that Tuten's more talented than not – we can't just totally forget about his ZAP score.



Woody Marks • RB

51.6

Y2 Score

HOUSTON TEXANS

FLEX PLAY



38.6

ZAP Score

Journey Comps: Javorius Allen ▪ Kendall Hunter ▪ Andre Williams

Woody Marks didn't profile as a true three-down back entering the NFL. That's what the ZAP Model suggested, and it's what I believed, too.

And yet, as a rookie, we frequently saw him in that role. Marks finished with the sixth-best weighted opportunity per game in the class. He also became just the 12th running back in Year 2 Model history to log at least 190 rookie carries after being selected outside the top 100 picks.

Sounds impressive.

Historically, it isn't.

Of the 11 backs who did it before him, their average best PPR points-per-game season across Years 2 through 4 is just 7.9. That's not difference-making production.

When Day 3 running backs earn heavy rookie volume, it's often more about team weakness than individual talent. Opportunity can be circumstantial.

That doesn't mean Marks is a bad player. In fact, the ZAP Model viewed him fairly favorably relative to his draft capital. But even last year's guide framed him as more of a complementary back with pass-catching ability than a true three-down option.

The strange part of his rookie season? Despite the workload, Houston didn't feature him heavily as a receiver. Marks posted just a 6.9% target share on a roughly 40% route participation rate – solid, but not what you'd expect for a player whose profile leaned on receiving utility.

Efficiency didn't help the case. Behind a below-average Houston run-blocking unit, Marks ranked 43rd out of 48 qualified backs in success rate, 33rd in rushing yards over expected per attempt, and 42nd in EPA per rush. Among the nine rookie backs with 100-plus carries, his rates of 10-plus-yard and 20-plus-yard runs both ranked second worst.

That's not a profile that screams long-term stability.

It's no surprise, then, that Houston traded for David Montgomery. Hypothetically, Montgomery's a strong complement – he can handle much of the in-between-the-tackles work the Texans thought Nick Chubb might provide in 2025. That's going to severely limit Marks' workload, though you could argue Montgomery is a win for Marks. If they don't add a back with significant capital in the draft, Montgomery isn't overly difficult competition compared to what could've been for Houston.

Even still, we're back where we started: Marks is a tandem back, not a bell-cow.



Dylan Sampson • RB

51.1

Y2 Score

CLEVELAND BROWNS

FLEX PLAY



36.8

ZAP Score

Journey Comps: Chuba Hubbard ▪ Ray Davis ▪ Andre Williams

Dylan Sampson finished 2025 with an 8.6% target share. That may not sound like much, but get this: among Year 2 Model running backs selected outside the top 100 picks, only 21 have reached an 8% target share as rookies.

What makes Sampson's season even more unusual is that he didn't enter the league with a strong collegiate receiving résumé. His best prorated reception share in college was under 10%. Of those 21 rookie backs to hit an 8% NFL target share, only seven had a sub-10% reception share in college.

Unfortunately for Sampson managers, that subset hasn't produced much fantasy upside. None of those backs became true difference-makers after Year 1. The best outcome was probably Jordan Howard, who topped out at 12.8 PPR points per game post-rookie season.

Maybe there's a small silver lining: Sampson was efficient as a receiver, posting the highest yards-per-route-run rate among that group. Maybe that matters enough to keep the momentum going into Year 2 and beyond. Maybe.

On the ground, though, little stood out – and what did wasn't encouraging. Sampson became just the ninth Year 2 Model back with 50-plus rookie carries to post a sub-5% 10-plus-yard run rate. While he managed a few 20-plus-yard gains, the down-to-down consistency wasn't there. His 29.1% success rate was borderline alarming.

You may have read earlier that Quinshon Judkins ranked last in yards before contact per attempt this past year. But that was when looking at higher-volume backs. When loosening that filter a bit and looking at guys with 50 or more carries, Sampson actually ranks even worse – he's dead last in the league by a healthy margin.

To put that another way, it's likely that Sampson's line wasn't doing him any favors this past year.

Still, the overall profile doesn't scream high ceiling.

If Quinshon Judkins is healthy, Sampson isn't leading this backfield. He's a capable handcuff – and his receiving usage supports that – but projecting much more than that in the short term feels aggressive. Down the line, perhaps his top Journey Comparable of Chuba Hubbard offers a plausible path. But that's more developmental outcome than immediate expectation.



Jacory Croskey-Merritt • RB

49.5

Y2 Score

WASHINGTON COMMANDERS

FLEX PLAY



13.9

ZAP Score

Journey Comps: James Robinson ▪ Jaylen Warren ▪ Daryl Richardson

The hype around Jacory Croskey-Merritt was very real just a week or two before the 2025 season, and he backed it up early. After the first month-plus, Next Gen Stats had Croskey-Merritt – “Bill” – posting the best success rate in football. Washington was still splitting the backfield, but Bill was undeniably productive.

Then regression hit.

Four of Croskey-Merritt’s first five games featured a success rate of at least 50%. During that stretch, he averaged a ridiculous 2.2 rushing yards over expected per attempt and gained 10 or more yards on nearly 21% of his carries.

After Week 5, the numbers cooled significantly. Croskey-Merritt had just two games with a 50% success rate the rest of the way. His rushing yards over expected per attempt fell to 0.34, and his 10-plus-yard run rate dropped to 9.1%.

Even so, his full-season body of work isn’t terrible. Bill generated a 10-plus-yard run at a 12% clip – above average within the class – and finished with 8.6 PPR points per game. His comparables across those metrics include Jerick McKinnon, Tyjae Spears, Tarik Cohen, and Keaton Mitchell.

The issue? Most of those players were meaningfully involved as receivers early in their careers. Croskey-Merritt wasn’t in Year 1. He finished with just a 3.0% target share and ran a route on only 25% of Washington’s dropbacks.

Woof.

Overall, Croskey-Merritt’s rushing profile fits that of a big-play complementary back. The problem is that there’s little evidence of a receiving backbone – even in college, despite more than four seasons of play, he never reached a 10% reception share. That could explain why the Commanders went out and signed the pass-catching Rachaad White.

Bill should continue to have a role in Washington’s backfield, though. It may not be a massive one, but it’ll be something.

But absent growth in the passing game, it’s difficult to project him as anything more than a rotational option rather than a featured piece.



Kaleb Johnson • RB

49.4

Y2 Score

PITTSBURGH STEELERS
FLEX PLAY


64.8

ZAP Score

Journey Comps: Shane Vereen ▪ Derrius Guice ▪ Tank Bigsby

Do we really have to talk about Kaleb Johnson?

Each year, as you know, the ZAP Model gets refined. New data is tested. New inputs are introduced. Player scores shift.

This current iteration of the running back ZAP Model is the best it's ever been.

And it still likes Kaleb Johnson.

Great.

Johnson had arguably the most disappointing rookie season of any back in last year's class. From a volume standpoint alone, he joins 19 other Year 2 Model running backs drafted inside the top 100 who failed to reach 50 rush attempts as rookies. On his 28 carries, he didn't record a single 10-plus-yard run.

We're off to a great start.

When we isolate backs drafted between Picks 32 and 100 since 2011 who failed to reach 50 rookie rush attempts, there *have* been a few spike seasons. Six produced at least 13.0 PPR points per game in one of Years 2 through 4. One of those was Mike Leshoure, who tore his Achilles before his rookie season and never really had the opportunity for that workload.

The others? Shane Vereen, Kenyan Drake, Ronald Jones, Damien Harris, and Darrell Henderson.

There's a path to some one-off production, as that group of backs shows. But for Johnson to become a true fantasy staple, he'd essentially have to break historical precedent for backs in his draft range over the last decade-plus.

You can make that bet if you'd like – especially with his dynasty price cratered. There's a new coaching staff in Pittsburgh, and while the Steelers did add Rico Dowdle (while losing Kenneth Gainwell), you never know how a new set of coaches will want to run things.

But let's be realistic: Kaleb Johnson profiles more like this year's Ja'Lynn Polk than a misunderstood breakout candidate. It's probably not going to happen. The one sliver of hope? Running back prospect scores tend to carry more rebound value than wide receiver scores after a poor rookie season. So while the odds aren't close to being in his favor, the position itself at least leaves the door cracked open.



Kyle Monangai • RB

49.2

Y2 Score

CHICAGO BEARS

FLEX PLAY



16.4

ZAP Score

Journey Comps: Isiah Pacheco ▪ Justin Jackson ▪ James Robinson

The ZAP Model wasn't particularly fond of Kyle Monangai for two primary reasons: draft capital and receiving.

As a seventh-round pick, he didn't have meaningful investment behind him. And analytically, the pass-game background was thin. His adjusted receiving yards per team pass attempt sat well below the 2025 class average, and he never reached an 8% best-season reception share in college.

If Monangai was going to hit, it was going to be on the ground.

Fortunately, he landed in a spot that allowed that to happen. In Chicago, Monangai handled 169 regular-season carries. He became just the fourth Year 2 Model back to reach at least 160 rookie rush attempts after being selected outside the top 200 picks. The other three: the aforementioned Jacory Croskey-Merritt, James Robinson, and fellow Rutgers alum Isiah Pacheco – ironically Monangai's top Journey Comparable.

So what's next?

The receiving work didn't expand in Year 1. Monangai finished with just a 5.7% target share and an underwhelming 0.75 yards per route run rate. That's unlikely to fuel a fantasy ceiling.

As a rusher, he was solid – and undeniably fun to watch – but the underlying efficiency was more average than highlight reels suggest. PFF graded him below average in missed tackles forced per attempt, and Next Gen Stats had his rushing yards over expected per attempt hovering around league average.

Where he did stand out was in consistency. Among 48 qualified backs, Monangai ranked fifth in success rate. But even that deserves context: teammate D'Andre Swift ranked just below him, and Chicago's offensive line finished fifth in run-blocking grade, per PFF. The environment was doing some of the lifting.

Monangai isn't a bad player. In fact, relative to expectation, he's a ZAP Model L. But the receiving ceiling remains limited, and his rushing profile looks more early-down grinder than true difference-maker.

My personal rankings are higher on Monangai than what the Year 2 Model is saying, largely because the situation is fantastic. The model isn't accounting for that.

But the broader profile tells a more measured story. Long term, he projects as a flex option with occasional RB2 spikes, not unlike Isiah Pacheco. He's probably not some foundational piece. That makes the Flex Play designation appropriate.



Devin Neal • RB

47.0

Y2 Score

NEW ORLEANS SAINTS

FLEX PLAY



29.7

ZAP Score

Journey Comps: Vick Ballard ▪ Elijah McGuire ▪ Chase Edmonds

Devin Neal more or less did what the ZAP Model suggested he would do as a rookie.

Was he great? Probably not.

Was he playable? Absolutely.

Thanks to injuries to Alvin Kamara and Kendre Miller, Neal found himself operating as New Orleans' lead back for stretches of the season. He logged a 70% snap share three times, and in those games, he averaged a respectable 12.1 PPR points per contest.

Neal entered the league projecting as a potential three-down back – just not a dominant one. His collegiate profile suggested competence across the board without a true standout trait. And that's exactly what we saw in 2025. When given the opportunity, he handled early downs, ran routes at a high clip, and stayed on the field in passing situations. In those three high-usage games, his route participation exceeded 70%, leading to an 11% target share.

In other words, the coaching staff trusted him.

It tells us that if injuries strike again, Neal is capable of absorbing a near three-down workload. It may not be explosive or hyper-efficient, but it's usable volume.

Efficiency-wise, though, nothing jumped off the page. His success rate was low and similar to Kendre Miller's. His 10-plus-yard run rate lagged behind most of his rookie classmates. And his receiving efficiency was below the norm.

He didn't separate. But he also didn't crater.

And that's really the story here. Neal profiles as a stabilizer – the type of back who can keep an offense on schedule and deliver replacement-level fantasy production when called upon. He's unlikely to become a league-winner, but he's also unlikely to disappear.

In dynasty, that archetype has value. He's a high-end depth piece with contingent upside – the kind of player you're glad to roster when the inevitable running back injuries hit.

Not extraordinary. But very rosterable.

Closing

Football isn't solved. It never will be.

If it were, there'd be no reason to do this. No reason to build models. No reason to debate landing spots or argue over breakout ages. No reason to care about a 21-year-old running back's target share.

But this game lives in the gray area.

Humans are playing it. Coaches are making decisions. Front offices are guessing. Injuries happen. Situations change. And we're all trying to make sense of it — **to reverse engineer a sport built on chaos.**

That's what makes prospecting so addicting. There's always room for improvement.

This guide isn't about certainty. It's about probability. It's about stacking small edges over time. It's about having a process you trust when you're on the clock and the group chat is losing its mind.

We'll get things right. We'll get things wrong. That's part of it.

But we'll keep refining. Keep questioning. Keep iterating. Because the edge isn't in being perfect — it's in being thoughtful.

Thanks for letting me obsess over this stuff for another year.



Rookie Rankings

Single-QB Top-48											
Rk	Player	Pos	Pos. Rank	Tier			Rk	Player	Pos	Pos. Rank	Tier
1	Jeremiyah Love	RB	1	1			25	Ja'Kobi Lane	WR	16	7
2	Jordyn Tyson	WR	1	2			26	Brenen Thompson	WR	17	7
3	Carnell Tate	WR	2	2			27	Bryce Lance	WR	18	8
4	Makai Lemon	WR	3	2			28	Ty Simpson	QB	2	8
5	KC Concepcion	WR	4	3			29	Max Klare	TE	3	8
6	Kenyon Sadiq	TE	1	3			30	Eric McAlister	WR	19	8
7	Omar Cooper	WR	5	4			31	Kaytron Allen	RB	7	8
8	Denzel Boston	WR	6	4			32	Seth McGowan	RB	8	8
9	Eli Stowers	TE	2	4			33	Kevin Coleman	WR	20	8
10	Elijah Sarratt	WR	7	5			34	Michael Trigg	TE	4	9
11	Fernando Mendoza	QB	1	5			35	Sam Roush	TE	5	9
12	Emmett Johnson	RB	2	5			36	Eli Heidenreich	RB	9	9
13	Chris Brazzell	WR	8	5			37	Justin Joly	TE	6	9
14	Jadarian Price	RB	3	5			38	Demond Claiborne	RB	10	9
15	Mike Washington	RB	4	5			39	Deion Burks	WR	21	10
16	Germie Bernard	WR	9	5			40	Barion Brown	WR	22	10
17	Jonah Coleman	RB	5	5			41	Reggie Virgil	WR	23	10
18	Nick Singleton	RB	6	6			42	Adam Randall	RB	11	10
19	Ted Hurst	WR	10	6			43	Desmond Reid	RB	12	10
20	Antonio Williams	WR	11	6			44	J'Mari Taylor	RB	13	11
21	Chris Bell	WR	12	6			45	Jam Miller	RB	14	11
22	Zachariah Branch	WR	13	7			46	Kendrick Law	WR	24	11
23	Malachi Fields	WR	14	7			47	Josh Cameron	WR	25	11
24	Skyler Bell	WR	15	7			48	CJ Daniels	WR	26	11

Superflex Top-48

Rk	Player	Pos	Pos. Rank	Tier	Rk	Player	Pos	Pos. Rank	Tier
1	Jeremiyah Love	RB	1	1	25	Skyler Bell	WR	15	7
2	Fernando Mendoza	QB	1	2	26	Ja'Kobi Lane	WR	16	7
3	Jordyn Tyson	WR	1	2	27	Brenen Thompson	WR	17	7
4	Carnell Tate	WR	2	2	28	Bryce Lance	WR	18	8
5	Makai Lemon	WR	3	2	29	Max Klare	TE	3	8
6	KC Concepcion	WR	4	3	30	Garrett Nussmeier	QB	3	8
7	Kenyon Sadiq	TE	1	3	31	Eric McAlister	WR	19	8
8	Omar Cooper	WR	5	4	32	Kaytron Allen	RB	7	8
9	Denzel Boston	WR	6	4	33	Seth McGowan	RB	8	8
10	Eli Stowers	TE	2	4	34	Kevin Coleman	WR	20	8
11	Elijah Sarratt	WR	7	5	35	Michael Trigg	TE	4	9
12	Ty Simpson	QB	2	5	36	Sam Roush	TE	5	9
13	Emmett Johnson	RB	2	5	37	Drew Allar	QB	4	9
14	Chris Brazzell	WR	8	5	38	Eli Heidenreich	RB	9	9
15	Jadarian Price	RB	3	5	39	Justin Joly	TE	6	9
16	Mike Washington	RB	4	5	40	Demond Claiborne	RB	10	9
17	Germie Bernard	WR	9	5	41	Deion Burks	WR	21	10
18	Jonah Coleman	RB	5	5	42	Barion Brown	WR	22	10
19	Nick Singleton	RB	6	6	43	Reggie Virgil	WR	23	10
20	Ted Hurst	WR	10	6	44	Adam Randall	RB	11	10
21	Antonio Williams	WR	11	6	45	Cole Payton	QB	5	10
22	Chris Bell	WR	12	6	46	Desmond Reid	RB	12	10
23	Zachariah Branch	WR	13	7	47	J'Mari Taylor	RB	13	11
24	Malachi Fields	WR	14	7	48	Jam Miller	RB	14	11

ZAP Model Rankings

RUNNING BACK			WIDE RECEIVER			TIGHT END		
Rk	Player	ZAP	Rk	Player	ZAP	Rk	Player	ZAP
LEGENDARY PERFORMER			LEGENDARY PERFORMER			LEGENDARY PERFORMER		
1	Jeremiah Love	93.9	1	Jordyn Tyson	92.2	1	Kenyon Sadiq	97.8
WEEKLY STARTER			ELITE PRODUCER			ELITE PRODUCER		
2	Emmett Johnson	69.7	2	Carnell Tate	84.2	2	Eli Stowers	79.2
3	Jadarian Price	64.2	3	Makai Lemon	80.2	FLEX PLAY		
4	Mike Washington	61.0	WEEKLY STARTER			3	Max Klare	56.2
FLEX PLAY			4	KC Concepcion	73.4	4	Michael Trigg	48.8
5	Jonah Coleman	58.7	5	Omar Cooper	66.3	5	Sam Roush	44.7
6	Nick Singleton	51.0	6	Denzel Boston	66.1	6	Justin Joly	40.8
7	Kaytron Allen	41.0	7	Chris Brazzell	61.6	BENCHWARMER		
BENCHWARMER			8	Germie Bernard	60.4	7	Joe Royer	36.3
8	Demond Claiborne	32.8	FLEX PLAY			8	Oscar Delp	34.9
9	Eli Heidenreich	31.6	9	Elijah Sarratt	57.4	9	Jack Endries	34.7
WAIVER WIRE ADD			10	Zachariah Branch	57.0	WAIVER WIRE ADD		
10	Seth McGowan	28.1	11	Antonio Williams	54.5	10	Marlin Klein	28.4
11	Adam Randall	27.9	12	Chris Bell	54.4	11	Eli Raridon	28.0
12	J'Mari Taylor	25.5	13	Malachi Fields	53.3	12	Dallen Bentley	25.3
13	Desmond Reid	24.0	14	Ja'Kobi Lane	46.8	13	Tanner Koziol	22.0
DART THROW			15	Ted Hurst	42.5	DART THROW		
14	Le'Veon Moss	19.5	16	Skyler Bell	40.6	14	Dae'Quan Wright	19.5
15	Jam Miller	18.0	BENCHWARMER			15	John Michael Gyllenborg	18.2
16	Robert Henry	16.7	17	Eric McAlister	36.6	16	Nate Boerkircher	17.7
17	Roman Hemby	16.1	18	Brenen Thompson	35.7	17	Josh Cuevas	16.3
18	CJ Donaldson	13.8	19	Bryce Lance	34.8	18	Riley Nowakowski	12.5
19	Noah Whittington	8.8	20	Reggie Virgil	33.8	19	Matthew Hibner	8.6
20	Rahsul Faison	8.7	21	Kevin Coleman	33.4	20	Jaren Kanak	7.5
			22	Deion Burks	33.3	21	Will Kacmarek	7.4
			WAIVER WIRE ADD			22	RJ Maryland	7.1
			23	Barion Brown	26.4	23	Bauer Sharp	6.5
			24	Kendrick Law	25.4	24	Miles Kitselman	6.2
			25	Jeff Caldwell	24.8	25	DJ Rogers	5.5